Part 2: Reading comprehension

WHAT'S AFTER UMAMI? SCIENTISTS ARE HUNTING FOR THE SIXTH BASIC TASTE

In 1908, Japanese chemist Kikunae Ikeda was studying the active substances in **seaweed**, when he made a discovery that would change food science forever. Ikeda realized that a compound called *glutamic acid* was what gave seaweed its distinctive taste—nothing like the existing basic tastes of sweet, salty, sour, and bitter. He named that taste *umami*.

Yet even though people have been eating seaweed, mushrooms, miso, cheese, and fermented foods for ages, it took nearly a century of scientific debate for umami to be recognized worldwide as the fifth basic taste. It wasn't until the 1990s that it gained universal recognition, and only after extensive scientific studies confirmed that it was unlike any other existing taste.

Is it time to add a sixth taste to the list? Some scientists argue that the answer is yes, though there is still debate about what it should be. Scientists have not been intentionally searching for a sixth taste. Rather, "there's a fundamental science-based search for different ways we can experience the world in terms of taste and how it's detected," explains neuroscientist Emily Liman.

Advances in understanding the science of taste would allow food scientists to create more delicious foods—and could also help doctors diagnose and treat related disorders that involve a loss of your sense of taste. But getting the scientific community to agree on a sixth sense is not easy. To qualify as a basic taste, any competitor must be proven to be as distinct as the sweetness of berries or the bitterness of kale.

First, it's important to note that "there's a difference between taste and flavor," says Marisa Moore, a dietitian in culinary nutrition from Atlanta. "Taste begins on the tongue when food molecules we eat mix with saliva and activate our **taste buds**, which then send signals to the brain and cause the perception of distinct tastes." Contrary to popular belief, the tongue does not have specific areas that detect each type of taste. Instead, basic tastes can be picked up by taste buds on various parts of the tongue, though different cells may have varying levels of sensitivity to sweet, sour, salty, bitter, and umami.

While taste begins in the mouth, flavor is what registers in the brain when it combines the entire experience of taste, texture, temperature, and aroma. "Taste and other senses do interact in the brain to put together flavor," says Richard Mattes, professor of nutrition science at Purdue University, "but that's different from taste."

Various criteria have been proposed over the years to define a new taste. For starters, a taste needs to have a "chemical signature"—a set of chemical components that are distinct from that of other substances. Then, Mattes says, "you need to have a receptor anywhere on the tongue, **palate**, or throat where the chemical component can interact with a cell in a taste bud." That cell in the taste bud must then have a mechanism "to change the component's chemical signal to an electrical signal that is then transmitted through nerves to the brain," Mattes adds. The electrical signal carried by taste nerves must activate regions in the brain that are associated with taste, and it needs to generate a unique taste perception in the brain that is independent from other tastes. Finally, there needs to be a response in the body that results from these effects. For example, Mattes says, "the perception of sweetness triggers the release of insulin throughout the body."

In short, a major challenge to getting the scientific community to accept a new taste has to do with the complexity of the research that needs to be conducted. "You have to go through a lot to prove a taste exists," says Dawn Jackson Blatner, a dietitian nutritionist in Chicago. None of the candidates for a sixth basic taste have passed all experimental tests yet—but some of them are closer to doing so than others. Despite all these complications, scientists continue to study taste—and debate what the next big one might be—because taste is important, as it is about what we **crave**, how we cook, and how satisfied we feel after eating.

Text adapted from an article by
Stacey Colino. *National Geographic* [online] (November 25, 2025)

seaweed: alga
taste bud: papil·la gustativa / papila gustativa
palate: paladar
crave: tenir desig de / tener antojo de

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. How did umami become recognized as the fifth basic taste? USE YOUR OWN WORDS TO ANSWER THE QUESTION. You may keep the words in the question.

2. Complete the following sentence:

Improving the diagnosis of taste-related illnesses and permitting researchers to make food tastier are…

3. Find a phrase in the text that means the following: "Unlike what people usually think".

4. According to the text, what is flavor the result of?

5. Name TWO of the different criteria that have been proposed over the years to define a new taste.

6. In what sense does the study of taste continue to be important? In your answer, mention the THREE reasons given in the text. USE YOUR OWN WORDS.

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

THE SCIENCE OF FEAR: HOW IT AFFECTS YOUR BODY AND MIND

Fear is a natural response that has helped humans survive dangerous situations for centuries. While, unlike those faced by our ancestors, today's threats are less likely to involve sabre-tooth tigers, haunted houses, scary movies, and harmless **pranks** still trigger the same physical and emotional reactions. The body's fight-or-flight response releases stress hormones and prepares us to either face the challenge or escape it. But how exactly does fear work, and what happens when it is activated too often?

The amygdala is a part of the brain that handles the processing of emotions and detection of danger. The fear response originates from it; upon detecting an apparent peril, signals are sent to the hypothalamus. The hypothalamus is an organ that initiates nervous and endocrine systems. Further, it encourages the release of stress hormones like cortisol, adrenaline, and noradrenaline. These chemicals cause a chain reaction in the body: your heart beats faster to pump oxygen-rich blood to your muscles and brain, your breathing quickens, your pupils dilate for better vision, and your muscles tense up ready for action. Adrenaline also reduces pain and heightens focus, allowing you to respond effectively to a threat. Interestingly, the release of dopamine, another hormone, can create a feeling of happiness during fear-inducing situations, which explains why some people enjoy being scared.

Your brain doesn't instantly distinguish between actual and imagined dangers. When an actor in a haunted house jumps out wearing a scary mask, for example, your body automatically behaves as if the danger were real. This is the automatic and brief initial phase of the fear response. However, the prefrontal cortex, the part of the brain that is responsible for reasoning, quickly weighs this event. It confers with the hippocampus, an organ that **retrieves** the memories of similar events from storage to determine if there really is any danger. If you have been through a haunted house before, your brain knows the threat is not real, and the fear response turns off. But when the situation is unfamiliar—say, some terrifying scene in a horror movie—your body may release stress hormones, and physical effects—such as a racing heart or sweaty palms—may be more obvious.

While the fear response is necessary for survival, frequent activation can damage the body. Continuous release of stress hormones may lead to high blood pressure, heart problems, digestive issues and immune system dysregulation because your body is constantly in "high alert" mode. Chronic exposure to jump scares can also desensitize the brain to real threats, potentially dulling critical survival instincts.

Some groups should take more care with scary activities. For instance, people with heart diseases, chronic pain, and anxiety disorders are more sensitive to the negative side effects of scares. According to experts, scary activities are not recommended in order to protect mental and physical health.

Controlled scares—the ones in haunted houses or elsewhere—are enjoyable to many. The temporary flash of stress hormones followed by relief creates an **exhilarating** sensation. But just like with any other activity involving health risks, moderation must be observed. When you become aware of what fear is, you can appreciate its role in survival and entertainment but also treat its impact on your health with respect.

Text adapted from an article by
Daryl Austin. *National Geographic* [online] (October 2, 2024)

prank: bretolada, broma / gamberrada, broma
retrieve: recuperar
exhilarating: emocionant, excitant / emocionante, excitante

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. According to the text, which threat is not usually encountered today?

2. Paraphrase the following sentence: "The release of dopamine […] can create a feeling of happiness during fear-inducing situations" (lines 14-15). You may keep the word *dopamine*.

3. How does the hippocampus help in distinguishing real threats from fake ones? DO NOT COPY DIRECTLY FROM THE TEXT. You may keep the words *hippocampus*, *brain*, and *past*.

4. How can frequent exposure to scary experiences affect someone's reaction to real danger?

5. Find a synonym in the text for *consider* in the sense of "assess, evaluate, and analyze."

6. Complete the following sentence:

It's important to understand what fear is so that you…

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

YOU MIGHT BE A LATE BLOOMER

Today we live in a society structured to promote early bloomers. Our school system has sorted people by the time they are 18, using grades and university entrance exam scores. Some of these people zoom to prestigious academic trajectories while others get left behind. Many of our most prominent models of success made it big while young—Bill Gates, Mark Zuckerberg, Elon Musk, Taylor Swift, Michael Jordan. Magazines publish lists to glamorize youthful superstars on the rise. Age discrimination is a fact of life. But for many people, the talents that bloom later in life are more consequential than the ones that bloom early. Even brilliant people apparently need at least a couple of decades to master their field.

Successful late bloomers are all around us. Morgan Freeman had his first key roles in *Street Smart* and *Driving Miss Daisy* in his early 50s. Colonel Harland Sanders started Kentucky Fried Chicken in his 60s. Isak Dinesen published the book that established her literary reputation, *Out of Africa*, at 52. Morris Chang founded Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing, the world's leading chipmaker, at 55. If Samuel Johnson had died at 40, few would remember him, but now he is considered one of the greatest writers in the history of the English language. Copernicus came up with his theory of planetary motion in his 60s.

Why do some people **hit their peak** later than others? In his book *Late Bloomers*, the journalist Rich Karlgaard points out that late bloomers are not simply early bloomers on a delayed timetable—they didn't just do the things early bloomers did but at a later age. Late bloomers tend to be *qualitatively* different. They possess a different set of abilities that are mostly invisible to or discouraged by our current education system. They usually have to invent their own paths. Late bloomers "fulfill their potential frequently in novel and unexpected ways," Karlgaard writes, "surprising even those closest to them."

If you survey history, a taxonomy of achievement emerges. In the first category are the "early bloomers," the precocious geniuses. These are people like Picasso or Fitzgerald who succeeded young. As the University of Chicago economist David Galenson has pointed out, these high achievers usually made a conceptual **breakthrough**. They came up with a new idea and then executed it. Then there are the "second-mountain people," exemplified by, say, Albert Schweitzer. First, they conquer their career mountain; Schweitzer, for instance, was an accomplished musician and scholar. But these people find their career success unsatisfying, so they leave their career mountain to serve humanity—their whole motivational structure shifts from acquisition to altruism. Schweitzer became a doctor in the poorest parts of Africa, and won the Nobel Peace Prize for his work in 1952. Finally, there are the people Galenson calls "the masters." These are people like Cézanne or Alfred Hitchcock or Charles Darwin, who were not all that successful—and in some cases just not even very good at what they did—when they were young. This could have been discouraging, but they just kept improving.

Late bloomers don't do as much advance planning as the conceptual geniuses, but they regard their entire lives as experiments. They try something and learn, and then they try something else and learn more. Their focus is not on their finished work, which they often throw away **haphazardly**. Their focus is on the process of learning itself, which they enjoy. They live their lives as a long period of trial and error, trying this and trying that, a slow process of accumulation and elaboration, so the quality of their work peaks late in life. They are the ugly ducklings of human achievement, who, over the decades, turn themselves into swans. Slow at the start, late bloomers are still sprinting during that final lap—they do not slow down as age brings its decay. They are seeking. They are striving. They are in it with all their heart.

Text adapted from an article by
David Brooks. *The Atlantic* [online] (June 26, 2024)

hit their peak: assolir el cim / alcanzar la cima
breakthrough: descobriment / descubrimiento
haphazardly: de qualsevol manera / de cualquier manera

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. What evidence does the author of the text use to claim that our society is structured to promote early bloomers? Mention ONE piece of evidence.

2. Explain what the examples of late bloomers in the second paragraph have in common (besides being well-known figures).

3. Explain IN YOUR OWN WORDS the consequence of late bloomers' invisibility to the current education system.

4. What is meant by the term *second-mountain people* (line 27)?

5. Rewrite the following sentence: "They possess a different set of abilities that are mostly invisible to or discouraged by our current education system" (lines 19-20). You may keep grammatical words (i.e. articles, pronouns, conjunctions, etc.) and the word *education*.

6. Mention TWO characteristics of late bloomers.

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

TIPPING IS MORE CONFUSING THAN EVER. HERE'S HOW TO HANDLE IT

Tipping has never been more confusing. Americans might always have disagreed on exactly how much to tip—20, 15, 10 percent?—but they generally knew where to do it. Now, tipping screens are popping up on iPads practically everywhere, and politicians are making things even harder by trying to adjust the laws around tipping.

Americans have been leaving a little extra with the bill for pretty much as long as the country has existed. But the practice really only took off after the Civil War, when travelers abroad brought the custom home to pay formerly enslaved black people, many of whom worked for a **pittance** as porters for the Pullman Company. Eventually, when restaurants took off as an industry separate from hotels and boarding places, gratuity became popular there, too. When minimum wage laws arrived with the New Deal, it made sense to legislators to exempt workers in professions where the expected tips would account for the difference. Similar thinking held when Congress created the "tip credit" system in the 1960s: allowing businesses to pay tipped personnel a subminimum wage only as long as tips brought their earnings to or above the minimum.

From there, tipping culture perpetuated itself. Americans know restaurant workers or, to a lesser extent, carwashers and hairdressers, legally don't take home enough money without tips, so the expectation that people will tip them has become customary. And as long as Americans keep tipping, the law can stay the same. Only recently, this status quo has become unstable. The laws started to change in the 2010s, when some cities, including D.C., and several states decided to experiment with cancelling the tip credit. Meanwhile, Congress passed legislation in 2018 allowing restaurants that pay servers the statutory minimum to redistribute any tips those employees *do* receive to back-of-house staff. Norms have changed, too, in more recent years—but in the opposite direction. Seventy-two percent of Americans said in a 2023 survey that they believe tips are expected in more places. That's thanks in part to the dawn of the digital payment era: pressing "no" on an iPad tip screen feels a lot ruder than neglecting to **toss** a dollar in a glass jar.

There's plenty of reasons to wish tipping would disappear altogether. People's tips might depend on how they look rather than the quality of their service. The unpredictability of pay—a rainy night likely means a lighter wallet—means undue financial stress for the tipped worker. Cooks and dishwashers also end up worse off than servers, especially at higher-end establishments, regardless of skill. On the other hand, research suggests the existence of tipping may yield better service, at least here in the United States. And many restaurants have struggled to support themselves without the flexibility the system allows them. In short, tipping probably isn't going to disappear anytime soon, and something like the status quo is not necessarily bad.

Where does that leave customers? One principle is simple: Where there's a subminimum wage, tip. The second factor to consider is more complicated and more personal: tip when someone is doing you a service that's worth more to you than the person serving you is getting for it. Maybe that is someone doing an average job in an above-average way—a locksmith who spends hours in the cold to let you in your house, or a barista with a flair for latte art. Or maybe it's someone doing unpleasant work for very little—hotel cleaning staff remedying a big mess. What kind of tipper are you?

Text adapted from an article by
David Shipley. *The Washington Post* [online] (September 23, 2024)

pittance: misèria / miseria
toss: llençar / lanzar

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. When and how did the practice of tipping start in America?

2. Find a sentence in the text that corresponds to the following rewritten/paraphrased sentence: "Since the early days of the United States, people have routinely added a small bonus to their payments."

3. Explain the tip credit system that was created in the 1960s IN YOUR OWN WORDS. You may use the words *pay*, *minimum* and *businesses*.

4. Why are tips believed to be expected in more places now?

5. Rewrite/paraphrase the sentence: "People's tips might depend on how they look rather than the quality of their service" (lines 27-28). You may keep grammatical words (i.e. *the*, *might*, *their*, *how*, etc.) and the following words: *tips*, *service*.

6. Explain IN YOUR OWN WORDS the second factor customers should consider when deciding whether to tip or not.

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

HOW TO MAKE PIZZA LIKE A NEAPOLITAN MASTER

When you think of Italy's most memorable dishes, its beloved pizza will most likely be among your top three favourites. It's a comfort food that has become an obsession around the world. But what makes pizza from Italy so special, and where do you find the very best?

Like so many of the country's most prized gastronomic delights like wine, olive oil and cheese, the quintessential pie from Naples, where pizza was born, is now worthy of its own Designation of Controlled Origin (DOC). The city's pizza-making tradition even received Unesco recognition in 2017 as an **intangible cultural heritage** item. Naples is the hub of the *pizza napoletana*, with generations of the same family groomed in the art of being a *pizzaiolo* (pizzamaker). And each family carefully guards its recipe variations with a passion that's matched perhaps only by the city's love for its football team. There are three basic types of Neapolitan pizza: the Margherita, topped with tomato sauce, mozzarella cheese and fresh **basil**; the marinara, with no cheese and oregano and garlic instead of basil; and the "DOC", made with *mozzarella di bufala* instead of the usual *fior di latte* made from cow's milk.

Pizza is said to have originated in the city in the 1700s, after one of the essential ingredients, the tomato, was brought from Peru. But even before that, Neapolitans had been eating a version of the pita, a kind of flatbread brought from Arabic immigrants, and which eventually evolved into "pizza" in the local dialect. Most upper-class Europeans originally considered tomatoes to be poisonous, but at a time of almost famine, local Neapolitans started topping their humble flatbreads with tomatoes, and soon the creation became a staple of the city's cuisine. Today, there are more than 500 pizzerias in Naples, but only a fifth of them are certified by the True Neapolitan Pizza Association, an organisation created in 1984 to protect and distinguish authentic pies from the wannabes. Its criteria are based not only on the ingredients that go into the pie—including everything from the type of flour in the dough to the provenance of the cheese—but also the preparation, from the dough fermentation style to oven temperature. The Association now even holds an annual contest to judge which pizza makers are the best in the world.

So, how does one make an authentic Neapolitan pizza? To begin with, the dough must be made with Italian wheat flour, fresh brewer's **yeast**, water and salt. The dough must be rolled by hand or with a slow speed mixer; never using a **rolling pin**. However, twirling it in the air to oxygenate the dough might be best left to the professional *pizzaioli*. Pureed tomatoes are another necessary ingredient for a great pie—preferably San Marzano, which grow on the volcanic plains of Mount Vesuvius and are required for pizzas with DOC designation. Only two types of mozzarella should be used to get the designation: *fior di latte* made from cow's milk; or *mozzarella di bufala*, made from the milk of the water buffalo that live in the Campania and Lazio regions.

Of course, part of Neapolitan pizza's fame comes from how it's cooked. The dough must be no more than 3 mm thick and must bake for 60 to 90 seconds at a very high temperature inside a wood-burning oven, resulting in a pizza that's crispy but not burnt. It all sounds easy enough, but there is a reason why some pizzamakers are considered true masters: that moment just before a pie becomes a burned mistake often lies in an expert's eye. But even if you don't have DOC-qualified ingredients or a wood-burning oven, all you really need to make a good pie is flour, yeast, a can of tomatoes and cheese. Whatever ingredients you use, hopefully, the final result will be delicious.

Text adapted from an article by
Ondine Cohane. *BBC* [online] (April 17, 2020)

intangible cultural heritage: patrimoni cultural immaterial / patrimonio cultural inmaterial
basil: alfàbrega / albahaca
yeast: llevat / levadura
rolling pin: corró / rodillo

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. Why is Naples's football team mentioned in the text?

2. Find a sentence in the text that means the following: "The new dish rapidly gained popularity, becoming an essential element of Naples' gastronomy."

3. What is a *wannabe* (line 22)?

4. How does the True Neapolitan Pizza Association regulate Neapolitan pizzas? DO NOT COPY DIRECTLY FROM THE TEXT.

5. Finish the following sentence:

For a Neapolitan pizza to be considered DOC, it must have…

6. Explain IN YOUR OWN WORDS what the author means by "that moment just before a pie becomes a burned mistake often lies in an expert's eye" (lines 38-39).

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

GIVE YOURSELF A BREAK: WHY SMALL BUSINESS OWNERS NEED TO REGAIN A SENSE OF BALANCE

If we are honest, most of us could use a little more balance at some points in our busy lives. Getting the right mix between work and leisure time can have benefits for our physical and mental health. It can also improve the performance of a business, research has suggested. The pandemic saw the biggest change in working patterns for decades, perhaps centuries. There was a **surge** in home working and flexible, "hybrid" working, blending work in the office with remote work. But despite this increased flexibility, work-life balance is far from standard. This is especially true among small business owners, who often feel **compelled** to check emails outside traditional work hours or work over the weekend.

Given the fact that small and medium-sized businesses (SMEs) account for 99 % of all UK businesses, that's a lot of people who aren't switching off when perhaps they should. However, there is some encouraging news here. According to a recent survey of UK small business leaders by American Express, there is certainly a widespread understanding of the importance of work-life balance and a desire to improve it. The research is based on responses from 500 business leaders in companies with fewer than 50 employees. Eight in 10 of the executives agree that regular time off from work is important to their wellbeing. However, there is often a gap between intention and action, the research found. Almost half of those surveyed admit to feeling guilty about not spending enough time with family or friends. And one-third say that they stopped their hobbies altogether when they started running their own business. While small business owners recognise the importance of frequent breaks in improving their work-life balance and the success of their business, many of them **struggle** to find room for **downtime**.

Someone who is well aware of this pressure is Michelle Ovens, director of Small Business Saturday UK, a campaign to celebrate small business success and encourage consumers to "shop local" to support businesses in their communities. People often start a business because they want more freedom and flexibility, she says, but that freedom can be reduced by them trying to do everything in the business and running out of time in the day and gas in the tank.

There's no one-size-fits-all approach to a good work-life blend. Some may need to spend more time supporting elderly parents or young children, for example. Others may want more time for hobbies. There are also benefits for the business itself. The American Express survey found that almost eight in 10 respondents agree that regular breaks are important to being a good leader and more than half think they and their business would benefit from them spending more time away from the workplace. Time away, especially travelling abroad or getting a change of scenery, can even offer new and different perspectives that entrepreneurs can bring back to their businesses. Tips for improving your work-life balance? Set firm boundaries between work and leisure time; for yourself, colleagues, **suppliers** and customers. Also, book time off work to recharge your batteries and reduce the risk of "burnout".

Ultimately, however, what constitutes the right work-life balance will vary over time and be different for each small business owner. There isn't a magic formula and therefore we shouldn't be too hard on ourselves if our messy lives fall short of our ideals. Balance in life is a constant work in progress. It might mean work sometimes; sometimes it might mean sport, or family, or community, or rest. The key thing is to give yourself a break—we are all a work in progress here.

Text adapted from an article by
Nick Huber. *The Guardian* [online] (September 19, 2023)

surge: augment / aumento
compelled: obligat / obligado
struggle: lluitar, esforçar-se / luchar, esforzarse
downtime: temps per a desconnectar / tiempo para desconectar
supplier: proveïdor / proveedor

QUESTIONS

Answer the questions below using complete sentences. You may use fragments from the text unless specified not to do so.

[3 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Up to 0.3 points might be deducted from the total mark for lack of intelligibility in the answers provided.]

1. Using information from the first paragraph, complete the following sentence IN YOUR OWN WORDS. You can keep the word *business*.

Balancing work and leisure time…

2. Why does the author say there is a gap between intention and action?

3. What seems to be the paradox in setting up one's own business?

4. Find a sentence in the text that means the following: "Everyone has their own way of finding how to balance work and personal life."

5. How can businesses benefit from leaders spending time away from work?

6. Explain the message in the last paragraph of the article IN YOUR OWN WORDS.

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Deduction for lack of intelligibility (up to 0.3 points)	
Reading comprehension score	

Part 2: Reading comprehension

STONE AGE BABIES HAD BETTER PARENTING THAN TODAY!

Modern life may have made many things easier, but scientists say that raising a child is certainly not one of them. A study of modern **hunter-gatherer** groups that has been recently published in the journal *Developmental Psychology* suggested that our Stone Age ancestors gave their children better childcare than we do today. Researchers from Cambridge University found that children among the Mbendjele BaYaka in the Republic of Congo not only received nine hours of care a day from up to 15 different caregivers, but also that crying children were attended to by either the mother or some individual in the mother's support network more than half of the time, this way giving the mums more time to rest. The study's authors say that these findings suggest that modern parenting methods may **be at odds** with children's evolutionary programmed needs.

Dr Nikhil Chaudhary, lead author of the study, says that **insights** into these modern hunter-gatherer societies can give us a lot of detail about how humans lived in the Stone Age, which is the period in human prehistory that covers 95 % of human technological prehistory. "For most of our evolutionary history, humans have lived as hunter-gatherers," said Dr Chaudhary. "Therefore, contemporary hunter-gatherer communities such as the Mbendjele BaYaka can offer valuable clues as to whether there are certain **childbearing systems** to which infants, and their mothers, may be psychologically adapted."

The Mbendjele BaYaka are a nomadic group who live in the jungles in the North of the Central African Republic and the Republic of Congo. They are a traditional hunter-gatherer society that practices hunting, fishing, **foraging**, and honey collection for sustenance. While some Mbendjele communities have become settled and integrated with local economies, many remain mobile and continue to inhabit the forest. Those that are still nomadic live in multifamily camps of between 20 to 80 individuals, consisting of a number of huts in which families live.

Evolutionary anthropologists stayed with the Mbendjele BaYaka between March and July 2014, observing children for 12 daylight hours and recording how often they were cared for and by whom. The researchers found that between 10 and 20 different caregivers would be involved in looking after a child and that a mother's support system would respond to more than half of their baby's crying episodes. Furthermore, children were almost never left alone and spent long periods of time in physical contact with adults or receiving close care from them. When children cried they were attended to in under 10 seconds in half of cases and in under 25 seconds 90 % of the time.

Older infants and adolescents were also often involved in caregiving, which the report's authors suggest gives them experience and helps reduce anxiety around parenting. This seems to point to the fact that children may be evolutionarily prepared to expect high levels of attention and physical contact from several different caregivers. However, in Western countries the provision of high-quality child support is limited, with parenting manuals often expecting babies to spend extended periods of time playing alone.

The study also notes that Stone Age societies may have better prioritized giving mothers a rest. In Western societies, the authors write, it is common for childcare to be used only to give parents time to go to work rather than time for themselves. This means that parents have no time to rest or recover, in total contrast to the parenting practices of both modern hunter-gatherers and our Neolithic ancestors. Co-author and child psychologist Dr Annie Swanepoel says that "support for mothers also has numerous benefits for children such as reducing the risk of neglect and abuse and improving maternal wellbeing, which in turn improves maternal care." And yet, throughout the whole of human history, it seems that parents have never been under such intense pressure and faced such a lack of support as they do in modern times.

Text adapted from an article by
William Hunter. *The Daily Mail* [online] (November 13, 2023)

hunter-gatherer: caçador recol·lector / cazador-recolector
be at odds: estar en desacord / estar en desacuerdo
insight: perspectiva
childbearing system: sistema de criança / sistema de crianza
forage: recol·lectar al bosc / recolectar en el bosque

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. According to a recently published article in the journal *Developmental Psychology*, the Mbendjele BaYaka's parenting habits ☐ are against children's evolutionary needs. ☐ involve helping mothers with childcare. ☐ do not allow mothers much time to rest. ☐ put children's evolutionary needs to test.	☐	☐	☐
2. The behavior of modern hunter-gatherer societies such as the Mbendjele BaYaka ☐ can be used to understand better how our ancestors lived in the Stone Age. ☐ is not representative of how humans lived during prehistory. ☐ is the only possible way in which we can understand how humans lived in the Stone Age. ☐ cannot help us understand how humans have lived during 95 % of human prehistory.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of the following statements is TRUE according to the text? ☐ All Mbendjele communities live isolated from the rest of civilization. ☐ No Mbendjele families live with other families. ☐ Some Mbendjele communities have stopped being nomadic. ☐ All Mbendjele families continue to be nomadic.	☐	☐	☐
4. Evolutionary anthropologists that stayed with the Mbendjele BaYaka found that ☐ only mothers would take care of babies when they cried. ☐ it would take caregivers a long time to react to baby's crying episodes. ☐ no one would respond to baby's crying episodes. ☐ several caregivers would quickly take care of babies when they cried.	☐	☐	☐
5. In comparison to the Mbendjele BaYaka childcare practices, parenting in Western countries ☐ does not involve spending a lot of time with babies. ☐ always involves older infants and adolescents in caregiving. ☐ increases older infants and adolescents' anxiety around childcare. ☐ is based on employing more than ten caregivers for every child.	☐	☐	☐
6. In Western societies, childcare ☐ is exclusively used to ensure that parents have free time. ☐ is often used to ensure that parents can work. ☐ is never used to ensure that mothers can go back to work. ☐ is always used to ensure that mothers have time to rest.	☐	☐	☐
7. Providing mothers with support ☐ improves maternal care but has no effect on children. ☐ has very little effect on the mother's wellbeing. ☐ has positive effects both on mothers and children. ☐ is beneficial for children but does not improve maternal care.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following statements is FALSE? ☐ In the present day, parents have more childcare pressure and less support than ever. ☐ Parents have never been less supported and felt more childcare pressure than in modern times. ☐ As regards childcare, there is more pressure and less support in modern times than in any other historical period. ☐ Parents have had more support and less pressure for childcare in modern times than in any other historical period.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

WHAT YOUR JEANS CAN (AND DO) HIDE

Paris, Milan, New York… These are some of the world's most prestigious fashion **catwalks**. There, young women and men graciously parade to impress elite guests and TV watchers with the surprising, fabulous creativity of the most renowned fashion designers. Yet, regardless of the amazing costs of such shows, there is a hidden price that Mother Nature pays (and which is not included in the price tag).

Let's start with the case of innocent blue jeans: it takes around 7,500 litres of water to make just one single pair. Know what this means? It is equivalent to the amount of water the average person drinks over a period of seven years. That's just one of the many startling facts that emerge from recent environmental research, and which show the real cost of staying fashionable.

When we think of industries that have a harmful effect on the environment, manufacturing, energy, transport and even food production come to mind. But the fashion industry is considered by the UN Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) to be the second most polluting industry in the world. In fact, according to UNCTAD, some 93 billion cubic metres of water—enough to meet the needs of five million people—are used by the fashion industry annually, and around half a million tons of microfibre, which is the equivalent of 3 million barrels of oil, are now being dumped into the ocean every year.

As for carbon emissions, the industry is responsible for more than all international flights and maritime shipping combined. "The dominant business model in the sector is that of 'fast fashion', whereby consumers are offered constantly changing collections at low prices, and encouraged to frequently buy and discard clothes," UNCTAD further explains. And it warns that the trend is responsible for "a plethora of negative social, economic and environmental impacts and, with clothing production doubling between 2000 and 2014, it is crucially important to ensure that clothes are produced as ethically and sustainably as possible."

For its part, UN Environment provides more conservative figures. It says that considering cotton production, manufacture, transport and washing, it takes 3,781 litres of water to make one pair of jeans. Furthermore, the process equates to around 33.4 kilograms of carbon equivalent emitted, like driving 111 kilometres or watching 246 hours of TV on a big screen. Even just washing our clothes releases plastic microfibres and other pollutants into the environment, contaminating our oceans and drinking water, and entering the food chain, UN Environment warns, and adds that around 20 % of global industrial water pollution is from **dyeing** and textile treatment.

Some studies estimate that the average garment is worn ten times before being discarded. Demand for clothing is projected to rise 2 % a year—but the number of times we wear a garment has dropped one third compared to the early 2000s. This waste costs money and the value of natural resources. Of the total fibre input used for clothing, 87 % is incinerated or sent to **landfill**. Overall, one garbage truck of textiles is landfilled or incinerated every second. The issue is so alarming that 10 different UN organisations joined forces through an Alliance for Sustainable Fashion, which seeks to halt the environmentally and socially destructive practices of fashion. Elisa Tonda, from UN Environment, explained this urgency: "The global production of clothing and footwear generates 8 % of the world's greenhouse gas emissions and, with manufacturing concentrated in Asia, the industry is mainly reliant on hard coal and natural gas to generate electricity. If we carry on with a business-as-usual approach, the greenhouse gas emissions from the industry will rise by almost 50 % by 2030."

Fashion today is about obsession with outward image and appearance. Rarely do we as consumers consider what's on the inside: the environmental cost. Now that we know, who will dare to take the bull by the horns?

Text adapted from an article by
Baher Kamal. *Meer* [online] (1 April, 2019)

catwalk: passarel·la / pasarela
dye: tenyir / teñir
landfill: abocador / vertedero

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. What is NOT included in the price tag in fashion? ☐ The environmental cost of the clothes. ☐ The cost of the fashion show. ☐ The salary of the designers and models. ☐ The creativity of the designer clothes.	☐	☐	☐
2. The fashion industry is considered highly polluting ☐ because of its high consumption of water. ☐ because it spills tons of petrol into the oceans. ☐ and so, five million people cannot have access to clean water. ☐ because of its energy consumption.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to UNCTAD, fast fashion ☐ has changed the way we buy and use clothes. ☐ clothes are being manufactured in a sustainable way. ☐ has no impact on the economy or the environment. ☐ produces more carbon emissions than planes or ships.	☐	☐	☐
4. The meaning of *plethora*, in "a <u>plethora</u> of negative social, economic and environmental impacts," is ☐ a large amount of. ☐ an indefinite quantity. ☐ a small number of. ☐ a group of.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following is NOT true? ☐ Most water pollution all over the world comes from the textile industry. ☐ Water plays an important role in the process of making a pair of jeans. ☐ Making one pair of jeans pollutes as much as driving over 100 km. ☐ Microfibres enter the water we drink every time we wash our clothes.	☐	☐	☐
6. In the early 2000s, ☐ people wore their clothes many more times than they do now. ☐ people disposed of their clothes after wearing them ten times. ☐ sending one lorry full of textiles to the landfill cost a lot of money. ☐ there was a higher production of new clothes.	☐	☐	☐
7. The main aim of the Alliance for Sustainable Fashion is ☐ to end the negative social and environmental effects of the fashion industry. ☐ to prevent Asian countries from using fossil fuels in the fashion industry. ☐ to increase the global production of clothing and footwear. ☐ to continue with the same fashion business model we have now.	☐	☐	☐
8. With the final paragraph, the author suggests that ☐ it is very difficult to solve the environmental problem associated with fashion. ☐ consumers should take direct action to protect the environment. ☐ for some people, their appearance is more important than the environment. ☐ the environmental cost of fashion needs to be known more widely.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

HOW AI CAN MAKE CANCER TREATMENT MORE EQUITABLE

Many are aware of the Cancer Moonshot—an ambitious and hopeful initiative of the US government to reduce cancer-related death rates by 50 % by the year 2047. It will take an army to achieve this goal, composed of the brightest minds and biggest hearts in healthcare, science, and technology. Many parties will be involved—the federal government, healthcare providers, researchers, patients, caregivers, and advocates, among others in both the public and private sectors. One of the most pivotal tools that can help **propel** us toward this high-minded goal is artificial intelligence (AI), which is poised to revolutionize cancer treatment.

The Moonshot plan identifies five priority areas, all of which AI has the potential to **enhance**. Two areas in particular lend themselves to AI: the call to deliver the latest cancer innovations to patients and communities and the aim of enhancing the oncology model to place cancer patients at the center of decision-making.

The history of cancer care has been a continual process of refining treatments through innovative processes and solutions. While these advancements represented significant **strides** toward personalizing cancer care, it has been a slow and historically inequitable process, with minority populations not having as much access to advanced diagnosis or care tools. AI has many distinct advantages over prior technologies. It continuously improves when trained on enormous datasets, making it both more accurate than prior methods and enabling it to distinguish subtleties across demographics, age, race, etc. It is relatively low-cost to **deploy**, runs instantly, and can be made accessible via cloud computing, which is now available in all populated continents. These advantages make AI a scalable solution that can uniquely optimize patients' treatment plans across the globe, delivering efficient and personalized cancer care to a substantially larger population than prior technology.

One of the most promising developments is the rise of AI-enabled tests that can simultaneously prognosticate how tumors will progress and predict treatment benefits. These tests use unique deep-learning algorithms that assess digital images from patient biopsies and couple them with the patient's clinical data. Clinicians can then take this information and build a personalized treatment plan; in some cases, this even means avoiding unnecessary treatments where the side effects outweigh the benefits for the patient.

The Moonshot initiative to deliver innovation to patients and communities is intended for *all* patients, not a select few. The generalizability of AI relies on the amount and variety of data that is used to build it. When AI is trained on datasets that properly represent diverse patient populations, it has the potential to provide greater insights for all, including historically underrepresented populations. In addition to helping bridge the gap in health disparities, AI can also serve as a conduit for increased communication between patients and clinicians by positioning patients at the center of decision-making about their care. How? By providing patients with more information about their illness, and therefore increasing confidence in their treatment plan. This confidence is a cornerstone of effective cancer treatment.

Patients must live with treatment decisions, both physically and mentally. Studies show that one key to treating cancer is for clinicians to create a patient-centered plan that incorporates multifaceted aspects of a person's life. With AI-enabled tests, the patient and clinician can review the data together to align on whether the therapy selected is worth the adverse effects that could influence the patient's lifestyle. In contrast, a lack of understanding of the options and benefits of the therapy can leave patients overwhelmed and under-committed to the treatment. This can decrease adherence to treatments and have detrimental effects on survival rates.

Text adapted from an article by
Andre Esteva. *Time* [online] (October 18, 2023)

propel: impulsar
enhance: millorar / mejorar
stride: avenç / progreso
deploy: utilitzar / utilizar

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per a la correcció		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The Cancer Moonshot ☐ is a project that will definitely reduce cancer-related death rates by 50 %. ☐ is a project that will involve the army and the brightest minds. ☐ is a US government-led project to reduce cancer death rates. ☐ is a project that will only involve brilliant scientists.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, artificial intelligence (AI) ☐ will help the private cancer treatments. ☐ will help reach a modest objective. ☐ can help researchers find a cure. ☐ can help improve cancer treatments.	☐	☐	☐
3. The two areas of the Cancer Moonshot plan that the article focuses on are: ☐ reaching all kinds of patients and empowering them to make decisions. ☐ prioritizing specific communities and placing cancer patients first. ☐ enhancing cancer treatments and using artificial intelligence to a lesser extent. ☐ implementing innovative treatments and prioritizing elderly patients.	☐	☐	☐
4. Although cancer care has witnessed important scientific advancements, ☐ treatments have been personalized among minority populations. ☐ not everyone has had access to proper diagnosis to the same extent. ☐ they have considerably slowed down certain types of treatments. ☐ all patients have had the chance to receive personalized treatments.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following statements is NOT true according to the text? ☐ AI is fast and available through cloud computing. ☐ AI can explore large sets of data to find patterns. ☐ AI can offer personalized plans to more patients. ☐ AI cannot be trained with large patient datasets.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to the text, why are AI-enabled tests a promising development? ☐ Because they can prevent cancer treatment side effects. ☐ Because they can predict patients' clinical data. ☐ Because they can diagnose tumors more effectively. ☐ Because they can predict how tumors might develop.	☐	☐	☐
7. How does Cancer Moonshot increase patients' confidence in their treatment plan? ☐ By ensuring patients receive more information. ☐ By providing patients with innovative treatments. ☐ By analyzing data from underrepresented populations. ☐ By controlling patients' access to AI-generated tools.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to the text, patient-centered plans ☐ overwhelm the majority of patients. ☐ make patients commit to treatment. ☐ make certain treatments less effective. ☐ allow clinicians to influence patients' life.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

DANCE LIKE YOU'RE IN *BRIDGERTON*, PLAY *SQUID GAME*: WHY ARE IMMERSIVE EXPERIENCES BOOMING?

Welcome to the age of immersion. Last summer saw the launch of *Stranger Things* and *Tomb Raider* "experiences" in London, and an *Alice in Wonderland* "immersive cocktail experience" in Sheffield. By September, fans were able to re-enact Netflix's *Squid Game* at Immersive Gamebox venues in London, Essex and Manchester. In the coming weeks, London will also host an experience based on the horror franchise *Saw*, while Cheshire will see thousands visit *Harry Potter: A Forbidden Forest Experience*. And that's without mentioning the boom in immersive art experiences, the most recent of which — *Frameless* — has just opened in central London.

The **buzzword** everyone will tell you is *immersive-interactive*. As a small number of companies dominate the cultural landscape, it seems that each wants to build its own mini-Disneyland. But why are we suddenly obsessed with stepping into the screen? In an increasingly dark world, are we seeking escapism? Or do we just want loads of cool Instagrammable pictures?

"It's really driven by a desire to find new ways to connect with our members and fans around the world," says Greg Lombardo, head of live experiences at Netflix. The streaming service lost almost a million subscribers between April and July last year after subscription fees increased by £1 a month. The company is seemingly diversifying its income — tickets to *Stranger Things: The Experience* cost £52 per person, £62 on a Saturday. "We really wanted to offer people a chance to feel like they were the hero of that story, that they had the powers," Lombardo says. Guests are divided into different coloured teams and allocated a hand gesture they can use to remotely crush cans, unlock doors and battle monsters as they wander *Stranger Things*-inspired sets. The experience features exclusive **footage** from the show's actors as well as live actors who interact with the audience. Why do more and more people seek this out? Lombardo says the *Stranger Things* experience attracts all ages, while guests of *The Queen's Ball* — a party based on Netflix's hit show *Bridgerton* — are 87 % women aged 18-45. It is a prom for adults and some people even join fan-created social media groups to discuss how to prepare for the event.

Elizabeth Cohen is a communications professor at West Virginia University who studies audience responses to different types of media. She says fans have always wanted to enter fictional worlds but the internet allowed them to get their voices heard. "I think the internet made 'geeking out' more mainstream," she says. "And what is mainstream is also more profitable." Cohen says immersion is psychologically gratifying because people connect with others, relieve stress and get creative. Just as we can both watch and play sports, Cohen says we can now watch and play with shows. Does this mean we're big babies? "Sports fans often go to great lengths to dress up in support of their team, put on face paint, collect memorabilia," Cohen says. "But I've never heard anyone suggest that sports fandom was infantilising, so why is there a double standard for pop culture?"

Millions have been invested into immersion, but some experiences are rougher around the edges than others. Many last an hour — meaning prices seem high when you consider a whole day ticket to Disneyland Paris can cost just £50. It remains to be seen whether they will attract repeat customers, or if they'll quickly become associated with the forced fun of work socials and first dates. Or perhaps high inflation will only increase the desire to step into the screen. If you think about shows like *Stranger Things* or *Bridgerton*, they are escapist stories. They allow us to forget, for a moment, things that might be more challenging in our lives.

Text adapted from an article by Amelia Tait.
The Guardian [online] (October 14, 2022)

buzzword: paraula de moda / palabra de moda
footage: escenes filmades / escenas filmadas

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

		Espai per al corrector/a		
		Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1.	In this text, the word *immersion* (and *immersive*) refers to ☐ social gatherings where people can meet famous pop culture Instagrammers. ☐ leisure experiences where people can interact with series or movies scenes. ☐ social experiences where people can meet and talk to Disney characters. ☐ leisure experiences where people can go on spectacular roller-coasters.	☐	☐	☐
2.	In the second paragraph, the author of the text ☐ wonders why Disneyland is opening new franchises for adolescents. ☐ wonders why adolescents are obsessed with movies and series. ☐ wonders if immersion experiences make young adults become childish. ☐ wonders why immersion experiences are popular now.	☐	☐	☐
3.	Netflix ☐ has incorporated new ways of making profits. ☐ is making profits only through subscriptions. ☐ is offering its subscribers monthly discounts. ☐ is contacting *Stranger Things* fans around the world.	☐	☐	☐
4.	Which of the following is NOT true about the *Stranger Things* experience? ☐ Entrance fees are cheaper on weekdays. ☐ Guests can walk around sets inspired by the series. ☐ Only the show's actors take part in it. ☐ Guests can pretend to fight against monsters.	☐	☐	☐
5.	*The Queen's Ball* ☐ attracts female *Bridgerton* fans of several ages. ☐ has boosted the number of *Bridgerton* viewers. ☐ is especially popular with men over 50. ☐ requires attendees to meet on a social media group first.	☐	☐	☐
6.	Elizabeth Cohen thinks that ☐ immersive experiences can become stressful for guests. ☐ the fans' contact with the fictional world has become normal. ☐ fictional immersive experiences should be based on sports. ☐ the fans' participation in immersive experiences should be streamed.	☐	☐	☐
7.	Why does there seem to be a double standard for pop culture? ☐ Because immersion tends to be criticised more often than sports fandom. ☐ Because immersion experiences are never considered childish. ☐ Because people tend to make fun of sports fans who dress up. ☐ Because pop culture fandom helps people connect with their heroes.	☐	☐	☐
8.	Immersion experiences ☐ will become symbolic of first dates and work gatherings. ☐ have come to stay. ☐ are becoming more expensive due to increasing inflation. ☐ give people the chance to escape from real difficulties.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

HOW GLOBAL CLIMATE TARGETS ARE SET AND WHAT THEY MEAN

How much warming can the world bear? This question was one of the main issues discussed at the past UN climate change **summit**, known as COP26, in Glasgow, Scotland.

Six years ago, when countries came together in Paris for the COP21 summit, at which the Paris climate accord was shaped, they committed to limit the global average temperature rise to below 2 degrees Celsius (2C) above pre-industrial levels. However, even though the 2015 agreement set 2C as the minimum, it also suggested that countries should push for a more ambitious goal: 1.5C. But not all countries agreed, with oil and gas producing Saudi Arabia among the countries complaining about the more ambitious targets. Some officials argued that countries should maintain the less ambitious target so that they were not set up for failure.

A preliminary draft of the COP26 agreement reaffirmed the Paris agreement's goal: limit Earth's warming to well below 2C and **pursue** a target of 1.5C. But it did not commit to meeting the 1.5C mark. The difference between the two targets may seem small, but they represent different levels of effort for countries trying to limit their carbon footprints, and very divergent **outcomes** for the planet. A study released by the UK Met Office, Britain's national weather service, found that 1 billion people could face heat stress, a potentially fatal combination of heat and humidity, if temperatures rise by 2C.

The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC), a UN body responsible for evaluating the scientific research on climate change, has warned that even an increase of 1.5C of global warming would result in significant differences, with increased heat waves and short cold seasons. The IPCC has found that an extreme heat event that would have occurred once per decade without human influence, would happen 4 times a decade with 1.5C of warming, and with 2C of warming there would be 5 extreme heat events.

The IPCC has also noted that the relative sea level will probably continue to rise throughout the 21st century and beyond. If temperatures do not increase more than 1.5C, over the next 2000 years sea levels could rise by as much as 3 meters, but it could be double that if temperatures grow by 2C, and be even worse if ice sheets in Antarctica become destabilized. Although a 2C increase would result in the number of people living in areas affected by extreme heat stress rising from 68 million today to 1 billion, a 4C rise could affect half of Earth's population.

In their latest report, the IPCC estimated that the world would probably reach the 1.5C mark by 2040. Global temperatures would initially be 1.5C higher by the middle of the century, and then fall as emissions were cut further. This could avoid some of the worst outcomes. If nothing is done, the world might see a rise of 4.4C by the year 2100—with an extreme impact on life on Earth.

Text adapted from an article on *The Washington Post* (November 10, 2021)

summit: cimera / cumbre
pursue: perseguir
outcome: resultat / resultado

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

		Espai per al corrector/a		
		Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1.	At the COP21 summit, countries ☐ agreed to limit Paris global climate change. ☐ agreed to limit the increase in global temperatures to 2C. ☐ agreed to discuss oil and gas production. ☐ agreed to return to pre-industrial temperature levels.	☐	☐	☐
2.	The most ambitious target at the Paris climate summit ☐ was agreed to by all countries in the world. ☐ was signed by Saudi Arabia. ☐ was considered too difficult to reach by a number of countries. ☐ would still result in the death of 1 billion people.	☐	☐	☐
3.	The 1.5C mark ☐ was a firm commitment at the COP26 summit in Glasgow. ☐ represents a major difference with respect to the 2C target. ☐ guarantees the maximum reduction in a country's carbon footprint. ☐ will have no effect on a country's carbon footprint.	☐	☐	☐
4.	What prediction has the IPCC made? ☐ There will be 5 extreme heat events in the next decade if no action is taken. ☐ Heat waves will become more frequent in the future. ☐ Extreme heat events will become increasingly rare if the 1.5C mark is met. ☐ Extreme heat events will happen once a year even if there is no rise in temperature.	☐	☐	☐
5.	Which of the following is TRUE? ☐ The relative sea level will probably keep on falling in this century. ☐ Sea levels could decrease by more than 3 meters over the next 2000 years. ☐ If ice sheets in Antarctica become destabilized, sea levels will rise. ☐ If temperatures rise by 2C, 2 billion people will die.	☐	☐	☐
6.	The number of people living in areas of extreme heat stress ☐ might rise to a million if the temperature increases 2C. ☐ might rise to a hundred million if the temperature increases 4C. ☐ doesn't reach a hundred million today. ☐ will represent most of the world's population with a 4C rise.	☐	☐	☐
7.	What are the IPCC estimates for the remainder of the 21st century? ☐ Global warming would not be recorded until 2040. ☐ Temperatures might start declining after 2050 if action is taken. ☐ Temperatures might keep on increasing after 2050 even if emissions are cut. ☐ Global warming might be stopped before the middle of the century.	☐	☐	☐
8.	What does the IPCC predict will happen if no climate action is taken now? ☐ Life on Earth will remain unaffected. ☐ Temperatures might rise by more than 4C by the end of the century. ☐ Global warming effects will not be as serious as expected. ☐ There will be a 4.4C temperature rise by 2040.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

Part 2: Reading comprehension

SOCCER IS THE WORLD'S MOST POPULAR SPORT. BUT WHO INVENTED IT?

Soccer is by far the world's most popular sport, and for good reason—beloved by at least 265 million people worldwide, it's easy to play in a random yard or field, and viewers instantly relate to the players racing across stadiums in different parts of the world. But if you're looking for the earliest ancestor of all that running, kicking, and cooperating, be ready to turn back your watch. Here's what you need to know about soccer's ancient origins and why it's the world's favorite sport today.

The Chinese were the first to kick balls into nets for sport in the third century B.C., and the game known globally as football was formalized in England in the 19th century. But the predecessor of most modern ball games can be found in the Americas. "The idea of the team sport was invented in Mesoamerica," says Mary Miller, a professor of the history of art at Yale University who has studied extensive evidence of the sport. In Mesoamerica, the vast historical region spanning from Mexico to Costa Rica, civilizations flourished well before Columbus "discovered" them, and many of them played a sport that involved a heavy ball made from a substance derived from tree resin.

It is unclear exactly where the game was invented, but it was popular across Mesoamerican cultures like the Teotihuacanos, Aztecs, and Maya beginning about 3,000 years ago. Its name varied—*ullamaliztli* in Aztec, *pok-ta-pok* or *pitz* in Maya. So did its rules, which included moves such as keeping the ball in play by bumping it with body parts or using racquets or bats.

Many of these games were played with rubber balls, which still exist in the archaeological record. Other evidence of game play ranges from ceramic vessels to more than 1,300 large stone courts that can be found across the region.

Aztec players bounced the ball back and forth between teams using only their hips and buttocks (feet or hands were off limits). They tried to hit the back wall of their opponents' courts with just one bounce, often sustaining life-threatening injuries when they were hit with the hard, heavy ball. If a player managed to get it into a high ring on the opposing team's side, it was an automatic win—and a major honor for the winner.

Though it was played as an everyday **pickup** sport, much like soccer or basketball, this ball game also held a **sacred** place in religion and warfare for Mesoamerican cultures. Aztec kings reportedly played it as a substitute for war, gaining ruling rights or diffusing diplomatic dramas with a game of ball. In Maya and Veracruz cultures, the stakes were even higher: the losers of some ritual games were sacrificed.

Though other cultures like Native Americans and Indigenous Australians played similar games, the modern sport that some people know as soccer—and many others know as football—was created in British schools. Although they had played variations of the game informally for centuries, the sport became formalized in the 19th century.

In the mid 19th century, developments in transportation, labor, and technology gave people the leisure and means to travel to competitive matches on mown lawn fields. By the 1840s, a variety of British schools created their own standards of play, making it possible to hold tournaments among players who all knew the same rules.

As the sport's popularity **ballooned**, players banded together in the London Football Association. By the 1870s, some teams had begun to recruit widely, secretly paying working-class league members. Upper-class footballers wanted the sport to remain amateur, but in 1885, they finally agreed to allow professional players, enabling a further boom in the sport. By 1904, the sport was so popular it had gone international, and the Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) began that same year.

Soccer's success skyrocketed from there. After the sport debuted in the 1908 Olympic Games and the first FIFA World Cup in 1930, professional soccer flourished. Today, FIFA remains the sport's governing body, **raking** in $755.5 million in 2021 alone.

But the heart of the sport has always been on the field, where everyone from small children to **seasoned** pro athletes can enjoy the action. Soccer's spirit is alive and well both in modern incarnations of the ball game and the millions of amateur and pro players who run and kick their way down an official or **makeshift** soccer pitch every day.

Text adapted from an article by Erin Blakemore.
The National Geographic [online] (November 17, 2022)

pickup: espontani / espontáneo
sacred: sagrat / sagrado
to balloon: incrementar
raking: recollint / recogiendo
seasoned: experimentats / experimentados
makeshift: improvisat / improvisado

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following statements is NOT true? ☐ Football as we know it was not formalized until the 19th century. ☐ Mesoamerican civilizations owe ball games to Columbus. ☐ In the third century B.C. the Chinese already played ball games. ☐ Modern ball games have their origin in Mesoamerica.	☐	☐	☐
2. The rules of a sport that involved a heavy rubber ball ☐ varied across Mesoamerican cultures. ☐ only included the use of body parts. ☐ excluded the use of racquets entirely. ☐ were formalized by Columbus and his men.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of the following statements is TRUE? ☐ Aztec players threw the ball back and forth. ☐ Aztec players could hit the hard, heavy ball with all their body parts. ☐ Aztec players used hard, heavy balls that could even kill them. ☐ Aztec players had to get the ball into the opposing team's ring several times to win.	☐	☐	☐
4. The ball game was sacred to Mesoamerican cultures and ☐ all their players were sacrificed at the end of the game. ☐ often created diplomatic conflict among Aztec kings. ☐ was used by Aztec kings for good luck before going to war. ☐ sometimes replaced battles and helped resolve conflicts.	☐	☐	☐
5. 19th century British schools ☐ are responsible for modern football or soccer. ☐ never agreed to a common set of rules to play football. ☐ only played football informally and uncompetitively. ☐ are responsible for technological developments in football.	☐	☐	☐
6. By 1870 ☐ all football players were professional. ☐ some working-class football players were paid. ☐ upper-class football players became professional. ☐ no football players were amateurs.	☐	☐	☐
7. The popularity of football as a sport ☐ had nothing to do with the professionalization of its players. ☐ can be attributed to the creation of the FIFA. ☐ resulted in its internationalization. ☐ was the consequence of only allowing amateur players.	☐	☐	☐
8. Although professional football has flourished since the early 20th century, ☐ the essence of the sport is in the fact that amateurs and pro athletes can play it together. ☐ the essence of the sport is in the fact that it raises a lot of money worldwide. ☐ the essence of the sport is in the fact that it is played only by pro athletes. ☐ the essence of the sport is in the fact that it can be played by anyone.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

ASSATEAGUE'S WILD HORSES

Assateague Island is a 60 km long barrier island located on the East Coast of the United States, facing the Atlantic Ocean. The northern two-thirds of the island is in Maryland while the southern third is in Virginia. The Maryland section contains the majority of Assateague Island National Seashore; the Virginia section contains Chincoteague National Wildlife Refuge. The island contains numerous marshes, bays and pristine beaches, and is a habitat for migratory birds and a wildlife sanctuary.

Assateague, however, is best known for its **herds** of wild horses. The "wild" horses on Assateague are actually feral animals, meaning that they are descendants of domestic animals that have reverted to a wild state. Horses tough enough to survive the scorching heat, abundant mosquitoes, stormy weather and poor quality food found on this remote, windswept barrier island, which have formed a unique wild horse society.

Local folklore describes the Assateague horses as survivors of a shipwreck off the Virginia coast. While this dramatic tale of struggle and survival is popular, there are no records yet that confirm it. The most plausible explanation is that they are the descendants of horses that were brought to barrier islands like Assateague in the late 17th century by mainland owners to avoid fencing laws and taxation of livestock.

The horses are split into two main herds, one on the Virginia side and one on the Maryland side of Assateague. They are separated by a fence at the Virginia/Maryland State line. These herds have divided themselves into bands of two to twelve animals and each band occupies a home range. The National Park Service manages the Maryland herd. The Chincoteague Volunteer Fire Company owns and manages the Virginia herd, which is allowed to graze on Chincoteague National Wildlife Refuge through a special use permit issued by the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service. The permit restricts the size of the herd to approximately 150 adult animals in order to protect the other natural resources of the wildlife refuge. It is the Virginia herd which is often referred to as the "Chincoteague" ponies.

Many visitors first learn about the Assateague horses from Marguerite Henry's famous book *Misty of Chincoteague*. The story takes place during a traditional Chincoteague festival called "Pony Penning." On the last Wednesday of July, the Virginia herd of horses is rounded up and made to swim from Assateague Island to nearby Chincoteague Island. On the following day most of the young **foals** are auctioned off. Proceeds from the sale benefit the Chincoteague Volunteer Fire Department.

Assateague's horses are beautiful, tough, and wild. They have learned to survive in a harsh environment. Feeding and/or petting them is detrimental to both visitors and horses. Horses can get sick from human food. Those that learn to come up to the road to beg for food are often hit and killed by cars. Visitors are kicked, bitten and knocked down every year as a direct result of getting too close to the wild horses. Treating wild horses like tame animals takes away the wildness that makes them special. The park rangers warn visitors that they must protect their family by respecting the horses: people must give the horses the space they need to be wild.

There are few places in the United States where you can view wild horses. Due to their complex social structure the Assateague horses display a wide range of unique behaviors. Visitors can take advantage of the opportunity to view these horses in a natural habitat. With careful management, the wild horses will continue to thrive on Assateague Island and provide enjoyment to thousands of nature enthusiasts, photographers, and people who just love horses!

Text adapted from an article on *NPS.gov* and *Wikipedia*

herd: ramat / manada
foal: cavall de menys d'un any / caballo de menos de un año

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

		Espai per al corrector/a		
		Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1.	The horses we see in Assateague Island are described as "feral". This means that they ☐ descend from domestic animals that have become wild over the years. ☐ are domestic animals whose owners have freed them in the island. ☐ were wild horses that now have been domesticated. ☐ have always lived free on this island.	☐	☐	☐
2.	These horses are unique because they ☐ are extremely small. ☐ are native to the Americas. ☐ have adapted to very tough living conditions. ☐ must live in very frigid temperatures.	☐	☐	☐
3.	How did the horses arrive on the island? ☐ They have always lived there. ☐ They migrated naturally from the mainland. ☐ They were travelling on a ship that sank off the coast. ☐ They were most probably taken there to avoid paying tax.	☐	☐	☐
4.	Which of the following sentences is NOT true? ☐ The National Park Service is in charge of all the horses on the island. ☐ There is a herd of horses in each state. ☐ There's a variable number of horses in each band. ☐ A fence along the state line keeps the herds apart.	☐	☐	☐
5.	The U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service ☐ owns the Chincoteague Volunteer Fire Company. ☐ issues a permit allowing the horses to feed on its grounds. ☐ is in charge of the Virginia herd of ponies. ☐ won't allow ponies to feed in order to protect the wildlife refuge.	☐	☐	☐
6.	The Pony Penning festival ☐ is organized by the National Park Service. ☐ is a local festival in which horses swim to a nearby island to be sold. ☐ was created after Margaret Henry described it in her book. ☐ takes place in many other places around the US on the same day in July.	☐	☐	☐
7.	The Assateague horses ☐ usually hit or bite other wild animals that get too near them. ☐ have become accustomed to eating human food. ☐ have adapted to their environment and developed a complex social structure. ☐ are quite tame and never bite humans.	☐	☐	☐
8.	Visitors to Assateague Island ☐ know that this is the only place in the USA where they can see horses in the wild. ☐ must treat the horses as wild animals and respect their habitat. ☐ can feed the wild horses with a special permit. ☐ almost never see horses because they are extremely rare.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

GINKGO TREES NEARLY WENT EXTINCT. HERE'S HOW WE SAVED THESE 'LIVING FOSSILS'

On the streets of Manhattan and Washington, D.C., in neighborhoods in Seoul and parks in Paris, ginkgo trees are gradually losing their bright yellow leaves in reaction to the first frigid winter air. Such leaf drop, gradual at first, and then suddenly, carpets streets with golden, **fan-shaped** leaves every year. But around the world, scientists are documenting evidence of the event happening later and later, a possible indication of climate change.

"People would ask us, 'When should I come out to see peak ginkgo color?' and we would say the 21st of October," says David Carr, the director of the University of Virginia's Blandy Experimental Farm, which is home to The Ginkgo Grove, an arboretum with over 300 ginkgo trees.

Carr, who's been at The Ginkgo Grove since 1997, says the trend toward warmer falls and later-in-the-season leaf color is a noticeable one. "Nowadays it seems to be closer to the end of October or the first week of November." But this is not the first time the ancient species has confronted major climate changes. And the story of ginkgos is not the familiar one of human carelessness with nature.

Thanks to fossils found in North Dakota, scientists know the species *Ginkgo biloba* has existed in its current form for 60 million years; it has genetically similar **ancestors** dating back 170 million years to the Jurassic Period. In its nearly 200-million-year timeline, "they gradually were reduced. They almost went extinct. Then they have this renewal that comes from the association with humans," says Peter Crane, author of the book *Ginkgo* and one of the world's foremost Ginkgo experts.

The International Union for the Conservation of Nature, an organization that tracks the survival of Earth's species, classifies the tree as endangered in the wild. Only a few rare populations are thought to potentially exist in China. When you walk on those bright golden fans **scattered** on some rain-darkened sidewalk this fall, you're having a close encounter with a rare thing—a species that humans rescued from natural **oblivion** and spread around the world. It's "such a great evolutionary story," Crane says, "and also a great cultural story."

On Earth today there are five different types of plants that produce **seeds**: flowering plants, the most abundant; conifers, plants with cones; gnetales, a diverse group of about 70 species including desert **shrubs**, tropical trees, and vines; cycads, another ancient group of palm-like trees—and the lonely ginkgo. In the plant kingdom's *Ginkgoaceae* family, there is just one living species, *Ginkgo biloba*.

Scientists think the world once contained many different species of ginkgo too. Fossilized plants found in a coal mine in central China that date back 170 million years show ginkgo-like trees with only slight variations in the shape of their leaves and number of seeds. The species was thought to be extinct in the wild until the early 20th century, when a supposedly undomesticated population was found in western China. A paper published in 2004 disagreed, suggesting instead that those trees had been cultivated by ancient Buddhist monks—but suggesting that other ginkgo **havens** might be found in the southwest of the country. Then in 2012, a new paper cited evidence that a wild population did indeed exist in southwestern China's Dalou Mountains. Those wild populations are a potential treasure of diversity for **crossbreeding** as scientists seek to improve the genetic composition of the domesticated species.

Crane is not worried about the future of the ginkgo, though. The popularity of the species will help it survive. "Though its status in the wild may be precarious and difficult to access, it is a plant that is unlikely to ever go extinct," Crane says.

Text adapted from an article by Sarah Gibbens.
The National Geographic [online] (November 30, 2020)

fan-shaped: en forma de ventall / en forma de abanico
ancestors: avantpassats / antepasados
scattered: escampats / esparcidos
oblivion: oblit / olvido
seeds: llavors / semillas
shrubs: arbustos
havens: refugis / refugios
crossbreeding: encreuament genètic / cruce genético

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. According to scientists, ☐ ginkgo trees losing their leaves later is possibly causing climate change. ☐ ginkgo trees no longer lose their leaves in the winter due to climate change. ☐ ginkgo trees losing their leaves later in the year is possibly due to climate change. ☐ ginkgo trees have gone from losing their leaves gradually to suddenly as a consequence of climate change.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which one of the sentences is FALSE? ☐ Ginkgos almost went extinct because of human carelessness with nature. ☐ Ginkgos have confronted major climatic changes before. ☐ Ginkgos have existed as a species for millions of years. ☐ Ginkgos have overcome extinction thanks to association with humans.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the International Union for the Conservation of Nature, ☐ ginkgos are found in vast numbers in the wild. ☐ practically no ginkgos exist in the wild. ☐ ginkgos no longer grow in the wild. ☐ ginkgos are a species that can only be found in the wild.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which one of the sentences is TRUE? ☐ Ginkgos are flowering plants. ☐ Ginkgos are palm-like trees. ☐ Ginkgos have several different species. ☐ Ginkgos produce seeds.	☐	☐	☐
5. Fossilized plants confirm that ☐ ginkgos have actually changed very little through time. ☐ currently extinct species of ginkgos did not produce seeds. ☐ millions of years ago ginkgos had the exact same number of seeds and shape of leaves as today. ☐ different species of ginkgos were once common on all continents.	☐	☐	☐
6. The undomesticated population of ginkgos found in western China ☐ showed that this species of trees only grows in the wild. ☐ was later destroyed by a forest fire. ☐ went extinct in the early 20th century. ☐ might have been cultivated by monks.	☐	☐	☐
7. Today domesticated ginkgo trees ☐ are common around the world. ☐ are only found in western China. ☐ belong to one of five related species. ☐ lose their leaves in mid-summer.	☐	☐	☐
8. Crane is not worried about the future of the ginkgo because ☐ it is difficult to find in the wild. ☐ it is a symbol of prosperity in China. ☐ it is a popular species of tree. ☐ its status in the wild is uncertain.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

SHE WAS SOLD TO A STRANGER SO HER FAMILY COULD EAT AS AFGANISTAN CRUMBLES

Parwana Malik, a 9-year-old girl with dark eyes and rosy cheeks, **giggles** with her friends as they play jump rope in a dusty clearing. But Parwana's laughter disappears as she returns home, where she's reminded of her **fate**: she's being sold to a stranger as a child bride.

The man who wants to buy Parwana says he's 55, but to her, he's "an old man" with white eyebrows and a thick white beard. She worries he will beat her and force her to work in his house. But her parents say they have no choice. For four years, her family has lived in an Afghan displacement camp in the northwestern Badghis province, surviving on humanitarian aid and **menial work** earning a few dollars a day. But life has only gotten harder since the Taliban took power in Afghanistan.

As international aid **dries up** and the country's economy collapses, they're unable to afford basic necessities like food. Her father already sold her 12-year-old sister to someone else several months ago. Parwana is one of many young Afghan girls sold into marriage as the country's humanitarian crisis deepens. Hunger has pushed some families to make heartbreaking decisions, especially as the brutal winter approaches. "Day by day, the numbers are increasing of families selling their children," said Mohammad Naiem Nazem, a human rights activist in Badghis. "Lack of food, lack of work, and the families feel they have to do this."

Abdul Malik, Parwana's father, can't sleep at night. Ahead of the sale, he's "broken" with guilt, shame and worry. He had tried to avoid selling her and his wife **resorted** to begging other camp residents for food. But he felt he had no choice if he wants to feed his family. "We are eight family members". "I have to sell to keep other family members alive." The money from Parwana's sale will only sustain the family for a few months, before Malik has to find another solution, he said.

Parwana said she hoped to change her parents' minds—she had dreams of becoming a teacher, and didn't want to give up her education. But her **pleas** were futile.

On October 24, Qorban, the buyer, who only has one name, arrived at her home and handed 200,000 Afghanis (about $2,200) in the form of sheep, land and cash to Parwana's father. Qorban didn't describe the sale as a marriage, saying he already had a wife who would look after Parwana as if she were one of their own children. "(Parwana) was cheap, and her father was very poor and he needs money," Qorban said. "She will be working in my home. I won't beat her. I will treat her like a family member. I will be kind."

Since the Taliban's takeover, stories like Parwana's have been on the rise. Though marrying off children under 15 is illegal nationwide, it has been commonly practiced for years, especially in more rural parts of Afghanistan. And it has only spread since August, driven by widespread hunger and desperation. The problem is particularly acute for Afghan girls, who have stayed home and watched their brothers return to secondary school since the Taliban takeover. The Taliban said it is working on a plan to allow girls to return too, but have not said when that could happen or what conditions may be imposed. The uncertainty combined with rising poverty has pushed many girls into the marriage market. And once a girl is sold as a bride, her chances of continuing an education or pursuing an independent path are close to zero.

Text adapted from an article on *edition.cnn.com* (November 2, 2021)

giggles: riu efusivament / ríe efusivamente
fate: destí / destino
menial work: feina avorrida / trabajo aburrido
dries up: acaba
resorted: va recórrer com a última opció / recurrió como última opción
plea: petició urgent i emotiva / petición urgente y emotiva

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following best describes Parwana? ☐ Parwana was thrilled to return home and to marry the man of her dreams. ☐ Parwana giggled when she knew that she was getting married. ☐ Parwana was delighted to accept her fate. ☐ Parwana didn't want to accept her parent's decision.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, ☐ she had a sister who had already been sold to the same man. ☐ her parents were forced to sell her due to hunger. ☐ not many young Afghan girls have been sold into marriage. ☐ some other girls were sold to Mohammad Naiem Nazem.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of the following sentences is NOT true? ☐ International aid has gradually diminished. ☐ Hunger has forced many families to take very hard decisions. ☐ The country's economy is booming. ☐ The situation of Afghan people worsened when the Taliban came to power.	☐	☐	☐
4. The word *futile* is used in the text in paragraph 5. A synonym for *futile* is ☐ *useless*. ☐ *heartbreaking*. ☐ *meaningful*. ☐ *productive*.	☐	☐	☐
5. Parwana's sale ☐ will probably be prevented by international aid agencies. ☐ will be a decision that Parwana's father will have to face for the rest of his children's sake. ☐ will sustain the family for a long time. ☐ is one of several possible options that the family has to survive.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to the text, what does Qorban say about the sale? ☐ He will send Parwana to school to become a teacher. ☐ He paid more than what was first agreed because of the vulnerable situation of the family. ☐ He would treat her as another family member. ☐ He wants to marry her because he needed a wife for his children.	☐	☐	☐
7. When girls under 15 are married off ☐ they increase their possibilities to have an education. ☐ they have accepted and chosen their partner freely. ☐ their future prospects for a better life improve. ☐ their fundamental freedoms are being infringed.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following sentences best summarizes the content of the article? ☐ The sale and marriage of young girls is a desperate measure to overcome extreme poverty. ☐ Marriages of convenience are frequent in rural areas in Asia. ☐ Afghan girls look forward to marriage at age 15. ☐ Arranged marriages are a beloved tradition among Afghan families.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

THE WOMAN WHO SAVED MILLIONS OF LIVES WITHOUT KNOWING

One young black woman made one of the greatest contributions of all time to modern medicine, even though she never knew the important role she has played.

Henrietta Lacks was diagnosed with cervical cancer in 1951 at the age of 31, shortly after giving birth to her fifth child. At the time, segregation was widespread in the US, so she turned to Johns Hopkins Hospital in Baltimore, Maryland, as it was one of the few which provided medical care to black people.

The **ward** where she ended up was down the hall from George Gey, a researcher who had been trying to grow human cells in his lab for decades. During the treatment to remove her tumour, her doctor sent a small sample of **tissue** without her knowing to Gey. Up to this point, attempts to grow human cells outside the body had failed. But something about Lacks's cells was about to change that.

In most people a natural process called *senescence* puts a limit on the lifespan of cells. Senescence is linked to aging: as cells divide and multiply over time, the accuracy of each accompanying replication of DNA decreases. The protective caps on the end of each **strand** of DNA, which are called *telomeres*, shorten. Eventually the DNA strands become unprotected and mutations associated with cancers and other age-related diseases arise.

Typically human cells are able to divide around 50 times before they reach senescence. But Lacks's cells were different. In the laboratory, her cells were able to divide and replicate indefinitely. They were, in essence, immortal. It made them perfect for medical research as a **culture** of identical cells could be grown quickly. Gey shared them widely with other scientists, and they became a workhorse of biological research.

Her cell line, which came to be known as "HeLa" in honour of Lacks, is the first and most commonly used immortalised cell line in medicine. Today, work done with HeLa cells **underpins** much of modern medicine. Millions of people owe their lives to the tissue taken from her—the cell line it generated was used to create the first polio vaccine, cancer medicines and *in vitro* fertilisation. Her cells even made it into space before any living human. One of the most recent applications has been in research for vaccines against COVID-19.

But the story of Henrietta Lacks also illustrates the racial inequities that are embedded in American medical research and health-care systems. Lacks was a black woman. Doctors and scientists revealed Lacks's name publicly, gave her medical records to the media and even published her cells' genome online, repeatedly failing to ask her family for consent. None of the biotechnology or other companies that profited from her cells passed any money back to her family, either.

Now, the extraordinary events of 2020—the #BlackLivesMatter movement for racial justice, and the unequal **death toll** of COVID-19 on communities of colour—are forcing scientists to reconsider past injustices. Some have called for a reduction, or even an end, in the use of HeLa cells in research. The argument is that, because the cells were obtained without Lacks's knowledge or consent (even though this was legal at the time), any use of them is unethical and perpetuates an injustice.

But that is not what many Lacks family members want. Henrietta Lacks has dozens of descendants, several of whom are calling for people to celebrate her life and legacy in her centennial year, #HELA100. To her grandson Alfred Lacks Carter, the most important thing about HeLa cells is how they have advanced cancer research—an adequate tribute, given that Lacks died of the disease at the young age of 31. "The cells were taken in a bad way but they are doing good for the world," he says. And they do so for people of all ethnicities.

Text adapted from an article on
BBC.com (November 20, 2020)

ward: sala d'hospital / sala de hospital
tissue: teixit / tejido
strand: cadena
culture: cultiu / cultivo
underpins: forma la base de
death toll: nombre de víctimes / número de víctimas

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

		Espai per al corrector/a		
		Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1.	Which one of the following sentences about Henrietta Lacks is NOT true? ☐ She is responsible for a great advance in medicine. ☐ She died while giving birth to her fifth son. ☐ She never knew of her contribution to medicine. ☐ She was segregated for being black.	☐	☐	☐
2.	When Henrietta Lacks was in hospital, George Gey ☐ operated to remove her tumour. ☐ received some of her tissue. ☐ informed her of his experiments. ☐ was growing human cells in his lab.	☐	☐	☐
3.	Because of senescence, ☐ cells continue dividing and multiplying. ☐ the DNA replicates perfectly throughout one's lifetime. ☐ cancers are avoided. ☐ cells eventually die.	☐	☐	☐
4.	Lacks's cells "became a workhorse of biological research." This means that ☐ they were used over and over again. ☐ they divided endlessly. ☐ they could be shared easily. ☐ they were preserved in a lab.	☐	☐	☐
5.	The HeLa cell line ☐ has been the basis for medical research for years. ☐ was immortalised in a laboratory. ☐ is only used in studies on the health of black people. ☐ cannot be used in present-day research anymore.	☐	☐	☐
6.	According to the text, ☐ neither Henrietta nor her family were ever asked permission to conduct experiments with her cells. ☐ the companies that used her cells in their products have paid her family compensation. ☐ Lacks's medical records have been very useful to scientists and doctors, and that's why they were published. ☐ Black people at that time had their lives exposed by doctors and the health-care system.	☐	☐	☐
7.	The #BlackLivesMatter movement ☐ has made researchers consider stopping the use of HeLa cells completely. ☐ has increased the number of COVID-19 deaths among black people. ☐ considers the research done with HeLa cells illegal. ☐ expects scientists to continue the experiments with HeLa cells.	☐	☐	☐
8.	Some of Henrietta's descendants ☐ want to pay tribute to all the people who have died of cancer. ☐ do not mind what was done wrong, because the result was worth it. ☐ are organising a party to celebrate the anniversary of her death. ☐ are encouraging people of all races to contribute to cancer research.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

IS PLASTIC A DEADLY THREAT TO WILDLIFE?

On a boat off Costa Rica, a biologist uses a Swiss army knife to try to extract a plastic straw from a sea turtle. The turtle seems to be dying, bleeding profusely. For eight painful minutes a video on YouTube—which has registered more than 20 million views—shows horrifying images that are hard to watch. In the end, the desperate biologists manage to remove a four-inch-long straw from the creature's nose.

These shocking scenes show the dangers of plastic on wildlife: images of a dead bird covered in oil or a flatback turtle stuck in a fishing net have spread widely in the media. But most of the time, the harm is not so noticeable. **Seagulls** that nest on islands off the coast of Australia and New Zealand eat more plastic as a proportion of their body mass than any other marine animal. Researchers say that in one large population, 90 % of the baby birds had already ingested some. A plastic piece **piercing** an intestine can kill any bird quickly. And what's worse, the consumption of plastic usually leads marine birds to suffer from chronic, permanent hunger.

Matthew Savoca, a marine biologist with the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration in the U.S., complains, "the really sad thing about this is that birds are eating plastic thinking that it is food." He goes on to add, "imagine you ate lunch and then just felt weak and lethargic and hungry all day, which would be very confusing." Seabirds use energy that their malnourished bodies cannot provide. That is why they **roam** farther in search of real food, but only to take back plastic waste to feed their young. Savoca has also come to the conclusion that fish such as anchovies eat plastic because it smells like food once it is covered with algae.

What makes plastic useful for people—it's durable, light, and easy to throw out—increases the threat to animals. Plastic lasts a very long time, perhaps for more than 400 years and besides, most of it floats. Scientists suggest that single-use plastic is the worst offender: straws, water bottles, and plastic bags have been proved to be the most serious danger to marine species. For instance, 700 marine species have been reported—so far—to have eaten or become entangled in plastic.

Society does not fully understand the long-term impact of plastic on wildlife, nor its impact on us. In an historical perspective, humans are not used to the massive use of this material. The first documented cases of seabirds ingesting plastic referred to 74 albatrosses found on a Pacific **atoll** in 1966, when plastic production was roughly 5 % of what it is today.

The widespread use of plastic in millions of products and the very nature of plastic waste mean that science is unlikely to be able to solve this huge problem any time soon. It is preferable to take policy action now before waiting for the situation to become even worse. The first step would be identifying places where plastic has been shown to be harmful for birds and then take forceful measures there. Passing a law banning the sale of plastic products in those places would be a significant step forward, for instance. In the end, people currently use plastics because they are easy to use and cheap, but increasingly we are realizing that in the long term, plastics are expensive and a serious threat to the environment.

Text adapted from an article in *National Geographic Magazine* (June 2018)

seagull: gavina / gaviota
to pierce: perforar
to roam: vagar
atoll: atol / atolón

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following statements is NOT true? ☐ A plastic straw was removed from the sea turtle. ☐ The images seen on YouTube are tough to watch. ☐ The biologists extracted the straw right away. ☐ A plastic straw made the turtle bleed.	☐	☐	☐
2. The harm that plastic causes on marine birds ☐ results in a constant feeling of hunger. ☐ has resulted in fewer anchovies in the sea. ☐ is minor in 90 % of cases. ☐ prevents them from migrating.	☐	☐	☐
3. We can deduce from Matthew Savoca's research that ☐ anchovies cannot smell algae. ☐ anchovies feed on algae. ☐ seagulls migrate to avoid eating plastics. ☐ seagulls feed on anchovies.	☐	☐	☐
4. Plastic is a threat to animals because ☐ it is poisonous. ☐ most of it does not remain on the sea surface. ☐ it can be thrown away easily. ☐ it does not last very long.	☐	☐	☐
5. Straws, water bottles and plastic bags ☐ sink down to the ocean floor. ☐ float for a short time. ☐ are eaten by only a few marine species. ☐ last much longer than expected.	☐	☐	☐
6. The massive use of plastic ☐ started on a Pacific island in 1966. ☐ has been documented since 1966. ☐ has not changed in the last 50 years. ☐ is a relatively recent phenomenon.	☐	☐	☐
7. The impact of plastic waste on wildlife ☐ was predicted by scientists 30 years ago. ☐ can be easily solved by science. ☐ requires government intervention. ☐ has remained the same over the years.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to the text, which of the following is an effective solution to the threat of plastic waste on wildlife? ☐ Delaying taking measures now and waiting for science to solve the problem. ☐ Financing scientific research to change the nature of plastic. ☐ Locating crucial areas and then forbidding plastics there. ☐ Taking voluntary measures to reduce people's use of plastic.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

RAGE AGAINST THE MACHINES: HOW UNPLUGGING HELPS

In the past, people could "switch off" after work by simply going home or avoiding dealing with dramatic friends by not picking up the phone. But smartphones, social media and the expectation that everyone should be available all the time have made taking a break much more difficult. From this necessity, a new anti-tech trend has arisen: over the past few years, the concept of *unplugging* has become popular amongst bloggers and youtubers.

It is widely accepted that multitasking and constant email cause a lack of productivity, negatively impact on social relationships and increase stress. But can we reverse these bad consequences if we abstain from using technology? According to most research, the answer is "yes."

Like a muscle, the brain needs recovery time in order to develop, grow and retain new memories. In fact, shutting off completely may be crucial: a Michigan university study found that students who walked in the woods after learning something new were more likely to retain it. Even brief activities such as taking a short walk, spending time in nature, or just daydreaming can help the brain. Without free time, it is impossible to fully learn new skills and keep the brain at its cognitive best.

Luckily more and more people are becoming aware of the importance of **down time**. Over the past few years, the idea of disconnecting from all online communication has grown into a major movement. In 2010, for instance, a group of Jewish artists created the *Sabbath Manifesto* designed to help people of all faiths and creeds find a day of rest amid the **fuss** of modern technology. This manifesto created the *National Day of Unplugging* which happens once a year, typically in early March.

Recently, countless bloggers have written about technological stress. For example, some of the people behind the lifestyle website *The Minimalists* suggest cancelling home Internet access in order to make using a computer more difficult and less appealing. Even some Internet celebs advocate a more radical approach: a 25-day digital detoxification after realizing their addiction was noticeable. And finally, a well-known magazine journalist has spent an entire year without Internet.

Unplugging is a trendy **buzzword** these days, but hopefully taking technological breaks is not just a **passing fad**. The Internet and mobile communication have grown by impressive leaps in the past ten years. But because we are used to tech companies releasing new and better products every week, we have assumed that more communication is good, more social media sites are better, and the ability to contact anyone at any time is best of all.

In reality, however, this behaviour might be unsustainable. Keeping up with email, Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, and other sites round-the-clock have been shown to be exhausting, bad for our brains, our relationships and our productivity. Regardless of length and intensity, technology **fasts** have proved an important point: with a little bit of effort we can stop living through our phones and computer screens. It would be better if we could re-connect with other human beings, thus reducing stress and **enhancing** creativity.

Text adapted from an article by
Sophia Breene. *Greatist* [online] (June 2015)

down time: temps d'inactivitat / tiempo de inactividad
fuss: rebombori / jaleo
buzzword: paraula en voga / palabra de moda
passing fad: tendència passatgera / tendencia pasajera
fast: dejuni / ayuno
to enhance: augmentar / aumentar

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Some years ago people did not answer phone calls so that ☐ they could be connected to the web without disturbance. ☐ they were able to forget about their problems. ☐ they could be available all the time. ☐ they could continue working from home.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to most research, we can avoid the bad consequences of being permanently connected to the web ☐ if we leave little time for socialization. ☐ if we learn to go without technological tools. ☐ by emailing as little as possible. ☐ if we admit that multitasking harms our friends irreversibly.	☐	☐	☐
3. A Michigan university study concluded that ☐ our brain only develops when it does not work. ☐ a student must leave the city if he/she wants to learn something new. ☐ students learn best after moments of outdoor relaxation. ☐ brief activities are beneficial for our memories.	☐	☐	☐
4. The idea of disconnecting from all online communication ☐ was conceived by Israeli social activists. ☐ can unite people from all faiths and creeds. ☐ has induced several organizations to remind people to unplug. ☐ has been discarded because it is too expensive.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of these four statements is NOT true according to the text? ☐ Some famous people have decided to unplug for almost a month. ☐ For many network users, technological stress is a serious issue. ☐ If home Internet access is available, switching on a computer is appealing. ☐ Taking technological breaks can develop into a severe addiction.	☐	☐	☐
6. The text states that one possible solution to reduce stress would be: ☐ to not use smartphones on weekends. ☐ to keep up with Facebook and Twitter all day. ☐ to pause our use of connected devices periodically. ☐ to maintain contact with everybody through social media.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to the text, why do people think that increased use of technology to contact others is good? ☐ Because we know companies are constantly launching state-of-the-art devices. ☐ Because technology has barely developed since the beginning of the 21st century. ☐ Because people have little time to communicate with each other. ☐ Because we know that it is always better to have more information.	☐	☐	☐
8. What is unsustainable about not "unplugging"? ☐ Multitasking has a positive impact on our social relationships. ☐ Being connected all the time makes us less creative. ☐ Keeping up with Facebook and Instagram keeps people more informed. ☐ Maintaining a public profile on social media is the key to success in business.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐

Nota de comprensió escrita ☐

Part 2: Reading comprehension

IS THERE SUCH A THING AS LOVE AT FIRST SIGHT?

The science of first impressions is complicated, influenced by things outside of our control, neurological processes that we don't understand and inaccurate stereotypes.

It takes less than a second to form an **assessment** of someone's face. These first impressions predict all kinds of important characteristics, not just attractiveness. These impressions we make in a second tend to be shared by the majority of the people. But that doesn't necessarily make them correct.

"A first impression could be **misleading**," says professor Alexander Todorov, author of the book *Face Value: The Irresistible Influence of First Impressions* and a professor at Princeton University. "Trying to figure out what a person is like from a simple exposure is basically ridiculous. We only make first impressions about strangers. So naturally they are superficial."

Whether our predictions are accurate or not, we make them quickly and we stick to them. Even if we are given more time than a second to judge the attractiveness of a face, we are unlikely to arrive at a different conclusion. According to professor Todorov, there are three universal qualities that people infer from a face: attractiveness, **trustworthiness** and dominance.

In these first impressions, men and women are not judged equally. Women who appear masculine are evaluated negatively whereas men would be evaluated positively. This applies to both genders, so men and women [both] make negative assessments of masculine-looking women."

First impressions of faces are superficial, general and can be inaccurate. If we think about this in the context of dating apps, we also have to think about the effects of how a photo is taken. The photos we choose to publish on dating profiles are those that present ourselves in the best light. Not just chosen for attractiveness, they are also there to reflect personality and social cues, like adventurousness or generosity.

First impressions are rapid but **shallow** and can change over time if you have better information, like when your date starts speaking. "The only way to tell whether two people will really like each other is when they have to talk. People don't make good predictions for compatibility without talking," says professor Todorov.

Professor Todorov has categorised all the conversational strategies we use which should lead to a second date and he came to several conclusions: "The traditional dating habit was that men approach women and we have found that it is men who approach women when dating online, too," says professor Todorov. "But the most interesting part is how few gender differences there were in the types of strategy used."

Men and women are more similar than they are different. Being sincere about the type of person you are looking for is more effective than talking about your wealth, profession or whether you are looking for love.

"Something that is unique about online dating is that you have a longer time to figure out if your date is going to meet your expectations," says Todorov. "Sometimes with online dating you have a tendency to build people up in your head which can lead to disappointment. We can idealise people when we don't have a lot of information to go on."

Having said that, there have been several marriages from these speed-dating meetings, so there must be some logic in there, says Todorov: "Some people now have children, so it produced some nice results".

Text adapted from an article by
William Park. *BBC News* [online] (April 3, 2019)

assessment: valoració / valoración
misleading: enganyós / engañoso
trustworthiness: confiança / confianza
shallow: superficial

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada

1. According to professor Todorov
- ☐ we only make first impressions about people we don't know.
- ☐ we make first impressions only if they are misleading.
- ☐ our first impressions about someone are usually wrong.
- ☐ we usually share our first impression with many other people.

2. Once people have made their first impressions
- ☐ they may change them quite quickly if their opinions are not accurate.
- ☐ they will change their opinion if they are not sure of the person they have just met.
- ☐ they will hardly ever change their first opinion about a person they have just met.
- ☐ they always change their mind soon afterwards if given more time to judge a person.

3. Which one of these sentences is TRUE?
- ☐ In first impressions women and men make similar judgments.
- ☐ In first impressions women and men are judged similarly.
- ☐ In first impressions feminine-looking men are badly considered.
- ☐ In first impressions masculine-looking men are badly judged.

4. According to the text, the photos people publish on their dating profiles are
- ☐ their best ones in order to reflect their personalities only.
- ☐ a mixture of fake and real ones; people don't want to show how they really are.
- ☐ very superficial in order not to show one's real personality and generosity.
- ☐ chosen to show physical and personality traits.

5. Prof. Todorov affirms that
- ☐ first impressions are always reliable even when our date starts speaking.
- ☐ people can change their first impressions when they start talking to their date.
- ☐ talking to our date reinforces our first impressions, making them more certain.
- ☐ people in general make good predictions from their first impressions.

6. According to professor Todorov, the conversational strategies used in online dating show
- ☐ that women talk more about themselves than men do.
- ☐ that men talk more about their profession than women do.
- ☐ that men and women use quite different approaches to dating.
- ☐ that men and women take similar approaches to dating.

7. If you want to find your perfect date, Prof. Todorov recommends that you be
- ☐ talkative when you meet your date.
- ☐ honest when you talk to your date.
- ☐ a little vague when talking about your interests.
- ☐ responsible when you talk about your wealth.

8. At the end of the article we can come to the conclusion that speed-dating meetings
- ☐ are the only way to get married successfully.
- ☐ are successful only if you want to have children.
- ☐ sometimes fulfil people's expectations.
- ☐ are a very flawed system of meeting people.

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

HOW TO LOOK MODERN IN VINTAGE

"I don't want to look retro. I think **permed hair** looks ridiculous and I would not be seen dead in anything with real fur. Right now I want a cardigan that I can tuck into a midi skirt, but I want it simple, with neutral colours like the ones on the **catwalk**, and not in some light, pastel colour with **embroidered** flowers." This is the thinking of many young people today, who increasingly go second-hand shopping, but for this season's looks. Can we find "now" clothes, without buying new clothes?

Buying clothes second-hand is, after all, very fashionable. This is sustainable **retail** therapy, a feelgood fashion fix that doesn't add to the environmental problem of clothing overproduction. In the U.S., the resale market has grown 21 times faster than the retail market in the past three years, with a report this year predicting that the second-hand market could overtake fast fashion within a decade. In the U.K., the younger shoppers are returning to a taste for second-hand things that their parents' generation, raised on fast fashion chains like Zara, Primark and H&M, never cultivated. Eighty per cent of 16-21-year-olds are happy to buy second-hand clothes and an amazing 90 % of over-60s are comfortable buying used garments, while less than a third of shoppers in their 30s and 40s are happy to buy used clothes, according to a survey by a waste management agency.

The new trendy profile of second-hand shopping is beginning to be felt on the high street. In Covent Garden in London, a new branch of *Picknweight*, a vintage store that is already a cult destination in Berlin, had customers queueing down the street when it opened. Many people start their hunt for now-clothes-not-new-clothes next door, in the Shelton Street branch of *Rokit*, a vintage institution which has resold more than a million tonnes of pre-worn clothing since the first branch opened in Camden market in 1986. Today *Rokit's* business is booming: it has expanded to four shops in London, has huge web sales, and even employs a team of people who transform and repair clothing that otherwise could never be resold into trendy, wanted items. Vintage is definitely IN.

Second-hand clothes hunting requires you to change your mind as a shopper. Walk into a high street store and you will see ready-made complete looks on **mannequins**, and the store has stock in different sizes. In a second-hand store, you have to look harder and use your imagination. You have to take a different approach: it helps to remind yourself that while new clothes look great on the shop floor, second-hand clothes are the opposite—these pieces often look unattractive in the shop and come into their own once you get them home.

If you want to find used clothes that look current, looking at labels for designer brands is not the best advice. Instead, zoom in on today's colours, shapes and details. Anything classic, like a blazer or a wool cardigan, is always a good buy if it is the right colour.

The preconception with vintage is that it's all baby blue polyester dresses, jackets with massive shoulder pads or horrible brown suits, but that's just not the case these days. The circular economy is perfectly suited to young people's commitment to recycling and creating a more sustainable world. The production of polyester alone is one of the world's most polluting industries because it depends on burning petroleum oil, so anything and everything we can do to reduce fast fashion and its carbon footprint should be our goal. Fashion is cyclical, after all. The fact is that the original of what you are looking for will be out there if you look hard enough.

Text adapted from an article by
Jess Cartner-Morley. *The Guardian* [online] (November 6, 2019)

permed hair: pentinat amb permanent / peinado con permanente
catwalk: passarel·la / pasarela
embroidered: brodat / bordado
retail: venda al detall / venta al por menor
mannequin: maniquí

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. According to the author, many young people ☐ want to wear light-coloured clothes with flowers. ☐ like shopping for second-hand clothes to achieve a "retro" look. ☐ like buying used clothes that don't look dated. ☐ shop for genuine fur coats in second-hand shops.	☐	☐	☐
2. In the U.S. ☐ the second-hand market for clothing is getting smaller and smaller. ☐ the first-hand market for clothing is 21 times larger than the second-hand market. ☐ the second-hand market for clothing will overtake the first-hand market in 10 years. ☐ the second-hand market for clothing has increased much faster than the first-hand market.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of the following is TRUE about people's shopping preferences in the U.K.? ☐ People over 60s are the age group that feels best about buying pre-worn clothing. ☐ Teenagers do not usually like buying second-hand clothes. ☐ About half of all 30-40-year-olds regularly buy used clothes. ☐ Less than half of people between 16 and 21 feel comfortable buying second-hand clothes.	☐	☐	☐
4. Where is the first *Picknweight* vintage store? ☐ In Covent Garden in London. ☐ In Camden market in London. ☐ In Berlin. ☐ The text does not say.	☐	☐	☐
5. How is second-hand clothes shopping different from buying new, unworn clothes? ☐ Shoppers can find well-matched outfits ready to be purchased. ☐ All sizes are available in second-hand stores. ☐ Shoppers should be ready to spend more time in the store. ☐ Clothes look nicer in a second-hand clothes shop than at home.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of the following is NOT true about *Rokit*? ☐ Its business has grown substantially since 1986. ☐ It has a single retail location in London. ☐ It has sold a huge amount of pre-worn clothing. ☐ It mends clothing before trying to sell it.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to the author, if you want to buy now-but-not-new clothes ☐ you need to browse the Internet. ☐ you need to look for famous brands. ☐ you should be looking for bright colours. ☐ you need to look for details currently in style.	☐	☐	☐
8. What does the phrase "Fashion is cyclical, after all" mean? ☐ It means that fashion trends return and are periodically back in style. ☐ It means that vintage clothes inevitably look old and outdated. ☐ It means that cycling trends will always be fashionable. ☐ It means that we should reduce, recycle and reuse vintage clothes.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Reading comprehension

HUGE REDUCTIONS IN MEAT-EATING 'ESSENTIAL' TO AVOID CLIMATE BREAKDOWN

Huge reductions in meat-eating are essential to avoid dangerous climate change, according to one of the most comprehensive analyses of the food system's impact on the environment. In Western countries, the study states that beef consumption needs to fall by 90 % and be replaced by five times more beans and peas. The research also finds that enormous changes to farming are needed to avoid destroying the planet's ability to feed the 10 billion people expected to be on the planet in a few decades.

Food production already causes great damage to the environment, via greenhouse gases from **livestock**, deforestation and water shortages from farming, and vast dead zones in oceans from agricultural pollution. But without action, its impact will get far worse as the world population rises by 2.3 billion people by 2050. At the same time, global income is increasing, enabling more people to eat meat-rich Western-style diets. "It is pretty shocking," said Marco Springmann at the University of Oxford, who led the research team. "We are really risking the sustainability of the whole system. If we are interested in people being able to farm and eat, then we better not do that."

The new study follows the publication of a UN report in which the world's leading scientists warned there are just 12 years in which to keep global warming under 1.5 °C, beyond which even half a degree will significantly worsen the risks of **drought**, floods and extreme heat. The report said consuming less meat and dairy products (like eggs and cheese) was important. Nevertheless, current trends are in the opposite direction.

The new research, published in the journal *Nature*, is the most thorough to date and combined data from many countries to evaluate the impact of food production on the global environment. It then looked at what could be done to stop the **looming** food crisis. "There is no magic bullet," said Springmann. "But dietary and technological change [on farms] are the two essential things, and hopefully they can be complemented by a reduction in food loss and waste." About a third of food produced today never reaches the table.

The researchers recommended a global shift to a "flexitarian" diet in order to keep climate change under 2 °C. This flexitarian diet means drastic changes for many people: the average European or American would need to eat 75 % less beef, 90 % less pork and half the number of eggs, while tripling consumption of legumes such as beans, peas, and lentils and quadrupling that of nuts and seeds. This would cut emissions from livestock by 50 %, and better management of **manure** would enable further cuts. In contrast to what needs to occur in the U.S. and Europe, the millions of people in poor nations who are undernourished need to eat a little more meat and dairy.

Reducing meat consumption might be achieved by a mix of education, taxes, subsidies for plant-based foods and changes to school and workplace menus, the scientists said. To prevent deforestation, water shortages and pollution from overuse of fertiliser, they recommend profound changes in farming practices.

Ultimately, we live on a finite planet, with finite resources. It is a myth to imagine that there is a technological solution allowing us to produce as much food as we might ever want, allowing us to overeat and throw food away. The effects of the current food system on the environment will not allow future generations to live on a stable, ecologically rich planet.

Text adapted from an article by
Damian Carrington. *The Guardian* [online] (October 10, 2018)

livestock: ramaderia / ganado
drought: sequera / sequía
looming: que s'acosta / que se avecina
manure: fems / estiércol

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. In order to avoid environmental damage ☐ people should eat less meat. ☐ people need to eat more fish. ☐ people should eat more meat and dairy. ☐ vegan diets need to be adopted.	☐	☐	☐
2. In a few decades, the world population ☐ will increase to 2.3 billion people. ☐ will increase by 70 %. ☐ will increase to 10 billion people. ☐ will not change.	☐	☐	☐
3. If global warming is kept under 1.5 °C ☐ traditional farming areas will experience major floods. ☐ the risk of drought, floods and extreme heat will increase. ☐ we will have a dozen years of continuous drought, floods and extreme heat. ☐ we will reduce the risk of drought, floods and extreme heat.	☐	☐	☐
4. The report states that dietary habits and changes in farming should be accompanied by ☐ more emissions from livestock. ☐ less impact on beef production. ☐ a decrease in food loss and waste. ☐ a global increase in meat consumption.	☐	☐	☐
5. A flexitarian diet implies ☐ eating mainly raw vegetables. ☐ eating no meat from farms. ☐ eating more meat and less legumes. ☐ eating more beans and peas and less meat.	☐	☐	☐
6. In order to be effective against climate breakdown, dietary changes ☐ should be applied equally across the world's population. ☐ should be applied more strictly in developed countries. ☐ are unnecessary in developing countries. ☐ should not be applied in the U.S. or U.K.	☐	☐	☐
7. What does the report recommend to reduce people's consumption of meat? ☐ Adopting traditional European farming practices everywhere. ☐ Using more fertilisers in developing countries. ☐ Changing menus served to children in schools. ☐ Clearing forests to increase the land available for agriculture.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following statements is NOT true? ☐ The Earth's resources are limited. ☐ The current food system does not enable future generations to have a sustainable planet. ☐ Technology will help us to continue with food production as we know it now. ☐ The current food system has a damaging impact on our climate.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE EMOJI IS THE BIRTH OF A NEW TYPE OF LANGUAGE (NO JOKE)

Tyler Schnoebelen has discovered something curious about why people use the skull emoji. Schnoebelen is a linguist and the chief analyst for Idibon, a firm that interprets linguistic data. Recently he got interested in emoji. He analyzed a million social media posts containing those familiar little pictograms and found that when people talk about their phone, they're 11 times more likely to use the skull. Weird, right? But to Schnoebelen, it makes sense. Our phones, he points out, are social lifelines, and when they malfunction—a weak signal, short battery life—we're upset. "When you don't have access to your phone, or when nobody's texting you, you're socially dead," he says. So we reach for a metaphorical emoji: the skull.

Fully 92 percent of all people online use emoji now, and one-third of them do so daily. On Instagram, nearly half of the posts contain emoji, a trend that began in 2011 when Apple's iOS added an emoji keyboard. Rates increased when Android did the same two years later. Emoji are so popular they're killing off **netspeak**. The more we use emoji, the less we use LOL and OMG.

In essence, we're watching the birth of a new type of language. Emoji assist in a peculiarly modern task: conveying emotions in short, online texts. "They're trying to solve one of the big problems of writing online, which is that you have the words but you don't have the tone of voice," as Gretchen McCulloch, a linguist, says.

Purists are not so convinced. What have we become, children with **crayons**? Surely words alone can convey emotional tone. Maybe—if you're a novelist with years of experience. But most of us write speedily and conversationally on Instagram or WhatsApp. Of the 20 most frequently used emoji, nearly all are hearts, smilies, or hand gestures—the ones that express feelings. In an age of rapid chatter, emoji aid communication by adding an emotional meaning to the message.

We also use emoji to express a sort of ambient presence, when words alone aren't enough. Ryan Kelly, a computer scientist at the University of Bath, has found that texters often exchange a few emoji as nonverbal conclusion to a conversation. "You might not have anything else left to say," Kelly says, "but you want the person to know that you're thinking of them." So you send a couple of pandas. Or telescopes! Or some other symbol that seems **witty**. This is another aspect of emoji—many are open-ended. In fact, it is known that friends use that flexibility to assign their own private meanings to specific emoji. (My wife and I use the Easter Island head to connote absurdity.)

People are even developing syntax and rules of use for emoji. Schnoebelen found that when face emoji are used, they tend to occur before other objects. If you text about a late flight, you'll put an unhappy face followed by a plane, not the reverse. In linguistic terms, this is called conveying "**stance**." Just as with face-to-face talk, our expression illustrates our stance before we've spoken a word.

Social pessimists can stop worrying; no linguist thinks that this means the end of writing. Natural language is our most powerful communication tool. For most people, these ideograms represent an upgrade. Language always changes: slang is born, develops and becomes obsolete, for example. But it's exceedingly rare—maybe unprecedented—for languages with phonetic alphabets to suddenly acquire a big expansion pack of ideograms. In an age when we write more than ever, emoji are the new language of the heart.

Text adapted from an article by
Clive Thompson. *Wired* [online] (April 19, 2016)

netspeak: llenguatge del ciberespai / lenguaje del ciberespacio
crayon: llapis de cera / lápiz de cera
witty: enginyós / ingenioso
stance: actitud

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Many people use the skull emoji when talking about their phone ☐ to tell friends that they don't feel well. ☐ to explain that it is not working well. ☐ to complain that nobody's sending them text messages. ☐ because they like using metaphorical language.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the following sentences is NOT true? ☐ Instagram incorporated emoji in 2011. ☐ Emoji usage increased after Android included them. ☐ Since we have emoji, we use netspeak less. ☐ Emoji in Instagram posts are very frequent.	☐	☐	☐
3. The author believes that we are watching the birth of a new type of language because ☐ writing online presents big problems. ☐ emoji replace voice messages. ☐ emoji have stable meanings. ☐ emoji help us transmit our feelings in writing.	☐	☐	☐
4. Emoji have become so popular so quickly because ☐ people no longer know how to spell. ☐ we want to convey emotional tone. ☐ alphabet keyboards are difficult to use online. ☐ we need new words to express our feelings.	☐	☐	☐
5. According to the author, smiley, hand and heart emoji ☐ seldom occur in online messages. ☐ are the only way to communicate our feelings online. ☐ have become effective tools of communication. ☐ often result in miscommunication.	☐	☐	☐
6. Many emoji are open-ended. This means that ☐ different people may assign them different meanings. ☐ they are sometimes used to end a conversation. ☐ you can use them when you don't know what to say. ☐ some people use them to express absurd things.	☐	☐	☐
7. We tend to put an emoji face before an object because ☐ it's impossible to convey stance in a message. ☐ we don't need to speak words in an online conversation. ☐ when we speak, we see the person's facial expression first. ☐ that's what the new syntax rule for emoji use tells us to do.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to the writer, ☐ we write so much today because language always changes. ☐ emoji do not represent a threat to writing. ☐ emoji are a form of slang. ☐ emoji communicate more powerfully than text.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THRILLER: MICHAEL JACKSON'S SURPRISING SUCCESS

The album that would become the most successful record in music history went unnoticed by the magazine *Time* when it was first **released** 35 years ago, on November 30, 1982. But it didn't take too long for that to change, as the album sat atop the charts for weeks and revolutionized the entire record industry and the music-video culture. About a year after its **release**, *Thriller* was still selling 200,000 copies a week. By the time Michael Jackson appeared on the cover of *Time* magazine in 1984, the album had become the best-selling album ever (and it still claims that title).

But, while it could be said that a success of that magnitude is always a surprise in some way, *Time*'s music critic Jay Cocks also suggests a deeper reason why the editors at *Time* may have **overlooked** the album when it was first released:

> For the record industry, *Thriller* was a restoration of confidence, a rejuvenation. Its effect on listeners, especially younger ones, was nearer to a revelation. *Thriller* brought Black music back to mainstream radio, from which it had been **banished** in the mid-'70s. "No doubt about it," says composer-arranger Quincy Jones, who produced the albums *Off the Wall* and *Thriller* with Jackson. "He took us right up there where we belong. Black music had to **play second fiddle** for a long time, but its spirit is the whole motor of pop. Michael connected with every soul in the world."
>
> *Thriller* does not have the mean, challenging immediacy of rap, but it is consummate contemporary rhythm and blues. Jane Fonda, one of Jackson's pals, put it as nicely as any music critic: "Michael had a fresh, original sound. The music is energetic, and it's sensual. You can dance to it, work out to it, make love to it, sing to it. It's hard to sit still to."
>
> The pulse of America and much of the rest of the world **beat** in time to the tough **strut** of *Billie Jean*, the asphalt aria of *Beat It*, the cool chills of *Thriller*. *Thriller* was on the Japanese charts for 65 consecutive weeks, and local teens were copying Michael's moves and singing his songs. *Thriller* was also South Africa's top seller: "Jackson bridged the apartheid gap," declared one record executive. The Soviet press in Moscow denounced Jackson, and his fans couldn't buy his records in any stores, but **bootleg** tapes were swapped and treasured.
>
> "Michael used to say, when he wrote, he'd write for everyone," says his mother Katherine, "even though the music business would list it as rhythm and blues because of him being Black." Jackson was the biggest thing in music since The Beatles. He was the hottest single phenomenon since Elvis Presley. He just may be the most popular Black singer ever.
>
> This success, Jones says, "had never happened to a Black performer." Rock critics (who are mostly white) liked *Thriller* well enough and wrote respectfully of it when it was released in December 1982, but they were as surprised as record-company executives (who are mostly white) when the album started **burning its way into** the country's collective musical consciousness. The message is obvious anyway: soul is for sharing, not segregating.

When Jackson died in 2009, *Thriller* was still remembered by many as a high point in his career. "For a generation, the magic is partly nostalgic; everyone in his fifties remembers exactly where they were when they heard *Beat It* for the first time," wrote *Time*'s Richard Corliss in his remembrance of the pop idol. "As a piece of music, it remains the greatest pop album of all time."

Text adapted from an article by
Lily Rothman. *Time* [online] (November 29, 2017)

to release: publicar
release: publicació / publicación
to overlook: passar per alt / pasar por alto
to banish: bandejar / desterrar
to play second fiddle: ser a l'ombra / estar en la sombra
to beat: marcar el ritme / marcar el ritmo
strut: estil de caminar fatxenda / pavoneo
bootleg: còpia pirata / copia pirata
to burn one's way into: establir-se ràpidament i amb força / establecerse rápidamente y con fuerza

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. When Michael Jackson's *Thriller* was released, ☐ *Time* magazine didn't pay much notice to it. ☐ it sold 200,000 copies on the first week. ☐ it was considered the best album ever. ☐ it didn't reach the charts immediately.	☐	☐	☐
2. After *Thriller*, ☐ Black music was forbidden on the radio. ☐ young people started listening to the radio again. ☐ only Black people listened to the radio stations playing Jackson's music. ☐ Black music was heard on radio stations aimed at a general audience.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of these things does Quincy Jones NOT say? ☐ Michael Jackson made Black music important again. ☐ Pop music has a strong influence of Black music. ☐ Michael Jackson had connections all over the world. ☐ Black music was considered secondary for years.	☐	☐	☐
4. When Jane Fonda said that "It's hard to sit still to [Michael Jackson's music]", she meant that ☐ his music makes you want to move. ☐ his music makes you want to sit down. ☐ it's difficult to listen to his music. ☐ it's difficult to dance like he did.	☐	☐	☐
5. In Moscow, Michael Jackson's records ☐ were widely available in music stores. ☐ were only available as pirate copies. ☐ reached the top position in the charts. ☐ were played regularly on state-owned radio stations.	☐	☐	☐
6. Michael Jackson's mother says that ☐ he didn't make music for a specific group of people. ☐ he composed music for a Black audience. ☐ he composed mainly rhythm and blues. ☐ he wrote for the music business.	☐	☐	☐
7. Rock critics ☐ worked together with record companies. ☐ thought that Jackson's music would promote segregation. ☐ predicted the success of the album. ☐ didn't expect the album to be so successful.	☐	☐	☐
8. Many people believe that *Thriller* ☐ is the most famous song of the 20th century. ☐ marked the end of a music era. ☐ is one of the best albums in Michael Jackson's career. ☐ is a song with a strong political message.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

LEONARDO'S *SALVATOR MUNDI*: ART OR BUSINESS?

Salvator Mundi, the long-lost Leonardo da Vinci painting of Jesus Christ ordered by King Louis XII of France more than 500 years ago, has been sold in New York at Christie's, the well-known auction house, for more than $450 million, breaking the world record of any work of art sold at auction. It far surpassed Picasso's *Women of Algiers*, which was sold for $179.4 million at Christie's in May 2015.

Christie's marketing campaign was unprecedented in the art world. It was the first time the auction house had paid an agency for an advertising campaign. Christie's produced a video that compared the painting to "the discovery of a new planet" and showed celebrities like Leonardo di Caprio and Patti Smith viewing it. Christie's called the work "the last da Vinci," the only known painting by the Renaissance master still in a private collection (some fifteen others are in museums), and "the biggest discovery of the 21st century." In short, Christie's ran a brilliant marketing campaign for a painting with a very complicated history.

The oil on wood panel painting **depicts** a half-length figure of Christ as Savior of the World, facing frontally and dressed in flowing blue and **crimson** robes. He holds a crystal orb in his left hand as he raises his right hand in benediction.

Leonardo, who died in 1519, is thought to have painted *Salvator Mundi* sometime after 1500, during the same period that he produced the *Mona Lisa*. It became part of the British Royal collection in the early 17th century. It then disappeared in 1763 until 1900, when it was acquired by Sir Charles Robinson, an art collector, for the Cook Collection in Richmond, England. At the time, the painting was thought to have been by Leonardo's follower, Bernardino Luini. In 1958 the painting was sold by Sotheby's (Christie's rival auction house) for just £45 and the painting disappeared once again until it showed up in Louisiana in 2005.

It was acquired, badly damaged and partly painted-over, by a consortium of American art dealers who paid less than $10,000 for it. They restored it extensively and documented its authenticity as a work by Leonardo.

The masterpiece was long believed to have existed but was generally presumed to have been destroyed. In 2011, following six years of investigations, the work was confirmed as a genuine work of art by Leonardo and **unveiled** publicly at London's National Gallery, making it the first discovery of a painting by Leonardo since 1909. The painting was then sold to a Swiss art dealer, who then sold it to a Russian billionaire in 2013 for $127.5 million in a private sale that became the subject of a continuing **lawsuit**. The Russian family has sold the painting, which was bought by a prince from Saudi Arabia and will eventually be displayed in the new museum, Louvre Abu Dhabi.

Christie's says most scholars agree that the painting is by Leonardo, though some critics have questioned the attribution and some say the extensive restoration makes it impossible to determine the work's authorship. Before the auction, over 27,000 people had lined up at viewings in Hong Kong, London, San Francisco and New York to see the painting. Most of the people in line did not seem to care if Leonardo had actually made the work himself, or how much of the canvas had been repainted and restored. They just wanted to see a masterwork that dates from about 1500 and was rediscovered in 2005.

Text adapted from *The New York Times* (November 15, 2017), *The Telegraph* (November 16, 2017) and *The Guardian* (November 20, 2017)

to depict: representar
crimson: carmesí
unveiled: descobert / descubierto
lawsuit: demanda judicial

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The first owner of *Salvator Mundi* was ☐ the auction house Christie's. ☐ King Louis XII of France. ☐ a Russian art dealer. ☐ an anonymous American collector.	☐	☐	☐
2. Before they put the painting up for sale, Christie's ☐ showed it to professional collectors in France. ☐ had the painting put in a new frame. ☐ made a video to show the painting. ☐ tried to cover up the painting's complicated history.	☐	☐	☐
3. Most of Leonardo da Vinci's paintings that still exist are ☐ on exhibit in museums. ☐ owned by private collectors. ☐ currently being restored. ☐ in very poor condition.	☐	☐	☐
4. *Salvator Mundi* has been in known hands ☐ since the 16th century. ☐ for seven years, when it was first shown to the public. ☐ only since it was acquired by a group of American art dealers thirteen years ago. ☐ only for a short time compared with its 500+ years of existence.	☐	☐	☐
5. In 2005, a group of Americans ☐ bought the painting from a museum in Richmond, England. ☐ found the painting in a garage in San Francisco. ☐ purchased the painting and then had it cleaned and restored. ☐ lent the painting to the National Gallery in London for a major art exhibition.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of the following is NOT true? ☐ Christie's auctioned the painting for a Russian family. ☐ Christie's sold the painting to a Russian family. ☐ A Russian family bought the painting after it had been restored. ☐ A Swiss art dealer made a controversial sale to a Russian billionaire.	☐	☐	☐
7. Which of the following best describes this painting of the *Salvator Mundi*? ☐ There is no doubt that the painting is by Leonardo da Vinci. ☐ There is little evidence to support that Leonardo da Vinci was the painter. ☐ A few art critics claim that the painting is by Leonardo da Vinci. ☐ Despite extensive restoration, most experts believe the painting was done by Leonardo da Vinci.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to the text, most of the people who lined up to see the *Salvator Mundi* ☐ did not believe that it was done by Leonardo da Vinci. ☐ were not very concerned about the details of restoration. ☐ were celebrities like Leonardo di Caprio and Patti Smith. ☐ were representatives of potential buyers from around the world.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE FUTURE OF FAKE NEWS: DON'T BELIEVE EVERYTHING YOU READ, SEE OR HEAR

In an age of Photoshop, filters and social media, many of us are used to seeing manipulated pictures—subjects become slimmer and smoother or, in the case of Snapchat, transformed into puppies. However, there's a new breed of video and audio manipulation tools, made possible by advances in artificial intelligence and computer graphics, that will allow for the creation of realistic looking **footage** of public figures appearing to say anything: Queen Elisabeth declaring her desire to fly to the moon, or Hillary Clinton describing how she climbed Mount Everest without oxygen. This is the future of fake news. We've long been told not to believe everything we read, but soon we'll have to question everything we see and hear as well.

For now, there are several research teams working on capturing and synthesizing different visual and audio elements of human behaviour. Software developed at Stanford University called Face2Face is able to manipulate video footage of public figures to allow a second person to put words in their mouth—in real time. Face2Face captures the second person's facial expressions as they talk into a webcam and then **morphs** those movements directly onto the face of the person in the original video. On its own, Face2Face is a fun plaything for creating memes and entertaining late-night talk show hosts. However, with the addition of a synthesized voice, it becomes more convincing—not only does the digital puppet look like the politician, but it can sound like the politician, too.

A research team at the University of Alabama at Birmingham has been working on voice impersonation. With 3-5 minutes of audio of a victim's voice—taken live or from YouTube videos or radio shows—an attacker can create a synthesized voice that can **fool** both humans and voice biometric security systems used by some banks and smartphones. The attacker can then talk into a microphone and the software will convert it so that the words sound like they are being spoken by the victim—whether over the phone or on a radio show.

Although their intentions may be well-meaning, voice-morphing technology could be combined with face-morphing technology to create convincing fake statements by public figures. However, these morphing technologies still aren't perfect. The facial expressions in the videos can seem a little distorted or unnatural, and the voices can sound a little robotic. But given time, they will be able to faithfully recreate the sound or appearance of a person, to the point where it might be very difficult for humans to detect the fraud.

Given the erosion of trust in the media and the **rampant** spread of **hoaxes** via social media, it will become even more important for news organizations to **scrutinize** content that looks and sounds like the real deal. People should be looking at the lighting and shadows in the video, whether all the elements featured in the frame are the right size, and whether the audio is **synced** perfectly. **Doctored** content might not pass the scrutiny of a rigorous newsroom, but if posted as a **grainy** video to social media it could spread virally and trigger a political, diplomatic, or public relations disaster, or even start a war.

Text adapted from an article by
Olivia Solon. *The Guardian* [online] (July 26, 2017)

footage: filmació / filmación
to morph: aplicar canvis / aplicar cambios
to fool: enganyar / engañar
rampant: sense restriccions / sin restricciones
hoax: engany, trampa / engaño, fraude
to scrutinize: examinar detalladament / examinar detalladamente
synced: sincronitzat / sincronizado
doctored: manipulat / manipulado
grainy: granulat / granulado

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Artificial intelligence and computer graphics ☐ are the future of social media sites. ☐ are creating new types of video and audio manipulation tools. ☐ will benefit public figures such as Donald Trump. ☐ enable readers to spot fake news.	☐	☐	☐
2. Fake news will be more convincing in the future because ☐ people tend to have less critical thinking skills. ☐ people will be more familiar with image technology. ☐ it will incorporate improved image and voice technology. ☐ human behaviour is easy to imitate.	☐	☐	☐
3. Face2Face can currently ☐ capture someone's facial expressions and map them onto someone else's face. ☐ imitate someone's facial expressions. ☐ synthesize voice and incorporate it onto someone's image. ☐ capture someone's physical appearance.	☐	☐	☐
4. Recent research allows ☐ smartphones to synthesize voice. ☐ the creation of software to convert real voice into a synthesized one. ☐ the creation of microphones that synthesize voice. ☐ the creation of 3-5 minute audios.	☐	☐	☐
5. Which of the following statements is NOT true? ☐ Digital puppets will look and sound like real people. ☐ Face and voice-morphing technology will create more convincing fake news. ☐ Synthesized voice may deceive some security systems. ☐ Current software only works with live voice.	☐	☐	☐
6. There is certainly room for improvement in morphing technologies ☐ since they are able to exactly reproduce voice and image. ☐ since there are often sound delays in the videos. ☐ since facial expressions and voices may appear unreal. ☐ since humans can never detect fake videos.	☐	☐	☐
7. From now on, news organisations should ☐ manipulate news more often. ☐ not trust any information on social media. ☐ be more critical with their sources. ☐ pay particular attention to the features of videos.	☐	☐	☐
8. What is the danger of fake news, according to the author of the text? ☐ News agencies will never be able to detect fake news. ☐ Fake news will go viral on social media and create family conflicts. ☐ News agencies will spread fake news and create political conflicts. ☐ The viral presence of fake news on social media could create serious conflicts.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

SECRETS IN BUCKINGHAMSHIRE

There are secrets and there are secrets. The work done during the Second World War at Bletchley Park, a Victorian mansion fifty miles north of London, was so secret that the people who worked there didn't talk about it even to their friends or family. The work done at Bletchley Park is now well known: in recent years there have been major films, documentaries and books, and today it is a tourist attraction. So what took place there during the war?

Bletchley Park was purchased by the British government in 1938 as a location for its code-breaking school. The mansion was not really **suitable** for the task because the house was too small for all those who worked there, so many worked in "**huts**" around the main house. Bletchley Park was Britain's top code-breaking centre and security was very **tight**. The government feared that a Nazi agent would infiltrate the centre and ruin everything.

Station X, as Bletchley Park was known, was so efficient that it could read coded messages from German generals on the battlefield before they were even seen by Hitler in Berlin. Historians now believe that the code-breakers shortened the war in Europe by two years.

The Germans had invented Enigma, the most complicated encoding machine the world had ever seen. It resembled a large typewriter with lights and could, letter-by-letter, turn a normal message into entirely unintelligible nonsense that could be decoded only by using another Enigma machine. The design of Enigma machines allowed for millions of different configurations. Enigma machines were initially decoded by Polish mathematicians in 1932. When the Poles broke Enigma, the Germans changed the code only once every few months. Over the years, the Nazis continued to improve Enigma to increase the number of possible configurations to the billions, and with the **advent** of war, codes were changed at least once a day. Only a few weeks before Germany invaded Poland in 1939, Polish mathematicians showed their code-breaking machine, called a *bombe*, to the British. This information was extremely valuable, as the British had previously been unsuccessful at decoding German messages.

As the Second World War progressed, Station X became a hidden city with 10,000 people working there. About 75 % of the people working at Bletchley Park were women. Many of the code-breakers were Cambridge mathematicians, both experienced professors and recent graduates, but some were **recruited** because of their linguistic skills, knowledge of hieroglyphics, or brilliance at chess. Two of the best known code-breakers were Alan Turing and Gordon Welchman. Turing had significantly improved the design of the Polish machine, and Welchman then refined Turing's design. The result of their collaborations was the *Turing-Welchman Bombe*, named after the original Polish machine. The new Bombe went through all the possible Enigma configurations in order to reduce the possible number of settings to a **manageable** number that could be analyzed, and then decoded, by people.

The importance of code-breaking was recognized early on by Prime Minister Winston Churchill. In 1941, Turing and Welchman wrote directly to Churchill to ask for more resources. Churchill's now famous response was "Make sure they have all they want—extreme priority—and report to me that this has been done."

In 1945 Churchill ordered that all records of Bletchley Park be destroyed. The public first became aware of Bletchley Park because of a book published in 1974 that was authored by one of its former employees. Bletchley Park even has its own royal connection: in 2014 the visitor centre was opened by Catherine, Duchess of Cambridge (Kate Middleton), whose own grandmother had worked there during the war.

Text adapted from an article in *The Telegraph* (July 16, 2016)
and from information on the Bletchley Park Trust website

suitable: adequat / adecuado
hut: barracó / barracón
tight: estricte / estricto
advent: començament / comienzo
recruited: reclutat / reclutado
manageable: manejable

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The mansion at Bletchley Park was ☐ large enough for an entire school. ☐ too small for the number of people working there. ☐ converted into several huts. ☐ used as a shelter during Nazi attacks.	☐	☐	☐
2. The work done by the code-breakers at Bletchley Park ☐ had no effect on the outcome of the war. ☐ probably helped the Allies win the war earlier. ☐ was heavily criticized by Churchill. ☐ was infiltrated by the Nazis.	☐	☐	☐
3. Who built the Enigma machines? ☐ Germany. ☐ Polish mathematicians. ☐ The British Army. ☐ Alan Turing and Gordon Welchman.	☐	☐	☐
4. During the war, codes for Enigma machines ☐ changed daily. ☐ changed monthly. ☐ changed once every few months. ☐ never changed.	☐	☐	☐
5. The code-breakers at Bletchley Park included people who were ☐ very good at playing chess. ☐ mechanical engineers. ☐ originally from Poland. ☐ students from local universities.	☐	☐	☐
6. Churchill thought that code-breaking ☐ was interesting but too expensive. ☐ was important to winning the war. ☐ should be assigned to Army officers. ☐ could be done by anyone with some training.	☐	☐	☐
7. Bletchley Park was first discovered by the public because ☐ a documentary was made about it. ☐ Churchill gave many interviews about it. ☐ someone who had worked there wrote a book. ☐ the Poles reported on it to the British press.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following best describes the centre at Bletchley Park? ☐ A home owned by Queen Victoria. ☐ Government buildings turned into a tourist attraction. ☐ A school for mathematicians. ☐ The childhood home of Kate Middleton.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

HOW THE COLOUR RED **WARPS** THE MIND

We can never know what was going through our ancestors' minds, tens of thousands of years ago, when they first picked up natural **crayons** and began painting their bodies. But it is perhaps significant that they chose a rich, red colour—the colour of our blood and a **vivid** reminder of life, and death.

Today, shades of red are linked with power, aggression, and sex. And those associations may not be coincidence. A new **branch** of science called "colour psychology" has found that red can have a profound influence on our mood, perceptions and actions.

Wearing red can even change your physiology and balance of hormones. So what is it about the shades of red that makes them so potent? There is no doubt that our appreciation of red coincides with one of the most important events in our evolutionary history. Red skin is an important sign of dominance for many primates. Mandrill monkeys are perhaps the most famous example, with vivid markings on their face and bottom that signal their position in the group's strict hierarchy; the fitter, and more dominant an individual is, the redder he appears.

It was only in 2004 that two psychologists—Russell Hill and Robert Barton at the University of Durham—began to wonder whether humans might react in the same way. Although we don't tend to **flush** a vivid, inflamed red like a mandrill, we do sometimes burn up with anger. So the sight of red clothes could perhaps carry associations of aggression and dominance. The exact reason for these associations still remains a matter of debate. Researchers point to studies showing that people who wear red often feel more dominant themselves. Or perhaps the red intimidates the competitor: if you see red, you'll feel fear and be aware of your difficult situation, and as a result your testosterone drops.

Perhaps the most studied effect concerns the association of the colour with desire, seduction, and sin. A series of experiments, by Andrew Elliot and other colleagues at the University of Rochester in New York State, have all confirmed that men and women are both considered as being more attractive when wearing red compared to other colours. A possible explanation is that slightly redder skin seems to signal health and fitness; perhaps, by extension, we read the same from the clothes that we wear. Otherwise, not all the findings of colour psychology are robust enough to be fully trusted just yet. "I think the investigation is at a very early stage of development," says Elliot. "Eventually we might be able to use colour psychology to create a more productive working environment, but we're far from that point."

Elliot would also like to see more work investigating the rest of the rainbow. He has found that while red may **hinder** performance, green and blue can encourage creativity in certain kinds of word games. Even so, Elliot suspects that their influence will be fairly limited, compared to the potent effect that red has over our behaviour.

"The perception of red will always be associated with connotations and influences that run as deep as the blood in our veins. Perhaps we are only confirming what our ancestors realised when they first started painting their bodies: there is no other colour like it."

Text adapted from an article by
David Robson. *BBC.com* [online] (September 1, 2014)

to warp: torçar / torcer
crayon: llapis de color / lápiz de color
vivid: intens / intenso
branch: branca / rama
to flush: enrogir / enrojecer
to hinder: impedir

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[3 points: 0.375 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.125 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The reason why our ancestors picked up on the colour red is ☐ because it made them more aggressive. ☐ because it was a vivid colour. ☐ still a mystery to the experts. ☐ because it is the colour of our blood.	☐	☐	☐
2. "Colour psychology" has found that red ☐ was the favourite colour of our ancestors. ☐ can affect the way people behave. ☐ is a vivid reminder of life and death. ☐ was the first colour our ancestors used.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which of these statements is NOT true? ☐ For many primates, red is a sign of power. ☐ In the primate world red shows who the leader is. ☐ Mandrill monkeys' social order is marked by the colour red. ☐ Red only appears on the strongest primates.	☐	☐	☐
4. Russell Hill and Robert Barton ☐ affirm that humans don't follow the same pattern as monkeys. ☐ think that humans act with anger whenever they see red. ☐ want to know if the reactions of humans and monkeys to red are identical. ☐ doubt that humans could behave like mandrills right now.	☐	☐	☐
5. A series of experiments led by Professor Elliot have confirmed that people who ☐ wear red are considered more desirable. ☐ wear colours other than red are not attractive. ☐ wear red are more intelligent. ☐ choose red clothes are healthier.	☐	☐	☐
6. Professor Andrew Elliot says that colour psychology ☐ is not far from being fully developed. ☐ is now ready to create better conditions at work. ☐ is still in a premature phase. ☐ will soon create a productive working atmosphere.	☐	☐	☐
7. Professor Elliot has observed that ☐ red is the perfect colour for creativity in word games. ☐ red doesn't help in some word games. ☐ blue is worse than red in some word games. ☐ blue and green are not useful for word games.	☐	☐	☐
8. What is Professor Elliot's final conclusion about the perception of red? ☐ It has changed over the years. ☐ It is constantly in progress. ☐ It is related to blood. ☐ It has been the same throughout history.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

WHAT'S THE REAL HISTORY OF BLACK FRIDAY?

Black Friday is the day after Thanksgiving, when crowds of turkey-stuffed shoppers descend on stores all over the country to take advantage of the Christmas season's biggest **bargains**. But the real story behind Black Friday is a bit more complicated—and darker—than that.

The first recorded use of the term *Black Friday* was applied to a financial crisis, specifically, the crash of the U.S. gold market on September 24, 1869. Two speculators, Jay Gould and Jim Fisk, bought up as much as they could of the nation's gold, hoping **to drive** the price **up** and sell it for huge profits. On that Friday in September, the conspiracy was finally revealed, sending the Wall Street stock market into **bankruptcy**.

The most commonly repeated story behind the post-Thanksgiving shopping-related Black Friday tradition links it to **retailers**. As the story goes, after an entire year of operating at a loss ("in the red"), stores would earn a profit ("go into the black") on the day after Thanksgiving, because holiday shoppers spent so much money on discounted merchandise. Though it's true that retail companies used to record losses in red and profits in black when doing their **accounting**, this is an inaccurate version of Black Friday's origin.

In recent years, another myth has appeared, giving a particularly ugly **twist** to the tradition and claiming that back in the 1800s, Southern plantation owners could buy slaves at a discount on the day after Thanksgiving. Though this version of Black Friday's roots has understandably led some to call for a boycott of the retail holiday, it has no basis in fact.

The true story behind Black Friday, however, is quite different. Back in the 1950s, police in the city of Philadelphia used the term to describe the chaos on the day after Thanksgiving, when thousands of shoppers and tourists arrived in the city on the day before the big Army-Navy football game held on that Saturday every year. The Army-Navy game, one of the biggest rivalries in American sports, is usually played in Philadelphia, the first capital of the U.S. Philadelphia cops were not able to take the day off because they had to work extra-long **shifts** to deal with the big crowds and added traffic. Shoplifters would also take advantage of the confusion in stores to steal merchandise, adding to the policemen's headaches.

By 1961, the expression *Black Friday* had caught on in Philadelphia. The city's merchants tried unsuccessfully to change it into *Big Friday* in order to remove the negative connotations. The term didn't spread to the rest of the U.S. until much later. Sometime in the late 1990s, however, retailers found a way to reinvent Black Friday and turn it into something that reflected positively on them and their customers. The day after Thanksgiving became America's shopping day, marking the point when stores turned a profit. It is interesting to note, however, that stores traditionally see bigger sales on the Saturday before Christmas than on Black Friday.

The Black Friday story stuck, and soon the term's darker roots in Philadelphia were forgotten. Since then, the one-day sales bonanza has become a four-day event, and has inspired other retail holidays such as Small Business Saturday/Sunday and Cyber Monday. Stores started opening earlier and earlier on that Friday, until Walmart, the world's largest retailer, opened its stores on Thanksgiving evening in 2011. Ever since, retailers have been in a race to catch up and now, millions of Americans say they plan to shop immediately after their Thanksgiving meal. Retailers have come up with a name they hope will catch on: Grey Thursday.

Text adapted from an article by
Sarah Pruitt. *History.com* [on line] (November 24, 2015)

bargain: ganga
to drive up: incrementar
bankruptcy: bancarrota
retailer: comerciant que ven al detall / comerciante minorista
accounting: comptabilitat / contabilidad
twist: gir / giro
shift: torn / turno

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. On Black Friday ☐ you can find the biggest discounts of the year. ☐ lots of shoppers buy stuffed turkey. ☐ retailers sell merchandise at lower prices. ☐ shops all over the country increase prices.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which sentence is NOT true? ☐ Gould and Fisk managed to sell their gold at a high price. ☐ As a result of Gould and Fisk's conspiracy, Wall Street crashed in 1869. ☐ The term *Black Friday* was used for the first time in 1869. ☐ Gould and Fisk's speculative moves were discovered on a Friday.	☐	☐	☐
3. It is said that Black Friday owes its name to retailers because ☐ they sold a lot and made a profit on the day after Thanksgiving. ☐ they had losses and profits on the same day. ☐ the stores that didn't offer any discounts were in the red. ☐ they didn't make any profits on the day after Thanksgiving.	☐	☐	☐
4. According to the text, what's the relationship between slavery and Black Friday? ☐ None; the whole story is fake. ☐ Slaves used to be sold on Fridays. ☐ Slaves were cheaper after Thanksgiving. ☐ Extra help was needed on plantations after Thanksgiving.	☐	☐	☐
5. Police officers in Philadelphia used the term *Black Friday* to refer to the day when ☐ thousands of visitors to the city caused them a lot of trouble. ☐ the Army-Navy football match was played. ☐ stores opened later than usual. ☐ they could enjoy a long Thanksgiving holiday.	☐	☐	☐
6. The term *Black Friday*, with the meaning we know today, was widely used ☐ at the end of the 1990s. ☐ throughout the 1950s. ☐ from 2011 onwards. ☐ back in the 1800s.	☐	☐	☐
7. Nowadays, Black Friday sales ☐ last until the Monday after Thanksgiving. ☐ have been replaced by Cyber Monday. ☐ start very early on Thanksgiving Day. ☐ continue until the following Thursday.	☐	☐	☐
8. Grey Thursday refers to ☐ going shopping right after Thanksgiving dinner. ☐ the first time Walmart opened its stores on Thanksgiving Day. ☐ the shops that open on Thanksgiving Day. ☐ the day when most Americans go shopping.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

JAMIE'S SUGAR TAX ON FIZZY DRINKS

Jamie Oliver is an English celebrity chef, owner of more than 50 restaurants and also a personality known for his food television shows, cookbooks and more recently his global campaign for better food education. One of the actions of his global campaign is to impose a **levy** on sweet **fizzy** drinks sold in Jamie's restaurants in protest at the government's refusal to introduce a "sugar tax."

Oliver will add a 10 p (€ 0.15) charge to every drink with added sugar in an attempt to **highlight** the dangers of too much sugar as well as to send a message to the government to take urgent action on childhood obesity.

Several other restaurant chains are expected to join Oliver's "sugar tax" protest. All the money raised from the levy will be put into a foundation called *Sustain*, which will promote better food and farming policies and practices, to support children's healthy food initiatives across Britain. The Jamie Oliver Restaurant Group will make a donation of £25,000 to get the fund started. Oliver expects the charge—which he calls "the children's health levy"—to raise £80,000 in the first year.

Oliver said: "I was born into the restaurant industry and I truly believe that by joining together on this problem we not only send a powerful and strong message to government but we also have the potential to make a long lasting **legacy** that could make many parents be aware of the benefits that a healthy diet has on their children."

Oliver also added: "I have seen first-hand the heart breaking effects that poor diet and too much sugar is having on our children's health. Young children often need multiple teeth pulled out under anaesthetic and one in three kids now leaves primary school overweight or obese. Soft drinks are the biggest single source of sugar among school-age kids and teenagers and so we have to start here."

An explanation of the sugary drink levy will be printed on all menus in Jamie Oliver's restaurants and the waiters **will be briefed** about the alternative choices for children. Oliver points out that tap water is always freely available. Oliver does not allow fizzy, sugary drinks in his own home. He says his four children have grown up drinking mainly water or diluted fruit juice. He believes parents should explain to children which drinks are best for them and make healthy drinks fun—for instance, by adding freshly cut lemons, oranges or strawberries to iced water.

Simon Bladgen, chief executive of the Jamie Oliver Restaurant Group, said: "As a business we're concerned about the increasing number of illnesses related to the diet in the UK, especially in children, and while we're not against sugar, we do feel that we need to take the initiative when it comes to keeping our costumers informed, so a levy on these drinks allows us to send a message as well as raise money to help give children the knowledge to make better choices."

The idea has been welcomed by health activists. Tam Fry, a spokesman for the National Obesity Forum, said: "Once again Jamie Oliver has taken the initiative that should force the government to take measures as soon as possible. His levy will be applauded by everyone who understands obesity and the health damage of excessive sugar."

While all the main medical professions in Britain have given support to a 20 % tax on sugary soft drinks, the government has excluded such a move, preferring to work with the food industry on voluntary measures.

Text adapted from *The Sunday Times* (June 21, 2015)

levy: taxa / impuesto
fizzy: amb gas / con gas
highlight: fer patent / resaltar
legacy: llegat / herencia
to be briefed: ser informat / ser informado

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Jamie's sugar tax is imposed in ☐ all British restaurants. ☐ Jamie's restaurants only. ☐ restaurant chains only. ☐ hamburger restaurants in Britain.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the following sentences is NOT true? ☐ Jamie has created this tax to emphasize the dangers of too much sugar in our diet. ☐ The British government has imposed a sugar tax because of childhood obesity. ☐ The money from the tax will support programmes promoting healthy food. ☐ Jamie participates in a worldwide campaign to improve food education.	☐	☐	☐
3. Oliver considers that if all the restaurant industry is united on the "sugar tax," ☐ the Sustain foundation will not raise enough money to continue with its activities. ☐ the government will have more support to carry on with its policy on childhood obesity. ☐ parents will be convinced to give their children a healthy diet. ☐ they will send a strong message to the fizzy drink manufacturers.	☐	☐	☐
4. Jamie Oliver considers that soft drinks ☐ have improved the diet of many children. ☐ are a necessary source of energy for children. ☐ are often recommended by doctors and nurses. ☐ should be taxed by the government.	☐	☐	☐
5. At Jamie Oliver's restaurants ☐ fizzy drinks are not printed on the menus. ☐ waiters are told not to offer fizzy drinks. ☐ tap water is cheaper. ☐ fizzy drinks are more expensive.	☐	☐	☐
6. Jamie Oliver's own children ☐ can't drink fizzy sugary drinks at home. ☐ don't usually drink fizzy, sugary drinks at home. ☐ only drink water at home. ☐ hardly ever drink fruit juice.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to Simon Bladgen, a levy on fizzy drinks will ☐ stop young people from buying too many fizzy drinks. ☐ make obese children lose weight by consuming fewer fizzy drinks. ☐ make people aware of the risks of too much sugar in their diet. ☐ help the government policy on financing healthy diets for young people.	☐	☐	☐
8. Although the main medical professions support a 20 % tax on sugary drinks, the government has decided ☐ to ignore the proposal made by the doctors. ☐ to study the proposal carefully before taking any move. ☐ to promote optional actions among the food industry. ☐ to ban soft drink advertising.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

HOW A ROBOT COULD BE GRANDMA'S NEW **CAREGIVER**

With an ageing population and care costs rising, robots and smart homes may be a solution. But would you want a plastic dog to look after your loved ones?

Sitting in a studio in Kensington, London, the designer Sebastian Conran walks me through a worst-case scenario. "Basically, what it's looking for is a break in routine," he explains, pointing to a drawing of an elderly woman lying on the floor of her home. "There's an event. The e-sensor in the room notices that you've fallen over. MiRo goes to investigate." MiRo is a robotic dog. There is an early model close to where we are sitting. Its head sits above a torso without arms or legs, its ears carry hidden speakers, and its big eyes stare out at me.

Conran's company describes MiRo as a biomimetic companion robot, and says it will eventually work with facial recognition technology to make life easier for its owner. For example, the robot could **prompt** people to take medicine, or remind them of visitors' names, or question them if it thinks there is a problem. "It tries talking to you," he continues, "and then it will send a signal to the central office. Someone in the central office will then talk on the home speaker, asking if you're all right, and telling you to touch your wrist." Conran points at the wristband the elderly woman in the picture is wearing. It is another key part of his system because it monitors the vital signs of its wearer 24 hours a day. "If you touch your wrist the process will stop but will be recorded," he says. "If you don't touch your wrist it will contact a caregiver, who can see your heart rate and body temperature. The system rewinds the recording using the cameras in the home to see what happened. So when the ambulance gets there, the doctor will know what to expect."

Many of these visions are just **emerging**, but at a time of rising elderly populations and less government **funding** for health care, they raise important questions about where we are going with care. Can robots supplement human contact? Do economic realities mean technology is pushing some of society's most vulnerable into the arms of machines?

The technologists insist that their creations are designed to work alongside people, and not to replace them. They say there is a lot of misunderstanding about what robots are and whether they could have human-like qualities and give emotional support. Some technologists are against the idea of robots that resemble humans precisely for this reason. There are things that people are good at, and there are things that machines are good at. Designing robots to look like human beings could dangerously confuse these lines, they warn. Politicians might decide to spend much less money on doctors and nurses because they think robots can do everything.

Is a robot something people would actually want as a caregiver? Conran mentions an interesting point. For the generations now growing up that are accustomed to digital culture, centred on their instant gratification, the idea of 24-hour attention may even be desired. "These people are going to have completely different expectations," he says. "They will expect the state to provide for them in a different way than previous generations did. The quality of life has constantly got better and better, and we're coming up against the fact that, instead of getting better and better, things are beginning to drop off. Ageing needs to be improved."

Text adapted from an article by
Thomas McMullan. *The Guardian* (November 6, 2016)

caregiver: cuidador, cuidadora
to prompt: indicar
to emerge: emergir / emerger
funding: fons / fondos

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

		Espai per al corrector/a		
		Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1.	Robots and smart homes might ☐ be a solution to anyone who lives on their own. ☐ prevent ageing. ☐ be a solution to increasing elderly care costs. ☐ become plastic dogs.	☐	☐	☐
2.	When you fall over, MiRo ☐ helps you stand up. ☐ notices that and gets closer to you. ☐ controls your body temperature. ☐ tells you to touch your wrist.	☐	☐	☐
3.	MiRo ☐ only physically resembles a human person. ☐ can tell you to take medicine and remind you of names. ☐ can have a normal conversation with you. ☐ can prevent you from falling.	☐	☐	☐
4.	If a robotic dog like MiRo takes care of you, ☐ you need to wear a wristband that constantly checks your health. ☐ there's always an ambulance that will know exactly what to do. ☐ it will come to you and take your body temperature. ☐ you need to call the central office with your vital signs every day.	☐	☐	☐
5.	Robots ☐ are created to eventually substitute what human caregivers do. ☐ are designed to give and receive emotional support as human caregivers do. ☐ are created to solve misunderstandings with human caregivers. ☐ are designed to complement what human caregivers can do.	☐	☐	☐
6.	Which of the following statements is NOT true? ☐ Some scientists believe robots should not have human-like traits. ☐ Government authorities will definitely invest more money on automated care. ☐ Both humans and machines are each good at certain things. ☐ There's a lot of debate as to whether robots can have human-like traits.	☐	☐	☐
7.	Present-day generations ☐ might want to have constant care. ☐ will be very interested in managing robots. ☐ will surely have a better life than older generations. ☐ should be given a robot by the state authorities.	☐	☐	☐
8.	Sebastian Conran believes that ☐ economic realities make automated care a need. ☐ robots will entirely replace human caregivers. ☐ ageing is getting easier. ☐ the State will cover the costs of automated care.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

NORWAY, THE GREEN PATH

Norway, a country of 5.2 million people and one of the richest countries in the world, is trying to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and meet ambitious climate goals. Many Norwegians today are taking part in the world's most ambitious governmental effort to reduce the use of fossil fuels.

Norway has become a global model of how to get the public interested in buying electric vehicles. The country has the highest proportion of electric car registrations in the world—by a long margin. According to a recent study, 1/3 of all new car registrations were of electric vehicles.

This interest in electric cars is attracting the attention of researchers and government officials from around the world. Some people wonder if the Norwegian program is an efficient way to reduce air pollutants. And some elements of the program simply may not be possible in other countries. But for many, Norway is showing a **path** forward.

At first, it seems ironic that electric cars are so popular in a country that is one of the world's biggest producers of oil (Norway is the world's 7th largest producer of petroleum). But Norway also has many fast rivers, allowing it to generate almost all of its electricity from hydropower. As a result, Norway's electricity is clean and relatively cheap. Countries where much of the electricity is generated by power plants burning coal, like the U.S., China, or Germany, would not see as many environmental benefits from switching to electric vehicles.

Electric cars, however, are not popular in all countries with fast rivers. So what does Norway have that others don't? In a word: incentives. Norwegians pay some of the world's highest taxes, but they also receive huge benefits for buying electric cars. An electric vehicle pays no road tax or registration fee, no sales tax, and no **value-added tax**. Public parking is free; **tolls** on roads, bridges, and tunnels are free, and it is free to transport electric cars on ferries. In addition, electric cars can be charged for free at public charging points, and they can also travel in restricted bus lanes.

Those incentives are working. Electric vehicles now account for 2.5 % of all cars in Norway. After more than a decade of government support, officials had expected that there would be 50,000 electric cars on Norway's roads by the end of 2017. The government program has been even more successful than hoped: by September 2015, over 66,000 all-electric cars were in use. The American luxury car manufacturer Tesla, which only makes fully electric cars, sells approximately 30 % of its cars in Europe, and its largest European market is Norway.

Naturally, all those incentives cost a lot of money. In fact, the incentives have been so successful that some of them will be reduced in the future. Electric car owners will have to pay 50 % of the road tax starting in 2018, and all of it in 2020. Local governments can now decide if they offer free parking and free tolls. Many smaller cities have said that they will start treating electric cars like all other vehicles because they need the extra cash to repair bridges and tunnels. Free charging of electric vehicles will probably remain, however, because Norway has so much inexpensive hydroelectric power. The effect of eliminating some incentives for electric cars in Norway remains to be seen, although in Japan, electric car registrations fell by 20 % when some incentives ended. The green approach, although widely supported by Norwegians, may turn out to be too expensive, even for a rich country.

Text adapted from *The New York Times* (October 19, 2015)

path: camí / camino
value-added tax: IVA
toll: peatge / peaje

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The reason the government of Norway promotes the sale of electric cars is that it wants ☐ to support the local coal industry. ☐ to lower the levels of gas emissions. ☐ to limit petroleum and gas production. ☐ to support Norwegian companies producing electric cars.	☐	☐	☐
2. People in other countries study the evolution of the car market in Norway because ☐ there are more cars in Norway than in any other country. ☐ electric cars were only recently introduced in the country. ☐ a high percentage of electric cars are sold there. ☐ the government has decided to restrict the sale of cars.	☐	☐	☐
3. Electricity production in Norway mainly depends on ☐ coal. ☐ gas. ☐ oil. ☐ water.	☐	☐	☐
4. The effects on the climate of moving away from gasoline-fueled cars to electric cars are greater in Norway than in a country like Germany because ☐ Norway produces more oil than Germany. ☐ Norway produces cheap, clean electricity. ☐ no electric cars are made in Germany. ☐ of Norway's location.	☐	☐	☐
5. The text claims that Norway is able to provide free public charging of electric vehicles because ☐ electricity is cheap to produce in the country. ☐ electricity is produced from Norwegian gas. ☐ it is a world leader in oil production. ☐ only a very few vehicles in the country are fully electric.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of the following is NOT an incentive offered by the Norwegian government to buy an electric car? ☐ Free charging. ☐ Free car repairs. ☐ Free parking. ☐ Free registration.	☐	☐	☐
7. The program to promote the use of electric cars ☐ has been a failure in many ways. ☐ has succeeded beyond expectations. ☐ has had very little impact. ☐ cannot be evaluated yet.	☐	☐	☐
8. The text states that the benefits of operating an electric car in Norway ☐ will remain unchanged during the next 5 years. ☐ will be eliminated in part in the next 5 years. ☐ will be increased in the next 5 years. ☐ will depend on the production of Norwegian gas and oil.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE SECRET LIFE OF WORDS: HOW ENGLISH BECAME ENGLISH

Communication is essential to our lives, but how often do we stop to think about where the words we use have come from? Have you ever thought about which words in English have been **borrowed** from Arabic, French or Dutch? A recent book by Henry Hitchings, *The Secret Life of Words*, shows how and why English has absorbed words from more than 350 other languages, many originating from the most unlikely of places, such as *shampoo* from Hindi and *kiosk* from Turkish. Indeed, words do have a secret life, or rather a secret past. One learns things like that the English words taken from Basque are only two: *anchovy* and *Basque*. But etymology is just Hitching's starting point; he shows us that the history of our vocabulary is the history of our place in the world.

Hitchings' book covers the history of the English language from pre-Roman Britain to the latest street **slang**, though individual chapters tend to concentrate on particular cultural encounters or themes, sometimes in an extended way. A chapter called "Powwow", for instance, is an interesting account of the British early exploration of America and their encounter with its languages. A chapter called "Connoisseur" explores the 18th century's extensive relation between English and French, the rise of scientific writing, the use of Italian terms in music, and the lexicon of travel and exploration, including an account of the first confrontations of the British with Australian Aboriginal languages.

We usually talk of "borrowing" words. It is a way of describing in a simple manner a process that is very complex. Hitchings gives an intelligent account of what really happens when two languages come into contact. There is an exchange of terms; but the **breadth and depth** of that exchange is dependent upon the strength of the relationship. Long connections between two languages are likely to generate more borrowings. English, for example, has taken more words from French than from anywhere else, because the British have been engaged with French culture for a thousand years. But English has also taken a surprising amount from Native American languages, because the British settled there and, at the beginning, enjoyed fruitful relationships with the Native Americans. In contrast, English has taken next to nothing from Australian Aboriginal languages.

One of the themes of *The Secret Life of Words* is the recurring tension between those who want the language to be pure, simple and Germanic, and those who **relish** complexity and adopting new words. Hitchings points out that words only come into the language because there is a need for them, though at the same time, he thinks that "there are strong reasons for wanting a large degree of stability in our language."

Hitchings is clearly well informed on this subject. His book includes an extensive bibliography and index and many clarifying and interesting footnotes. Furthermore, the book is written in a clever, persuasive and delightful style and contains entertaining observations. All in all, *The Secret Life of Words* is an exhaustive account not only of the history of English, but also of how words witness history, reflect social change and remind us of our turbulent past.

Text adapted from *The Independent* (May 4, 2008)

borrow: manllevar / tomar prestado
slang: argot
breadth and depth: amplitud i profunditat / amplitud y profundidad
relish: gaudir / disfrutar

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Who is Henry Hitchings? ☐ The author of a very influential English grammar. ☐ An expert in the etymology of Arabic, French and Dutch. ☐ The author of a book on the history of the English language. ☐ An expert on the influence of English communication in many languages.	☐	☐	☐
2. We learn from the text that the Basque language ☐ has had a common past with the development of English. ☐ has as many borrowings from English as from French. ☐ has a difficult etymology because of its secret past. ☐ has had a minor influence on English vocabulary.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the text, English can be seen as a language ☐ capable of absorbing many foreign words. ☐ that is spoken by the majority in 350 countries. ☐ unable to adopt words from Hindu and Turkish. ☐ that became popular with the study of etymology.	☐	☐	☐
4. The aim of Hitchings' book is ☐ to study how "Powwow" can be useful in world explorations. ☐ to analyse the effect of borrowing on English vocabulary. ☐ to explain the difficulties of English in borrowing words of French origin. ☐ to determine the benefits of English as a language for scientific writings.	☐	☐	☐
5. The text explains that borrowings are normally the result of ☐ having many "connoisseurs" studying languages in your own country. ☐ nations wanting to impose their own language on colonized peoples. ☐ strong relationships between people speaking different languages. ☐ the love of the British for discovering remote places in the world.	☐	☐	☐
6. Hitchings argues that English can only develop if ☐ it remains pure and simple and uses words of Germanic origin. ☐ it becomes a language largely appreciated by purist grammarians. ☐ it becomes a language that proves able to accept needless words. ☐ it remains largely stable but adopts new useful words.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to the author, Hitchings has written a book ☐ that is full of information but with some boring chapters. ☐ with not enough specific bibliography on its subject. ☐ which is highly specialized but enjoyable to read. ☐ that will encourage readers to learn foreign languages.	☐	☐	☐
8. The text suggests that words ☐ can be a source of knowledge about our historical past. ☐ can carry secrets that are only known to native speakers. ☐ from foreign languages should not be officially accepted. ☐ have been borrowed so that languages can have many synonyms.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

STARTING EARLY

One night, 18-year-old Ritesh Agarwal was locked out of his apartment in Delhi. It was an unfortunate minor incident that would change his life. Forced to check into a hotel, he found himself in a situation he had already experienced several times while travelling in India. "The receptionist was sleeping, electrical **sockets** did not work, the bathroom was leaking, and at the end they wouldn't let me pay by card. I felt if this was my problem, this had to be a problem for many travellers. Why can't India have a good standard of hotel rooms at a reasonable price?" he says.

Four years later, at the age of 22, Mr Agarwal is the founder and chief executive of Oyo Rooms, a network of 3,000 hotels operating in 140 cities across India, with monthly **revenues** of $3.5 million and 1,500 employees. The firm works with independent hotels to improve their **facilities** and train staff, renames them with the Oyo **brand**, and from then on takes a percentage of the hotel's revenues. The owner of the hotel benefits from a higher occupancy rate, thanks to the new brand name. As part of the business, Mr Agarwal has also developed an app, which guests can use to book rooms, get directions to the hotel and order room service.

Despite such rapid growth, he says the early days were "extremely difficult." "Nobody would believe this could be a technology business in the future," he says. But some people did believe in him. The idea won him a **fellowship** which pays for 20 teenagers to stop studying and set up a business instead. He used the money from the fellowship to start the business.

The firm launched in 2013 with just $900 a month, working with one hotel near Delhi. "I used to be the manager, engineer, receptionist, and I also delivered stuff in hotel rooms," says Mr Agarwal. "At night I would write codes to develop our app and improve our website. But at the same time I was also building strong teams because I wanted the project to grow."

The only way he could persuade investors was to show them just how bad some **budget hotels** in India were. "I took our first investor to our hotel and to other hotels where there were many problems. He saw the conviction in us and agreed we could make a difference," recalls Mr Agarwal. Now that the business has grown, it has become much easier to attract investors, including banks.

Mr Agarwal's journey from college **dropout** to business owner may seem smooth, but he admits starting a business at 17 was not easy. "Normal things like getting a bank account or hiring staff were more challenging. Some people also saw my age as a chance to take advantage, but I met some very good people, too. Overall, my experience was quite positive," he says.

He has ambitious plans for the firm, which he wants to expand abroad. Currently, his focus is on making improvements based on customer feedback and he is optimistic about expanding the company at home, saying India's increasing smartphone and internet penetration offers "huge potential."

For those keen to emulate his success, his advice—unsurprisingly—is to "start early." "Start really fast and, if you fail, you will learn and the chances of success in the next venture will increase," he says.

Text adapted from *BBC News* (September 6, 2015)

socket: endoll / enchufe
revenue: benefici / beneficio
facilities: instal·lacions / instalaciones
brand: marca
fellowship: beca
budget hotel: hotel de baix cost / hotel de bajo coste
dropout: persona que abandona els estudis / persona que abandona los estudios

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Ritesh Agarwal got the idea to start his own business ☐ when he was travelling around India. ☐ when he couldn't pay by credit card in a hotel. ☐ when he saw that travellers were having problems in India. ☐ when he couldn't enter his flat one night.	☐	☐	☐
2. Mr Agarwal's company ☐ buys and sells unbranded hotels. ☐ mainly develops apps for hotel guests. ☐ benefits from other hotels' occupancy rates. ☐ improves hotels and gives them its brand.	☐	☐	☐
3. The beginning of Oyo Rooms was difficult because ☐ few people thought this business had a future. ☐ some people thought technology was not a good business. ☐ Agarwal's fellowship demanded that he stopped studying. ☐ the money from the fellowship was not enough to start out.	☐	☐	☐
4. Which sentence is NOT true? In his first hotel, Mr Agarwal ☐ had to do all sorts of jobs. ☐ was in charge of the hotel's website and app. ☐ already had the idea to make the project big. ☐ had a team of people to work for him.	☐	☐	☐
5. The investors were convinced ☐ when they compared an Oyo hotel to other, unimproved ones. ☐ when they saw that all Indian hotels had many problems. ☐ after the banks were also interested in the project. ☐ after seeing budget hotels that were as good as the Oyo hotel.	☐	☐	☐
6. Mr Agarwal admits that ☐ he couldn't open any bank accounts in the beginning. ☐ everyone took advantage of his young age. ☐ leaving college at seventeen was easier than it might have seemed. ☐ his experiences with good people exceeded the bad ones.	☐	☐	☐
7. At present, Mr Agarwal ☐ is expanding his hotel network to other countries. ☐ pays little attention to customer feedback. ☐ is improving the potential of smartphones for his business. ☐ hopes to expand in India thanks to the wider use of the internet.	☐	☐	☐
8. His advice to other people is to start a business young because ☐ if you fail, what you learn will be useful for your next attempt. ☐ it is easier for young people to find investors to support their ideas. ☐ studying is the key to success in the business world. ☐ if you fail, you still have time to go back to school.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

ARE LOVE-LOCKS ON BRIDGES ROMANTIC OR A MENACE?

Beautiful bridges in Paris are being ruined by an epidemic of **padlocks**. But is the growing trend for love-locks a thoughtless act of vandalism, or just a harmless expression of love?

It seemed romantic when Carolyn Barnabo and Clive Roberts attached a padlock to the Pont des Arts and symbolically threw the key into the Seine. Five years later they are married and their love is still strong, but Carolyn's fondness for love-**locks** certainly isn't. "It's just out of control and I feel so bad that we contributed to it," says Carolyn. "This beautiful bridge is ruined." There were just a few love-locks on the bridge when she attached hers and posted photos on her blog. Now there are thousands on bridges all over Paris.

The locks first started appearing on bridges in Paris around 2006, shortly after young couples in Italy had begun attaching padlocks to the Ponte Milvio over Rome's river Tiber, mimicking the protagonists of a popular Italian novel. In 2007 the **mayor** of Rome introduced fines for anyone leaving a padlock on this bridge. "After Rome started forbidding the locks, couples from all over Europe came to Paris," Lorna Taylor explains. She and friend Lisa Anselmo started the No Love-Locks campaign in January 2014. "The delicate Pont des Arts, which has become a freakish mass of indistinguishable metal pieces, is now in mortal danger," Lisa Anselmo adds. They say the City of Love has now become the City of Locks, and they have counted at least eight bridges over the Seine and three over the Canal Saint Martin where padlocks have spread "like fungus." Anselmo thinks that this trend "**defaces** and damages historic structures, and it is already imposing itself on other cities around Europe, where some of the bridges involved are hundreds of years old."

The padlock supposedly symbolises a **bond** between two people in love—but local authorities are now removing some padlocks from time to time. It was only after a wall on the Pont des Arts collapsed under the weight of the locks that the Paris authorities got serious about putting an end to the practice. "Some of the **railings** have 500 kilograms of locks by the time they are removed. The one that collapsed weighed 700 kilograms. They're a costly problem for the city and also a safety one," Lorna Taylor says. Now, city officials in Paris are experimenting with panels of thick glass to protect the bridges from the damage caused by padlocks.

Described as an "epidemic" by the No Love-Locks campaign, padlocks are spreading around the world, and they are no longer restricted to bridges. Love-locks have appeared on the top of the Eiffel Tower and others can be found on fences in London. And they are not restricted to tourist destinations either—four have already appeared on St Botolph's Bridge in Boston, Lincolnshire, which only opened in February 2014. Many businesses have benefitted from this **trend**: some offer engraved padlocks in heart shapes and even one website suggests locations to attach them in Amsterdam, Chicago, Prague, Rome or Sydney. Lisa Anselmo says: "If a city wants to designate a space uniquely for love-locks, and restrict the practice on non-designated areas, that's not a bad idea. The question is how to find a way for love-locks and **heritage** to co-exist."

Despite attaching her own love lock in Paris five years ago, Carolyn now regrets that she contributed to this horrendous sight. "I would hate to see any beautiful bridges in England get like that. It was a nice idea, but I hope it dies out soon."

Text adapted from *BBC News* (May 5, 2014)

padlock, lock: cadenat / candado
mayor: alcalde
defaces (to deface): desfigurar
bond: lligam / vínculo
railing: barana / barandilla
trend: tendència, moda / tendencia, moda
heritage: patrimoni històric / patrimonio histórico

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Carolyn Barnabo and Clive Roberts left a lock on a bridge in Paris ☐ because it was a romantic thing to do. ☐ to contribute to the Parisian tradition. ☐ because they were fond of locks. ☐ in order to write an entry in a blog.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the sentences is FALSE? The custom of attaching locks on bridges ☐ was made popular by an Italian novel. ☐ is prohibited in Rome. ☐ follows an Italian tradition. ☐ was exported to Paris.	☐	☐	☐
3. The phrase "padlocks have spread like fungus" means that ☐ fungus appear on the bridges where padlocks are attached. ☐ padlocks are attached mainly on historic bridges. ☐ eight bridges over the river Seine were seriously deteriorated. ☐ padlocks have appeared in great quantities and very quickly.	☐	☐	☐
4. The municipal authorities in Paris decided to eradicate this practice ☐ after they had removed padlocks from bridges several times. ☐ when part of a historic bridge fell because of the weight of the locks. ☐ only when the eight bridges got covered by 500 kilograms of locks. ☐ when the railings of the Pont des Arts had to be removed.	☐	☐	☐
5. The city of Paris is putting panels of glass on bridges ☐ to protect the locks that are already attached. ☐ to let people see the locks more safely. ☐ to prevent the damage that the locks cause. ☐ to make an experiment on the bridges.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to the text, padlock sellers ☐ are making profits from this epidemic. ☐ sell only heart-shaped padlocks. ☐ tell you where you must put yours. ☐ sell them only through their website.	☐	☐	☐
7. Love-locks ☐ are restricted in European cities, like Paris or London. ☐ are limited to bridges or fences. ☐ are not found in non-tourist destinations. ☐ can now be found in a variety of places.	☐	☐	☐
8. Lisa Anselmo thinks that it would be a good idea for local authorities ☐ to assign a place for people to attach their locks. ☐ to restrict love-locks anywhere in the city. ☐ to keep love-locks in historic areas. ☐ to forbid love-locks everywhere, once and for all.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

ESPERANTO AND UNIVERSAL COMMUNICATION

Today, English has no rival as an international *lingua franca*. However, things could have been different if Esperanto, an artificial language invented in 1887 by Ludwig Lazarus Zamenhof, a Jewish doctor from Bialystok (modern-day Poland but then part of the Russian Empire), had become a common language. Esperanto is made up of key structures from different linguistic families (Latinate, Germanic, Slavic and Semitic). The word *Esperanto* derives from *Doktoro Esperanto* ("Esperanto" translates as "one who hopes"), the pseudonym under which Zamenhof published the first grammar of Esperanto. Zamenhof's goal was to create an easy-to-learn, politically neutral language that would transcend nationality and encourage peace and international understanding between people with different languages.

In a letter to a friend, Zamenhof explained why he was worried about human communication: "The place where I was born and spent my childhood gave direction to all my future **struggles**. In Bialystok the inhabitants were divided into four distinct elements: Russians, Poles, Germans and Jews; each of these spoke their own language and looked on all the others as enemies. Living in such a town made me feel the misery caused by language division. The diversity of languages is the first, or at least the most influential, basis for the separation of the human family into groups of enemies. I was brought up as an idealist. I was taught that all people were brothers, while outside in the street at every step I felt that there were no people, only Russians, Poles, Germans and Jews."

In 1905, Esperanto's first international congress took place in Boulogne-sur-Mer, in France. Then, in 1920, the League of Nations (the precursor of the United Nations) recommended that its member states incorporate the language, despite **misgivings** in France, as at that time French was the dominant international tongue. However, the advent of the Second World War and Nazi expansion put an end to the possibility of the language, which was invented by a Jew, from becoming the new international *lingua franca*. Nevertheless, more than a century since Zamenhof published his first grammar enthusiasts of Esperanto continue to promote the usefulness of the tongue. "Esperanto is much easier to learn than English," says Ramon Perera, a member of the Associació Catalana d'Esperanto and a teacher of the language for the past 20 years. "Esperanto," he says, "is a fairer language because none of its speakers have an advantage over the others." Perera says that up to two years are needed to learn the language, "depending on the capabilities of each person, the hours dedicated to it and the level they want to reach."

Perera began learning the language some 38 years ago when a friend lent him a book written in Esperanto. He took a four-week intensive course, which left him captivated by the language's "simple and logical" grammar. From that moment on, he became a dedicated "Esperantist" and has since met speakers from all over Europe, something that has been aided by the advent of the Internet. "It is a language that works and that could solve the world's communication problems," he says. In fact, the French economist François Grin, in 2005, presented a report to the European Parliament that proposed adopting Esperanto as a common language in the European Union, which would save the Union 25 million euros every year. For the moment, that report has been **filed away** somewhere, but according to **estimates** by the World Esperanto Association, there are as many as two million Esperanto speakers who hope that one day their adopted language will **take root** and a new era of universal communication will begin.

Text adapted from *Catalonia Today* (October 31, 2013)

struggle: lluita / lucha
misgiving: recel / recelo
filed away (to file away): arxivar / archivar
estimate: valoració / valoración
take root (to take root): arrelar / arraigar

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Who was Doktoro Esperanto? ☐ The leader of an organization in favour of international languages. ☐ The pseudonym of a novelist of Slavic origin. ☐ The inventor of an artificial, neutral language. ☐ The title of the first published grammar of Esperanto.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, Zamenhof was ☐ an idealist in favour of international understanding. ☐ a believer in the impossibility of human dreams. ☐ an idealist in favour of translation for peaceful purposes. ☐ a believer in the benefits of speaking many languages.	☐	☐	☐
3. As a child, Zamenhof quickly realized that language division ☐ was a necessity in the Russian Empire. ☐ makes people better informed about others. ☐ makes people more sensitive to differences. ☐ creates barriers to common humanity.	☐	☐	☐
4. At the time of the first Esperanto international congress, the French were ☐ clearly against the fact that it was held in French territory. ☐ not enthusiastic about a new international language. ☐ worried about the use of French as an international language. ☐ against the use of a single language for international communication.	☐	☐	☐
5. The text implies that the Nazi regime would not favour Esperanto because ☐ Zamenhof was a poor speaker of German. ☐ it would put an end to the Second World War. ☐ it had been created by a Jewish person. ☐ it was a tool that could be used against Germany.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to Ramon Perera, a good thing about Esperanto is that ☐ it was created by speakers of different cultures. ☐ it began to expand in the Russian Empire. ☐ it will make people learn other languages. ☐ it is not the language of any particular community.	☐	☐	☐
7. The French economist François Grin argued that the use of Esperanto in the EU would ☐ reduce many travelling expenses. ☐ make state members more efficient. ☐ help save a great amount of money. ☐ increase people's interest in languages.	☐	☐	☐
8. The text suggests that the European Parliament has ☐ shown little interest in the use of Esperanto. ☐ denied that there are many Esperanto speakers. ☐ said that Esperanto is a useless language. ☐ said that Esperanto could become a common language.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE LAST OF THE NOBLEST GENERATION

Harry Patch, the last survivor of the First World War, and the man who reminded the modern world of its obscene massacre, died at the age of 111. His life ended on a fine summer morning in his native Somerset, many miles from the Belgian land of Ypres where so many of his comrades fell, and where he so nearly joined them. For decades he kept the sights and sounds of that terrible experience to himself. But then, at the age of 100, he began to talk…

Born in the village of Coombe Down, Harry left school at 14 for an apprenticeship with a plumber, and would, no doubt, have lived a life of peaceful anonymity if the war hadn't been declared. Being too young at first, at the age of 17 Harry was **conscripted**. "I didn't want to go and fight anyone, but it was a case of having to," he said. He was in charge of a machine gun, and, by his 19th birthday, was in a **trench** in the middle of one of the most famous and bloodiest battles of the First World War: the Battle of Ypres. "Anyone who tells you he wasn't **scared** is a damned liar," Harry would later say. "We lived by the hour… You saw the sun rise; hopefully, you'd see it set. If you saw it set, you hoped you'd see it rise."

Many didn't. One of them was a young soldier whom Patch and his comrades found in the battlefield, badly wounded by **shrapnel**. "Shoot me," he said, and then, before Harry could react, he died with the words "Mother!" on his lips. It was but one of the phantoms from the trenches that Harry carried with him until his death. Later on, in September 1917, came the German projectile which would hit Harry. It burst among his **mates** with such force that three of them were never found again. Harry, some metres away, was seriously wounded, his stomach pierced by shrapnel. He was taken to a **CCS (casualty clearing station)**, where he lay, untreated in maddening pain, for one day and a half. Finally, a doctor came, and, with no anaesthetic, took out the metal while four men held him down. Although he would not be **demobbed** for another year, that was the end of Harry's war. He returned home, to plumbing, marriage, two sons, and an old age that saw him survive both sons and his wife.

All this time, he had kept those memories of war to himself, telling no one. But then, as he passed his 100th birthday, a journalist called Richard Emden asked Harry if he would talk of war. He agreed and he wrote, with Richard's help, his life story, and became a witness for those comrades who had been killed so many years before. When Richard Emden went to see him, Harry sat at a table in the morning room of his house. The conversation went mainly one-way. Harry's mind was sharp, and his sight good, but his voice was soft and delicate, and he was practically speechless. The journalist ended the interview before he had intended, afraid to be more of an inconvenience than he had already been.

His voice and body may have died, but his words on war should live on, resonating strongly. Harry Patch had words for all his experiences. They were spoken with an anger that lasted all his adult life. "War," he said, "is organised murder, and nothing else."

Text adapted from *The Independent* (July 26, 2009)

conscripted: cridat a files, reclutat / llamado a filas, reclutado
trench: trinxera / trinchera
scared (to be scared): tenir por / tener miedo
shrapnel: metralla
mate: company / compañero
CCS (casualty clearing station): hospital de campanya / hospital de campaña
demobbed: desmobilitzat, que ha deixat de servir a l'exèrcit / desmovilizado, que ha dejado de servir en el ejército

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Which of the following sentences about Harry Patch is FALSE? ☐ He was the only survivor of the First World War. ☐ He only explained his experiences when he was 100. ☐ He nearly died during the Battle of Ypres. ☐ He died at the age of 111 in his home country.	☐	☐	☐
2. When the First World War began, Harry Patch ☐ was too young to be called into the army. ☐ was looking forward to joining the army. ☐ had already been enrolled in the army. ☐ was ready to be enrolled but he was at school.	☐	☐	☐
3. Harry explains that during the Battle of Ypres, the soldiers were ☐ only focused on winning the battle. ☐ constantly worried about their survival. ☐ not quite aware their lives were in danger. ☐ not really worried about being killed.	☐	☐	☐
4. When Harry and his comrades found an injured soldier in the battle field ☐ they took him to the trenches for shelter. ☐ they took him still alive to a casualty clearing station. ☐ they decided to shoot him because he asked them to. ☐ they couldn't do anything to save his life.	☐	☐	☐
5. After being seriously wounded, Harry was taken to a CCS where ☐ he was operated on, after being in pain for more than one day. ☐ he was left alone in terrible pain for less than one day. ☐ he was immediately treated by a doctor. ☐ four men took out the metal without anesthetics.	☐	☐	☐
6. The war finished for Harry Patch ☐ the year after he was demobbed. ☐ several months after his recovery. ☐ immediately after being wounded. ☐ when he was sent back home.	☐	☐	☐
7. Shortly before Harry died, Richard Emden interviewed him and ☐ Harry did most of the talking. ☐ Harry spoke in a surprisingly clear voice. ☐ Richard did most of the talking. ☐ Richard was not able to talk too much.	☐	☐	☐
8. After all his experiences in the First World War ☐ Harry thought that no war could ever be justified. ☐ Harry's views on war became ambiguous. ☐ Harry chose never again to talk about war. ☐ Harry never again expressed his opinions about war.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE RIGHT TO VOTE

"Votes for women? What a ridiculous idea!" Some of the arguments that male voters used in the past to prevent women the right to vote would seem unacceptable to most of us nowadays.

However, many people would be surprised to read that the women of Switzerland received the right to vote in 1971, and yet **canton** Appenzell Innerrhoden resisted until 1991. Most male and female residents in that part of the country saw the law preventing women's **suffrage** as one of their cultural traditions, along with voting by assembly in the town square. Only after two women **filed suit** with the Swiss Federal Court was the canton forced to extend suffrage to its female residents.

Some argued that women were less intelligent than men, that their brains were smaller than men's. Others feared women would go out to campaign without asking their husbands' permission. The point was also raised for equality because, they said, "women's natural modesty would stop them going out to vote when pregnant, and since rural women have more babies than those in towns, this would give an unfair advantage to the latter." "And if women were actually elected, that would be a source of humiliation for their husbands!"

Such were the arguments that convinced Switzerland's male population to **turn down** every proposal to allow women the vote. In New Zealand women had the right to vote since 1893 and in most European countries since the end of World War I. Even though both chambers of the Swiss parliament finally gave the green light to women's suffrage in 1958, more than 50 years after Europe's pioneer Finland, when proposed to the people, two thirds of the male citizens turned parliament's recommendation down.

But it wasn't as if Swiss women had stood **idly** waiting for their rights to be given to them. Emilie Kempin-Spyri (1853-1901), Switzerland's first woman lawyer, had claimed that the article of the Federal Constitution which stated "All Swiss are equal before the law" meant that men and women had equal rights. However, this assertion was rejected by the Swiss Federal Court.

The first feminist association was established in 1868, calling for civil rights, and the right to attend university. There had been proposals to include women's suffrage in the 1874 constitution. In 1929 a petition for voting rights managed to collect a quarter of a million signatures—but it was ignored.

Switzerland's system of direct democracy, which gave voters the final say on legislation, ironically kept women out. However, the extensive autonomy of even the smallest administrative units gave them their chance to **break in** to political life. It was a tiny commune in Canton Valais that, in 1957, was the first to allow its women members to vote. Several cantons gradually followed and in the 1960s women started occupying more and more important positions in local parliaments and governments. In 1968 Geneva, then the country's third largest city, had a woman mayor—but she still couldn't vote in federal elections.

When the human rights convention of the Council of Europe was signed, Switzerland remained out of those parts that call for sexual equality. The protest this provoked forced the government to revise its position and a new referendum was put to the country.

The result: on February 7th 1971 Swiss males finally gave their female compatriots the full federal voting rights by a two thirds majority. The official results showed 621,403 of the all-male electorate supported the vote for women and 323,596 were against.

Text adapted from *Swissworld.org*

canton: One of the several states which form the Swiss Confederation.
suffrage: vot / voto
filed suit (to file suit): demandar, portar a judici / demandar, llevar a juicio
turn down (to turn down): rebutjar / rechazar
idly: inactiu / inactivo
break in (to break in): entrar, introduir-se /entrar, introducirse

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Women in Switzerland got their right to vote ☐ when female residents were accepted by assembly. ☐ thanks to two women who took legal action for it. ☐ as part of their traditional rights. ☐ before canton Appenzell Innerrhoden accepted it.	☐	☐	☐
2. In the text, which of these arguments for not giving women the right to vote is FALSE? ☐ Women were considered less intelligent than men. ☐ Women in rural areas had more advantages than urban women. ☐ Pregnant women would be too shy to go out to vote. ☐ Men feared they would lose their control over women.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the text, when the Swiss parliament proposed to pass the vote for women in 1958, ☐ the majority of male voters rejected it. ☐ all European countries had already given it the green light. ☐ only women in Finland had the right to vote. ☐ the arguments were not convincing at all.	☐	☐	☐
4. The text explains that Swiss women ☐ had never become involved in political action before 1991. ☐ were peacefully waiting for their rights to be granted to them. ☐ had been fighting for their rights since the nineteenth century. ☐ ignored the quarter million signatures petition for votes in 1929.	☐	☐	☐
5. Although Switzerland's system of direct democracy kept women out of their right to vote in federal elections, ☐ women started taking political posts in local government in the 1960s. ☐ some small communities allowed women extensive autonomy. ☐ most cantons always resisted the legislation. ☐ in 1968 Geneva gave the first woman mayor the chance to vote.	☐	☐	☐
6. At the human rights Convention of the Council of Europe, Switzerland ☐ demanded governments to change their position on equal vote. ☐ called on a referendum on equal vote in Europe. ☐ suggested to revise those parts on sexual equality. ☐ refused to sign the parts on sexual equality.	☐	☐	☐
7. According to Emilie Kempin-Spyri, the Swiss Federal Constitution ☐ should give more rights to women. ☐ gave equal rights to both men and women. ☐ needed an article on equal rights. ☐ rejected her proposals before the Federal Court.	☐	☐	☐
8. Swiss women finally gained full right to federal vote ☐ in spite of the criticism of the Federal Court. ☐ thanks to the claims of the first woman lawyer, Emilie Kempin-Spyri. ☐ when 50 % of male voters signed a petition. ☐ in the 1971 referendum, with more than 50 % of male voters.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

WHY BILINGUALS ARE SMARTER

Speaking two languages has obvious practical benefits in an increasingly globalized world. But in recent years, scientists have begun to show that the advantages of bilingualism are even more fundamental than being able to converse with a wider range of people. Being bilingual, it turns out, makes you smarter. It can have a profound effect on your brain, improving cognitive skills not related to language and even protecting against dementia in old age.

This view of bilingualism is remarkably different from the one through much of the 20th century. Researchers and educators used to consider that a second language was an interference that **hindered** a child's academic and intellectual development. They were not wrong: there is ample evidence that in a bilingual's brain both language systems are active even when only one language is being used, therefore creating situations in which one system obstructs the other. But this interference, researchers are finding out, isn't so much a **handicap** as an advantage. It forces the brain to resolve internal conflict, making the mind strengthen its cognitive muscles.

Bilinguals, for instance, seem to be better than monolinguals at solving certain kinds of mental puzzles. In a 2004 study by the psychologists Ellen Bialystok and Michelle Martin-Rhee, bilingual and monolingual preschoolers were asked to **sort** blue circles and red squares presented on a computer screen into two digital boxes—one marked with a blue square and the other marked with a red circle. In the first task, the children had to sort the shapes by colour, placing blue circles in the box marked with the blue square and red squares in the box marked with the red circle. Both groups did this with similar easiness. Next, the children were asked to sort by shape, which was more challenging because it required placing the images in a box marked with a different colour. The bilinguals were quicker at performing this task.

The evidence from such studies suggests that the bilingual experience improves the brain's executive function—a command system that directs the processes that we use for planning, solving problems and doing other mentally demanding tasks. These processes include avoiding distractions, **switching** attention from one thing to another and holding information in mind—like remembering a sequence of directions while driving.

The main difference between bilinguals and monolinguals may be more basic: an increased ability to **monitor** the environment. "Bilinguals have to switch languages quite often—you may talk to your father in one language and to your mother in another," says Albert Costa, a researcher at the Pompeu Fabra University in Spain. "This requires observing changes around you in the same way that we monitor our surroundings when driving." In a study comparing German-Italian bilinguals with Italian monolinguals on monitoring tasks, Mr Costa found that the bilingual speakers did them better and needed less brain activity, indicating that they were more efficient.

The bilingual experience appears to influence the brain from infancy to old age. In a recent study of 44 elderly Spanish-English bilinguals, scientists directed by the neuropsychologist Tamar Gollan of the University of California, San Diego, found that individuals with a higher degree of bilingualism were more resistant than others to the **onset** of dementia and other symptoms of Alzheimer's disease and developed them later.

Nobody ever doubted the power of language. But who could imagine that the words we hear and the sentences we speak might have such a big influence?

Text adapted from *The New York Times* (March 17, 2012)

hindered (to hinder): entorpir / entorpecer
handicap: desavantatge / desventaja
sort (to sort): classificar /clasificar
switch (to switch): canviar / cambiar
monitor (to monitor): observar, controlar
onset: començament / inicio

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Recent scientific studies have proved that bilingual people ☐ obtain greater benefits in today's world. ☐ are better conversationalists. ☐ have better cognitive skills than monolinguals. ☐ will not suffer from mental diseases in old age.	☐	☐	☐
2. As opposed to the 20th century view, we now know that ☐ bilingual children had more learning advantages in the past. ☐ when two languages interfere, they cause many disadvantages. ☐ language interference is good because it makes the mind stronger. ☐ the brain of bilingual people is obstructed more easily.	☐	☐	☐
3. In the first part of a study by Bialystok and Martin-Rhee, both mono and bilingual kids ☐ had difficulty in classifying the colours in the corresponding circle. ☐ found it similarly easy to classify the figures according to colour. ☐ had problems using the computer. ☐ put circles and squares together in the same box.	☐	☐	☐
4. In the second part of the study, which was more difficult, ☐ bilingual kids were faster at solving the problem. ☐ there was no difference between the performance of mono and bilingual kids. ☐ monolingual kids could not classify the figures according to shape. ☐ both groups of kids encountered the same difficulties.	☐	☐	☐
5. According to the text, which one of the following tasks is NOT carried out by the brain's executive function? ☐ Making plans and decisions. ☐ Retaining a sequence of information. ☐ Giving directions to people who drive. ☐ Changing your focus of attention.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to Albert Costa, changing from one language to another all the time ☐ makes you observe the changes around you. ☐ may improve your driving skills. ☐ allows you to talk to your father and mother in different languages. ☐ makes you quicker at changing the things around you.	☐	☐	☐
7. In Mr Costa's study, ☐ German-Italian bilinguals required more brain activity on their monitoring tasks. ☐ Italian monolinguals were not as active as German-Italian bilinguals. ☐ Italian monolinguals got better results in their monitoring tasks. ☐ German-Italian bilinguals did their monitoring tasks better and more efficiently.	☐	☐	☐
8. A study at the University of California revealed that ☐ monolinguals suffer from more mental illnesses like dementia. ☐ bilinguals developed some mental diseases at a more advanced age. ☐ Alzheimer's disease is more resistant in monolingual people. ☐ some people were more resistant to bilingualism than others.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE TEACHER WHO CHANGED MY LIFE

A fortnight ago I heard that the English master who taught me at school, the great Frank Miles, had died, aged 92. Although he was a teaching giant and recognised as such by former pupils and colleagues, there is just a brief mention of him on the Internet. That is exactly as he would have wanted it: modern communication methods were not for him. He only just tolerated the telephone; a telephone which rang at an inopportune moment, such as when he was marking essays or exam papers, could easily be thrown out of the window.

But when he was teaching, Frank made his inflexible views extremely plain. The classroom was his theatre. In physical presence he was quite **slight**. But to a boy of my age his reputation made him seem several times life-size. That reputation alone was enough to cause fear into the lazy and **quell** the uncontrollable. He didn't have to do anything to keep order. Lessons would begin with what a friend has described as a "ferocious, almost neurotic intensity." They could also be very funny, as long as the class was performing to the highest level.

Frank's critical remarks were annihilating. After the first homework our class ever did for him, Frank judged the standard so poor throughout the entire class that he **tore** up every incorrect composition and threw it in the bin. All except one, and I **blush** to write that the piece saved was mine. It would have been much better for me if someone else's homework had been picked.

He was highly intolerant of those who disagreed with him. By today's standards he was deeply politically incorrect and had little time for rules and regulations. In fact, in the modern bureaucratic world he would be considered a problematic teacher.

Yet he was a truly inspirational teacher who held his class in focused attention. Because, above all, he had a complete passion not only for his subject but also for education. What was most important to him was his pupils' intellectual understanding of English, and he was not afraid to reprimand them when they were failing to reach his high standards. Frank would have taught anyone who showed a **spark** of aptitude for his subject as he was determined to raise standards. He was particularly pleased when a boy who had previously had a low level could achieve spectacular results.

He was quite a peculiar man. His **mannerisms** and language lent themselves so well to imitation that the image of boys pretending to be Frank is sometimes more vivid than the memory of Frank himself.

In the restaurant, after the funeral service, we discussed the never-ending question: who was Frank? He once told me how lucky I was to come from a loving family. He had not got on with his father. Other than that, his childhood was to us a complete blank, as was his emotional life.

He lived for his pupils; if other relationships had once existed, nobody knew about them. Although he detested snobbery and money, he could be considered an elitist—but only in the sense that he expected the best from every boy he taught, whatever their background or potential.

I was lucky to come under the eyes of a classroom colossus. Sadly, Frank did not find relationships outside the classroom easy. He became a recluse in his last decade and died in a basic flat. And the tragedy is that I never told him how much he had influenced my life—and that of many others.

Text adapted from the *Daily Mail* (July 16, 2013)

slight: menut, prim / menudo, delgado
quell (to quell): apaivagar, calmar / apaciguar, calmar
tore (to tear): estripar / romper
blush (to blush): ruboritzar-se / sonrojarse
spark: espurna, mica / chispa, pizca
mannerism: peculiaritat, gest d'expressió / peculiaridad, gesto de expresión

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The author of the text knew about the death of Frank Miles ☐ a long time ago. ☐ through a phone call. ☐ from his colleagues. ☐ quite recently.	☐	☐	☐
2. The author also states that information about Frank Miles ☐ can be found on most educational websites. ☐ was widely spread on the Internet. ☐ was not available on the Internet. ☐ was hardly mentioned on the Internet.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the text, Frank Miles calmed his rebellious students thanks ☐ to his physical appearance. ☐ to his good manners. ☐ to his weak character. ☐ to his strong personality.	☐	☐	☐
4. Frank's classes could be very funny ☐ provided the students were at their best. ☐ only when the students behaved correctly. ☐ provided the students did their homework. ☐ as long as the students paid attention.	☐	☐	☐
5. The author thinks that Frank Miles was a remarkable teacher because ☐ he had an intellectual understanding of English. ☐ he was passionate about educational values. ☐ he never reprimanded his rebellious pupils. ☐ he had little interest in raising his students' results.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to the text, which of the following statements about Frank Miles' character is TRUE? ☐ He had a passion for rules and regulations. ☐ He tolerated diversity of opinion. ☐ He was intolerant with his students' low standards. ☐ His students were never frightened by his criticism.	☐	☐	☐
7. The author considered Frank Miles elitist because he ☐ fancied money and snobbery. ☐ ignored rebellious students. ☐ had particular mannierisms. ☐ demanded the best from his pupils.	☐	☐	☐
8. During his last decade, Frank Miles lived ☐ surrounded by his ex-pupils. ☐ alone in his wealthy house. ☐ on his own in a modest apartment. ☐ in a hostel for the homeless.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

HOW CHINA IS WINNING THE SCHOOL RACE

China's education performance—at least in cities such as Shanghai and Hong Kong—is as spectacular as the country's rapid economic expansion, surpassing many more advanced countries. But what is behind this success?

Surprise came when the results of the **OECD**'s international maths, science and reading tests —the 2009 **PISA** tests—were published. Shanghai, taking part for the first time, came top in all three subjects. Meanwhile, Hong Kong, which did well in the last decade, has gone from good to great. In this global ranking, it came fourth in reading, second in maths and third in science. These two Chinese cities **outstripped** leading education systems around the world. The results for Beijing are not quite as spectacular. "But they are still high," says Andreas Schleicher, the OECD's head of education statistics.

Cheng Kai-Ming, Professor of Education at Hong Kong University, attributes the results to "a devotion to education not shared by other cultures." More than 80 % of Shanghai's older secondary students attend after-school tutoring. They may spend another three to four hours each day on homework under close parental supervision. Such dedication also reflects the ferociously competitive university entrance examinations. Prof. Cheng says Chinese parents are definitely devoted to their children's education.

Certainly these two open and dynamic cities regard as valuable to adopt the best educational practices from around the world to **ensure** success. Under the slogan "First class city, first class education", Shanghai re-equipped classrooms, **upgraded** schools and revised the curriculum in the last decade. Teachers were trained in more interactive methodology and computers were brought in. The city's schools are now a model for the country. About 80 % of Shanghai school leavers go to university compared to an average of 24 % in China.

Last year Shanghai claimed to be the first Chinese city to provide free schooling for all migrant children. Shanghai controls who lives and works in the city, allowing only the best and the brightest students to become residents with access to jobs and schools. "For over 50 years Shanghai has been accumulating talent, the cream of the cream in China. That gives it an incredible advantage," says Ruth Heyhoe, former head of the Chinese Institute of Education.

Meanwhile, Hong Kong was forced into educational improvements when its industries moved to cheaper Chinese areas in the 1990s. To continue being a service centre for China, the city had to upgrade knowledge and skills. In the last decade Hong Kong has concentrated on raising the level for all students, and today Hong Kong's education system is rated among the best in the world. "If we want to have high **achievement**, we need experts in secondary schools," said Catherine Chan, secretary for education in the Hong Kong government. Teachers are selected from the top 30 % of the university graduates. By contrast, according to the OECD, the US selects from the bottom third. In Hong Kong, over one-fifth of government money is spent on education every year.

Both Hong Kong and Shanghai are changing their educational models and no-one knows how this will result in terms of quality. However, they believe they are moving in the right direction. Their societies are changing rapidly and for both cities, reaching the top might be easier than staying there.

Text adapted from *BBC News* [on line].
<http://www.bbc.co.uk/news>

OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development): OCDE
PISA (Programme for International Student Assessment)
outstrip: deixar enrere / dejar atrás
ensure: assegurar / asegurar
upgrade: modernitzar, millorar / modernizar, mejorar
achievement: assoliment, èxit / consecución, éxito

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The results of the 2009 PISA tests in Hong Kong and Shanghai were ☐ much better than cities in other countries. ☐ as spectacular as those in other countries. ☐ not as good as was expected. ☐ good, but not great.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, which of the following statements is FALSE? ☐ Chinese parents supervise their children's schoolwork very closely. ☐ Education is a very important issue for Chinese parents. ☐ All Chinese secondary students take extra after-school lessons. ☐ Chinese students spend most of their afternoons doing homework.	☐	☐	☐
3. In order to get better results in education, both Shanghai and Hong Kong ☐ will become open and dynamic. ☐ want to copy successful education systems from other countries. ☐ will continue with their own successful education practices. ☐ want the best educators in the world.	☐	☐	☐
4. The slogan "First class city, first class education" suggests that ☐ only people from the higher classes can get an education. ☐ to get an education, first you must go to class. ☐ they want to offer the best education to its citizens. ☐ in this city, everybody must get an education.	☐	☐	☐
5. In the last ten years, Shanghai has ☐ not done much to modernise its school system. ☐ started a teacher training program. ☐ introduced computers into schools. ☐ had 80 % of people who leave school.	☐	☐	☐
6. Shanghai ☐ has allowed immigrants to go to school for over fifty years. ☐ is the Chinese city with most migrant students. ☐ has no control over who lives and works there. ☐ only gives residence permit to the best students.	☐	☐	☐
7. Hong Kong had to make improvements in education ☐ because its industries were a service centre for China. ☐ to continue playing an important part in Chinese economy. ☐ because China was just as expensive and the industry moved there. ☐ when China upgraded its industry in the 1990s.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to the OECD, in ☐ Hong Kong, 30 % of university students become teachers. ☐ Hong Kong, only the best university students may become teachers. ☐ the USA, one third of the best university students become teachers. ☐ the USA, the bottom university students will never be teachers.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

WHY KIDS BULLY: BECAUSE THEY'RE POPULAR

Mothers tell their children that **mean** kids behave that way because they have unhappy home lives, feel inadequate, or don't have enough friends; or because they lack empathy. But a new study suggests some mean kids actually behave that way simply because they can. It has now been proved that the more popular a kid becomes, the more central to the social network of the school, the more aggressive the behaviour he or she **engages** in. At least, that was the case in North Carolina, where students from 19 middle and high schools were studied for 5 years by researchers at the University of California-Davis.

Authors Robert Faris and Diane Felmlee interviewed public-school kids seven times over the course of their study, starting when the students were in grades 6, 7 and 8. They asked the students to say who their friends were and used the data to create friendship maps. They then asked the kids who was unkind to them and whether they bullied anyone. Researchers then tried to determine the pathways of aggression. What they found was that only one-third of the students engaged in any bullying at all — physical force, insults or spreading gossip — but those who were becoming more popular in the school bullied more. Only when kids reached the very top 2 % of the school's social **hierarchy** or fell into the bottom 2 % did their behavior change; these kids were the least aggressive. "Seemingly normal well-adjusted kids can be aggressive," says Faris, whose results are published in the *American Sociological Review*. "We found that school status increases aggression."

Although authors do not discard psychological or background influences as **underlying** causes of bullying, they believe that popularity is at least as important. "It's one of the few times I can remember in social sciences where race and family background seem to make very little difference," says Faris. "Those demographic and socioeconomic factors don't seem to matter as much as where the kids are in the school hierarchy in terms of their popularity." Faris also found that kids who cared more about popularity, were more aggressive. Surprisingly, though, hostile behavior did not make them more popular. "The evidence suggests that aggression does not increase status," he says. Then again, bullying works mostly because kids believe it does.

Another stereotype the study destroyed was that males and females bully differently. Boys spread gossip less often than girls did. And girls were less physically violent to each other than boys were. Gender-on-gender bullying was more **prevalent** among girls than boys, but boys were more likely to be hostile toward girls than the other way around. However, gender wasn't entirely a neutral factor. If a girl knew a lot of boys, or a boy knew a lot of girls at a school where there wasn't much mixing of the sexes, those kids' popularity would go up, presumably because they provided a bridge to contact with potential dates. And, yes, the "gender-bridge" kids, as the study called them, seemed to be more aggressive than others.

If bullying is actually more a result of school hierarchy than of psychology, Faris believes there might be a more effective solution than trying to change the behavior of the bullies. "The majority of kids who witness bullying, either do not oppose it or encourage it," says Faris. "Those are the ones who give these kids their status. We need to change their minds."

Text adapted from *Time* (February 8, 2011)

mean: mesquí / mezquino
engage: involucrar
hierarchy: jerarquia / jerarquía
underlying: fonamental /fundamental
prevalent: freqüent / frecuente

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

		Espai per al corrector/a		
		Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1.	According to the text, mean kids behave that way ☐ because mothers do not prevent them to do so. ☐ as a result of the pressure of other students. ☐ for no apparent reason, just because it is accepted. ☐ as a consequence of their empathy with their friends.	☐	☐	☐
2.	The text argues that aggression at school ☐ increases with the kids' popularity. ☐ increases when the kid is involved in the school hierarchy. ☐ is insignificant among popular kids. ☐ depends on the school's social network.	☐	☐	☐
3.	Faris and Felmlee's research to determine the pathways of aggression revealed that ☐ in principle any kid may become a bully. ☐ physical force, insults or spreading gossip are the only forms of bullying. ☐ kids who were in the bottom 2 % of the school hierarchy inevitably become bullies. ☐ reaching the top 2 % of the school hierarchy conditioned kids towards bullying.	☐	☐	☐
4.	Faris and Felmlee also argue that ☐ popularity is the only determining factor in bullying. ☐ race and family background are strongly determining factors in bullying. ☐ psychological or background influences are also relevant when considering bullying. ☐ demographic and socioeconomic factors condition the school hierarchy.	☐	☐	☐
5.	According to the text, hostile behaviour ☐ increases the status of the kid at school. ☐ works mostly because kids like bullying. ☐ makes kids more popular at school. ☐ does not imply a rise in popularity.	☐	☐	☐
6.	The study found out that both boys and girls bully, but the difference is that ☐ girls prefer bullying boys rather than the other way round. ☐ boys clearly spread more gossip than girls do. ☐ bullying was clearly more violent among boys than among girls. ☐ bullying was more frequent between girls than the other way round.	☐	☐	☐
7.	Which one of the following statements is TRUE? According to the study, "gender-bridge" kids ☐ tended to be more aggressive than other students. ☐ are kids that have more dates than others. ☐ are very popular because they bully the rest. ☐ prove that gender is a neutral factor when considering bullying.	☐	☐	☐
8.	All in all, Faris argues that the solution to bullying ☐ is to change the behaviour of the bullies. ☐ lies in changing the minds of the majority of kids at school. ☐ is to encourage opposition againts the bullies. ☐ lies in introducing changes in the school hierarchy.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			
Nota de comprensió escrita			

NOMOPHOBIA: THE BIGGEST PHOBIA IN THE WORLD?

We use mobile phones every day, but for a growing number of people staying connected is an obsession.

According to a study carried out in 2012 by SecurEnvoy, a company that deals in mobile phone technology, Nomophobia (as in "No Mobile phone phobia", that is, the **fear** of being apart from your cell phone) is rising. Out of those surveyed, 66 percent said they have it. That number has gone up from a similar study carried out four years ago, in which 53 percent of people admitted they were afraid of losing their cell phones.

In the 2012 survey, SecurEnvoy **polled** 1,000 people about their mobile phone usage and found that 41 percent of people surveyed said they have more than one cell phone, an indication that fear of going without a cell phone is the real deal. The **poll** also found that nomophobia affects women more than men (70 percent of women surveyed compared to 61 percent of men). "We may draw the conclusion that, perhaps because 47 percent of men have two phones, they're less likely to **misplace** both and therefore be left phone-less," said Andy Kemshall, SecurEnvoy co-founder.

Nomophobia crosses all ethnic and social barriers, but researchers say young people are more likely to be addicted: 18-24 year-olds are the most nomophobic (77 %), followed by 25-34 year-olds (68 %). Perhaps a little more surprising is that the third most nomophobic are 55 and over!

The study also found that people check their phones, on average, 34 times a day. For Karla Campos, who owns a web services company, that's nothing. She says she checks her phone usually 50 times per day, and even sleeps with it: "Before I go to sleep, I put it under my pillow." She also uses the phone to communicate with her 10-year-old son, but not necessarily when they are apart. She says their conversations are deeper on the phone, or through Facebook. Campos argues that this form of communication is better than none at all, and thinks the cell phone connects her family.

Dr. Mitch Spero, a child and family psychologist, disagrees, "I recommend keeping your mobile phone there for emergencies, but when you're with someone, make them the priority in your life." He says it's common to see problems arise because of mobile phone use. "Cell phones should be used to improve our lives," he warned, "not to destroy our interpersonal communication skills with those that we love."

Kemshall found another interesting revelation: nearly half of the people surveyed by SecurEnvoy said they would be upset if their messages were viewed by their partner, and yet only a few take security measures to keep them private. "With 58 percent of the **respondents** using at least one **device** for business use, this lack of security is a worrying trend that needs addressing," said Kemshall.

"What this study does reveal though," adds Kemshall, "is how much people now depend on their mobile phones. As people are increasingly connected, nomophobia will continue to rise, with millions of people needing to have their phones on them, and on at all times."

Wondering if you have Nomophobia? The symptoms include: having multiple phones, constantly **topping up** your battery life, compulsively checking your phone for missed calls or messages, worrying about losing it even when it's in a safe place, never turning it off, using it in inappropriate places and feeling panic and anxiety when separated from it.

Text adapted from *RedOrbit.com* (May 9, 2012)

fear: por / miedo
to poll: enquestar / encuestar
poll: enquesta / encuesta
misplace: perdre, extraviar / perder, extraviar
respondent: enquestat / encuestado
device: aparell /aparato
top up: carregar completament / cargar por completo

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Comparing the 2008 and the 2012 surveys, we see that ☐ more people are afraid now of being without their mobile phone. ☐ in 2008 the number of nomophobes was similar to this year. ☐ in 2008 more people feared being without their mobile phones. ☐ in 2012 the number of nomophobes did not increase.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, more women suffer from nomophobia probably because ☐ a big percentage of men have two phones. ☐ all men have two phones. ☐ women usually have two phones. ☐ women easily misplace their phones.	☐	☐	☐
3. Which sentence is FALSE, according to the text? ☐ One third of people older than fifty-five are nomophobic. ☐ Nomophobia affects people of all ages, races and social classes. ☐ Those who are fifty-five or older are the third most affected age group. ☐ Young adults are the most nomophobic.	☐	☐	☐
4. Karla Campos ☐ talks to her son on the phone even when they are together. ☐ has better communication with her family on the phone. ☐ connects her family via mobile phone. ☐ only communicates with her son through Facebook.	☐	☐	☐
5. According to Dr Spero, ☐ we should make mobile phones a priority in our life. ☐ we should only use mobile phones in case of emergency. ☐ we should prioritise people over mobile phones. ☐ cell phones destroy communication with our loved ones.	☐	☐	☐
6. Kemshall says that security in mobile phones needs to be improved because ☐ lots of people use a phone for business purposes. ☐ nobody likes having their messages viewed by others. ☐ security measures don't help keep messages private. ☐ business people often view other people's messages.	☐	☐	☐
7. This study shows that ☐ there will be lots more nomophobes in the future. ☐ we don't know how many people depend on their phones. ☐ almost everybody will need to carry a phone in the future. ☐ it is necessary to have our mobiles constantly on, these days.	☐	☐	☐
8. Which of the following may indicate nomophobia? ☐ Charging the phone's battery all the time. ☐ Worrying about having just one mobile phone. ☐ Having many missed calls and messages. ☐ Putting the phones in a safe place.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

THE DAY I MET THE STRANGE AND INSCRUTABLE STEVE JOBS

One morning in Paris six years ago, I found myself sitting opposite Steve Jobs. I was feeling really excited, as getting an interview with Jobs had become an obsession. In recent years, particularly since his health had declined, he had rarely talked directly to the media. But then, one day I got the news: I'd been given an interview.

Over the years I'd built up a vague impression of what I could expect: there were stories about the notorious "**flamethrower** treatment" that he would give to anyone who made a mistake. Beyond this, I expected him to be something like the other captains of industry that I had come across, with magnetic personalities and enormous presence.

However, the reality turned out to be very different. The interview took place at Apple's Paris Expo, an exhibition of the company's latest technology. Once he had finished taking questions from the media I was asked to accompany him on a walk around the Expo. Like everything else in Jobs' life, the program was meant to be strictly managed: a quick turn around the **show floor**, and then downstairs to his temporary office for our interview. But as soon as Jobs began his walk, a wild group of Apple fans suddenly appeared, shouting his name and surrounding us. Jobs visibly **shrank** as they approached. His bodyguards quickly took him downstairs. A public relations officer invited me to follow him. Suddenly I was in a room with the man I'd been running after for years. But it wasn't what I expected at all. Yes, the man sitting in front of me looked like the Steve Jobs I knew. But the Steve Jobs I was used to seeing was always in command, always in control, when launching new products. This one, however, seemed frightened and a little confused.

We had half an hour scheduled to talk. I kept looking up at the clock. His assistant indicated that he still needed time to **settle**. Clearly disturbed by his brief encounter with the real world, he came to sit opposite me and adopted a defensive posture. Although we talked for 30 minutes, it wasn't a fluent and easy conversation. He spent too much of his time avoiding questions that he felt were inappropriate. I asked him about Apple's environmental policy, which had received some criticism recently. He rejected the **claim** that Apple's products were less green than its rivals with the same argument that he had always used in press conferences. When I pushed for more details he simply refused to go any further.

I mentioned his health. It was a year after he had had a pancreatic cancer operation, and it seemed that he had beaten the disease successfully. He refused to give me any details about it. For most of my time with him, it seemed he just wasn't mentally in the room. My presence seemed to be another reminder that not everything could be controlled.

This was, after all, a man whose life was so carefully organized that he rarely had to do anything that he didn't want to. He used to spend most of his life in or around Apple's headquarters in Silicon Valley. He followed a strict routine. He was so used to getting his way that when his cancer first appeared he tried to beat it simply through focusing on a diet of fruit and vegetables. It didn't work.

All in all, I was supposed to have just met the most attractive character that the business world has seen in decades. In person, Steve Jobs turned out to be the most inscrutable and peculiar **entrepreneur** I'd ever interviewed.

Text adapted from *The Times* (August 27, 2011)

flamethrower: llençaflames (en el text, abrupte, brusc) / lanzallamas (en el texto, abrupto, brusco)
show floor: pavelló firal / pabellón ferial
shrank: encongir-se / encogerse
settle: calmar-se / calmarse
claim: acusació / acusación
entrepreneur: empresari / empresario

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The narrator felt excited about having an interview with Steve Jobs because… ☐ Steve Jobs had been a myth for him. ☐ Steve Jobs refused to talk to the media. ☐ Steve Jobs never used to grant interviews in Paris. ☐ Steve Jobs hardly ever granted interviews.	☐	☐	☐
2. When the narrator talks about "the notorious flamethrower treatment", he means that… ☐ Jobs was a very strict person. ☐ Jobs was a very magnetic person. ☐ Jobs worked very hard every day. ☐ Jobs was obsessed about the computer world.	☐	☐	☐
3. When the narrator was going to interview Jobs, he found… ☐ him quite different from what he had expected. ☐ him very similar to what he had expected. ☐ him ready to have a long talk. ☐ out that Jobs was not going to answer any questions.	☐	☐	☐
4. According to the text, Jobs adopted a defensive posture because he was… ☐ angry with the interviewer. ☐ not feeling comfortable in Paris. ☐ still influenced by the incident with the fans. ☐ afraid of the interviewer.	☐	☐	☐
5. When asked about Apple's environmental policies… ☐ Jobs refused to answer the question, as he usually did. ☐ Jobs simply repeated the same explanation he always gave. ☐ Jobs answered that the question was inappropriate. ☐ Jobs gave a new point of view about the topic.	☐	☐	☐
6. When the narrator mentioned his health Jobs… ☐ answered that he had beaten his disease successfully. ☐ said that he had had a cancer operation. ☐ gave a short answer with no more details. ☐ simply did not answer.	☐	☐	☐
7. In his everyday life, Steve Jobs… ☐ followed a well-established routine. ☐ did not follow a rigorous routine. ☐ used to spend his time working in his office. ☐ was constantly travelling to sell his products.	☐	☐	☐
8. By defining Steve Jobs as "inscrutable and peculiar", the narrator means that Jobs was… ☐ a hard-working person. ☐ a model for the business world. ☐ a genius of this century. ☐ difficult to define.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

DEATH SITES: HOW TO LOG IN YOUR AFTERLIFE

Lately a lot of websites (*legacylocker.com, gonetoosoon.org, Deathswitch.com…*) have **sprung up** offering to help users to solve a particular modern problem: what happens to your web presence when you die? In the past, a person's legacy used to include a collection of letters and other personal papers; now it is more likely to include thousands of e-mails, tweets, blogs and online records.

The average internet user, with online banking facilities, Facebook and Twitter profiles, and internet based photos, blogs and e-mail accounts can now receive help in order to prepare "their **posthumous** online footprint". The new sites promise to store safely data such as e-mail account passwords, online banking codes and "goodbye videos" to be sent only to nominated friends or relatives in the event of a death.

These websites require that customers either pay an annual fee or buy a "lifetime membership" to keep the information, which is stored in new online legacy **depositories**. After a death, the online archive is opened by beneficiaries exclusively. These websites have many ways of certifying the death of their users: The *Deathswitch* website sends out regular e-mails to check that users are still alive. If a series of messages receive no response, the site contracts qualified people (or experts) called "verifiers" that make sure that the missing person is dead, before making his/her stored information available.

Facebook website now offers a "memorial status" where **deceased** former users have their profiles free from features such as accepting new friend's requests, and only previously accepted friends can see the profile. But it remains open to posts from **mourning** friends.

Neither Facebook nor e-mail providers such as Microsoft Hotmail and Google Gmail will give out the passwords of deceased former users. But Microsoft will provide authentic relatives with a CD of the late user's e-mails; and Gmail allows close relatives access only to specific messages in a deceased person's account. For that matter, relatives must provide copies of a death certificate, details of the content of the e-mails required and proof of legal right to access.

The American businessman Jeremy Toeman set up *Legacy Locker*, which is a website that promises to pass on "digital property" after death. Mr Toeman defines his website as a safe **depository** for vital digital property that allows access to online accounts for accepted friends and close relatives in the event of death. The idea occurred to him after his grandmother died. "I tried to get into her Hotmail account, as I wanted to contact people to let them know" said Mr Toeman. "But I couldn't gain access".

Responses to the new "death sites" are split. John Kay, 68, is a Facebook user but confesses that he wouldn't **sign up** to a death service because he doesn't keep anything confidential online. However, Stephen Marcus, 23, said: "I don't mind people looking through my e-mails or Facebook when I die. And I'm seriously thinking about the idea of a posthumous video. It could be a nice gesture."

In the end, all these sites are just trying to do us a pretty good favour, that is, they are likely to solve one of the most important mysteries in the history of humanity: how to be eternal.

Text adapted from *The Times*

sprung up: sorgir / surgir
posthumous: pòstum / póstumo
depository: magatzem virtual / almacén virtual
deceased: difunt / difunto
mourning: dol, aflicció / luto, aflicción
sign up: registrar-se / registrarse

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The main topic of the text is about websites that… ☐ delete your personal online data when you die. ☐ organise your personal letters and personal documents. ☐ help you to die in case you ask for it. ☐ keep your online profiles safe after your death.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, a "posthumous online footprint" is… ☐ a funeral service that can be downloaded from the internet. ☐ an online message that your friends can send you when you die. ☐ any kind of personal online information that is kept after your death. ☐ a series of acts dedicated to honour your memory when you die.	☐	☐	☐
3. When a user of one of these websites dies… ☐ all the user's archives are destroyed. ☐ the user's beneficiaries can access his/her online profiles. ☐ the website communicates the user's close friends the tragic ending. ☐ the website page of the dead user is removed.	☐	☐	☐
4. A "verifier"… ☐ is sent by the website to certify the user's death. ☐ keeps all the user's data after the funeral. ☐ makes sure that the user's annual fee is paid after the death. ☐ downloads all the user's profiles to the legal beneficiaries.	☐	☐	☐
5. A "memorial status" is a web service that… ☐ keeps your profiles updated daily after your death. ☐ allows anyone free access to your online legacy. ☐ allows your authorised friends access to your online messages. ☐ keeps everybody away from reading or downloading your online post.	☐	☐	☐
6. Which of these sentences is TRUE? ☐ There is no site that gives out the passwords of deceased users. ☐ Microsoft provides access to all messages in a dead user's account. ☐ Facebook provides legal advice on the deceased user's e-mails. ☐ Gmail allows free access to a deceased person's account.	☐	☐	☐
7. Jeremy Toeman's *Legacy Locker* site… ☐ gives everybody free access to your account once your death is certified. ☐ makes a copy of all your e-mails and leaves it to your family after your death. ☐ makes all your digital posthumous legacy available to allowed people. ☐ contacts all your relatives and close friends to let them know your death.	☐	☐	☐
8. According to the text, responses to the new "death sites" are: ☐ sceptical. ☐ indifferent. ☐ neither positive nor negative. ☐ divided.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐

Nota de comprensió escrita ☐

LIVING IN HARMONY WITH THE LAND

The Himba live in the northwest of Namibia in the Kunene region, near the river of the same name. The land is the driest and most **barren** region of Namibia, with less than 250 mm of rain a year. There is little farming and few roads. The mountains are hard to access. The largest town in the region, Opuwo, has only about 5,000 inhabitants. But this impenetrable wilderness has also meant that Himba people have been able to preserve their traditional way of life.

These semi-nomadic people number between 20,000 and 50,000. They live in the northwest of Namibia and mainly **breed** cows and goats. It is the children's job to look after the goats and also to **grind** corn, while the adults look after the cows. Himba society is divided into groups and clans and, unsurprisingly, the head of a clan is its eldest male member.

It has not been easy for the Himba to preserve their traditions. In 1904, when Namibia was ruled by Germany, Himba people were nearly exterminated. Starting in the 1920s, South African rulers confined them to a restricted "homeland," officially forbidding them to trade, breed farm animals freely, or garden and collect wild plants along the Kunene River. When dry weather and war struck Namibia in the 1980s, it looked as if the culture of the indigenous Himba people might disintegrate. Ninety percent of Himba **cattle**, the centre of their economy and identity, died. Some families left for Angola. Yet they resisted—even if at times it meant eating the **hides** they slept on.

With the peace and good rains that came to Namibia in the 1990s, the Himba rebuilt their **herds** and, working with international activists, helped block a proposed hydro-electric dam that would have inundated ancestral lands along the Kunene. They also have benefited from new opportunities provided by the government of independent Namibia—mobile schools where Himba children learn English and **conservancies** that give Himba control of wildlife and tourism on their lands. Vengapi Tijvinda, a grandmother in her 50s, lived through this rebirth. In the 1980s she was making baskets for tourists. Now she has returned to farming and raising cattle: "Life is still the same, but the children can read and write. I am a member of a **conservancy**, and now we can taste animal meat again".

In 1996 the government of Namibia made it possible for the Himba to profit from increased wildlife populations through a program that allows them to manage their shared property as a registered conservancy. This programme—officially called the Community Based Natural Resource Management Programme—requires that a group wanting to form a conservancy establish its membership and define the limits of the land they share, write a constitution and elect a governing committee. When the group's application is accepted by Namibia's Ministry of Environment and Tourism, the conservancy begins to manage the wildlife and other resources on its land according to principles of sustainable use, while continuing with traditional farming. Because conservancies can also control tourism on their land, they are able to contract with commercial tour operators and establish their own tourist facilities. Because a healthy wildlife population is a big tourist attraction, illegal hunting is down, animal numbers are increasing, and efforts are going into maintaining the natural environment that supports wildlife. And perhaps most important, indigenous people like the Himba, whose lives were for generations largely controlled by outside governments, are regaining local control over the future of their communities.

Text adapted from *National Geographic*

barren: àrid / árido
breed: criar
grind: moldre / moler
cattle: bestiar / ganado
hides: pells d'animals / pieles de animales
herds: ramats / manadas
conservancy: espai protegit / espacio protegido

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The Himba people live in…	☐	☐	☐
☐ a rainy region densely populated.			
☐ a mountainous region with good farming conditions.			
☐ a dry region badly communicated.			
☐ a traditional region known for its lakes and rivers.			
2. In Himba culture, children…	☐	☐	☐
☐ spend most of their time playing in the fields.			
☐ are taught traditional arts and crafts.			
☐ are in charge of looking after the cows.			
☐ play an important role in processing food.			
3. According to the text, the Himba people…	☐	☐	☐
☐ had to face many adverse circumstances.			
☐ lost their identity during the German domination.			
☐ were forced to sell most of their cattle to South African rulers.			
☐ were given housing and farming land in Angola.			
4. In the last decades life for the Himba…	☐	☐	☐
☐ has been troubled by monthly rains.			
☐ has improved in many ways.			
☐ has been difficult because of international activists.			
☐ has become much more expensive because of tourism.			
5. At present, Vengapi Tijvinda…	☐	☐	☐
☐ devotes her time to traditional crafts.			
☐ has to work in the tourist sector.			
☐ is finally learning how to read and write.			
☐ has recovered her old way of life.			
6. In a registered conservancy members are supposed…	☐	☐	☐
☐ to limit the increase of tourism.			
☐ to become commercial tour operators.			
☐ to preserve wildlife and traditional farming.			
☐ to refuse the property of the land.			
7. The government of Namibia is now helping the Himba…	☐	☐	☐
☐ to learn how to live away from their land.			
☐ to control the influence of tourism.			
☐ to become more autonomous.			
☐ to defend themselves from wildlife.			
8. The story of the Himba is best described as one of…	☐	☐	☐
☐ hardship and survival.			
☐ tradition and wealth.			
☐ happiness and dreams.			
☐ leisure and freedom.			

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐
Nota de comprensió escrita	☐		

WHAT THE AU PAIR SAW

Silvia, an 18-year-old from Bratislava, the capital of Slovakia, could not believe how **mean** her employers were. They hardly spoke to her, made her work very long hours for very little pay and restricted her access to food. Silvia didn't work in a shop. She was an au pair to a middle-class British family.

Silvia's story comes from a new book, called *Au Pair*, which takes a full and honest look at British families from the sincere point of view of the girls who come to look after their children and help around the house.

The book focuses on the experiences of 50 Slovakian au pairs who have lived with more than 100 **host families** in London. Its author is Zuzana Burikova, a Slovakian sociologist who has been working on this project for more than three years.

The book's most noticeable feature is the pejorative view that au pairs develop towards their host British families. In particular, they are highly critical of the *'having it all'* culture. British **parenting**, it seems, is shockingly bad. The book suggests that the British concept of a woman's right to a career as well as a family is viewed negatively by au pairs. The author thinks that "au pairs generally feel that any family that chooses to have an au pair must, by definition, either be lazy, or lack proper care and consideration for children and for people in general".

In the book we can read about the experience of an au pair called Jarmila, whose host mother worked at home as a clothes designer. Even when she was not working, her child spent all his time with Jarmila, who really felt like a second mother. Another case is that of Darinka, who was fascinated by "English mothers constantly talking about quality time and feeling guilty if they were not actually reading to or playing with their children". In fact, in most cases it was pretty clear they spent very little time with their children. "English women do love their children," Darinka **reluctantly** admits, "but the problem is that they are just not able to combine childcare, housework and a career."

From the experiences in the book we can learn that "food is a particularly tricky issue," says Ms. Burikova. "I'm surprised that children and parents do not eat the same food and that parents buy healthy food like vegetables and fish for themselves but not for their children." Zuzana Burikova explains that "the British like TV programmes where experts tell them how to keep their home, since they don't know how to do it themselves. That's why they need au pairs."

And yet, as with all things, there is a **flip side**. And not all families are cold and unfeeling. In the book we can read the experience of Tina. Tina worked in London as an au pair about nine years ago. She had an absolutely terrific time in there, and there was good understanding between Tina and her host family, as a result of which the family decided to **put her up** until she finished her studies.

After having studied all these experiences, Zuzana Burikova comes to the conclusion that none of all these au pairs' negative experiences stop people from applying for the job. Most Slovakian women go to Britain to work as an au pair in order to learn the language and earn some money at the same time, but there are also others that accept this job because it's a way of escaping from their families or simply because they have just split up with their boyfriend. So, up to a point, the arrangement suits them.

Text adapted from *The Sunday Times* (August 1, 2010)

mean: mesquí, gasiu / mezquino, tacaño
host family: família d'acollida / familia de acogida
parenting: criança / crianza
reluctantly: a contracor / a su pesar
flip side: l'altra cara de la moneda / la otra cara de la moneda
to put her up: acollir-la, contractar-la / acogerla, contratarla

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The book called *Au Pair* is about... ☐ the way Slovakian au pairs look after their own children. ☐ how Slovakian families should raise their children. ☐ what Slovakian au pairs think about British families. ☐ the way Slovakian girls can get a job in England.	☐	☐	☐
2. After reading the text, the *'having it all'* culture could be explained as… ☐ British women's aim of working out instead of being mothers. ☐ the idea of bringing up children and working at the same time. ☐ the difficult choice between having a family and working at the same time. ☐ the idea of having an au pair at home to look after the children.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the text, the British idea of a modern woman… ☐ is not shared by Slovakian au pairs. ☐ is generally accepted by au pairs. ☐ is never criticised by au pairs. ☐ has become a model for Slovakian au pairs.	☐	☐	☐
4. According to Ms. Burikova's book, some British families contract au pairs because… ☐ they think it is the cheapest way of educating their children. ☐ they can't survive without the au pair's help. ☐ they can't afford to raise their children on their own. ☐ they don't care enough about their children.	☐	☐	☐
5. Darinka thinks that most English mothers… ☐ do their best to look after their children. ☐ do not spend enough time with their children. ☐ prefer their careers to their children. ☐ play their role successfully.	☐	☐	☐
6. By saying that "food is a particularly tricky issue" Ms. Burikova suggests that parents… ☐ don't feed their children healthily. ☐ only care about what their children eat. ☐ do not care about their health problems. ☐ believe their children are healthy enough.	☐	☐	☐
7. Tina's experience as an au pair was… ☐ terrible. ☐ wonderful. ☐ depressing. ☐ unbelievable.	☐	☐	☐
8. Most Slovakian au pairs apply for the job mainly because… ☐ they want to travel abroad to get a well-paid job. ☐ it's a good opportunity to leave their homes and relatives. ☐ their love relationships are broken and they want to meet new people. ☐ it's a way of learning a language and earning some money.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐
Nota de comprensió escrita	☐		

THE *CAMINO DE SANTIAGO*, THE ENGLISH WAY

I was somewhere near Betanzos and I didn't know I was lost, but a passer-by guessed I was doing the *Camino*, said something I did not understand and pointed down the hill. So I retraced my steps about 50 metres, and there was the sign of the **scallop shell**.

The *Camino de Santiago*—or St James's Way—started attracting international **pilgrims** more than 1,000 years ago. By the 12th century, half a million a year were arriving in Santiago de Compostela to pay homage to a mythical early missionary who had a habit of appearing on battlefields to help the Christians. An early guidebook, the *Codex Calixtinus*, detailed the route, and a chain of hostels (called *albergues*) was built to give the pilgrims places of rest.

Nowadays, the hostels are still there, and they are so cheap as to be almost free. In Galicia official hostels cost €6 per night; some hostels along the way ask only for donations. The route is still **waymarked** with the scallop shell that became the pilgrim symbol, and after many centuries of little use the numbers of pilgrims are increasing again.

In a Holy Year, the pilgrimage is even more valued. Holy Years pilgrims occur whenever St James's Day (25 July) falls on a Sunday, as was the case in 2010, when 250,000 pilgrims—double the usual number—arrived in Santiago to claim their *compostela* (certificate of completion) and hug the statue of St James in the cathedral in the hope of absolute **forgiveness**. Even the Pope made an appearance this year.

There's not just one *Camino* across Spain, but five. The main route is the French Way, a difficult walk across northern Spain. Then there's the Portuguese Way, the Silver Way, the Northern Way and the English Way. This one is the shortest and the least crowded—and the one I was taking. It starts from the ports of either La Coruña or El Ferrol, where the English originally arrived by boat. It mixes coastal scenery with rural Spain, includes some handsome seaside towns and less handsome industrial sites, and can be done in less than a week. At times it felt to me quite English, too, as I walked between flower-rich **hedgerows** and crossed rivulets that could have been in Cornwall, except for the fragrant eucalyptus and vineyards on south-facing hills. And although it would probably have been more appropriate to stay in an *albergue*, I chose to do it the easy way, walking between designated points, and stopping at lovely rural hotels in the evening.

I'm not, really, a true pilgrim and I'm no believer (but neither are many of the walkers who **set out** every year on this oldest example of mass tourism). I wasn't expecting absolution. I wanted simply to enjoy an inexpensive long-distance walk through a little known part of Spain. That didn't diminish my satisfaction on arriving in Santiago, however, a historic city which makes an appropriate end to a form of tourism that hasn't fundamentally changed since medieval times.

Although I hadn't done enough to collect my *compostela* (you must complete at least 100 km and have the stamps to prove it), I felt so satisfied with myself on arrival that I went to pilgrim Mass in the magnificent sculpture-covered cathedral. Outside, the main square was full of buskers, beggars and pilgrims, tanned and smiley, just as it's been happening over the centuries.

Text adapted from *The Independent* (July 24, 2010)

scallop shell: petxina de vieira / concha de vieira
pilgrim: pelegrí / peregrino
waymarked: senyalitzat / señalizado
hedgerow: tanca / valla
forgiveness: perdó / perdón
to set out: sortir, començar el camí / partir, empezar el camino

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The writer got lost while he was doing the *Camino*… ☐ and asked the way to a passer-by. ☐ but he was lucky to find the scallop shell that marks the way. ☐ and a man gave him directions even before he asked. ☐ and he had to walk a long way back to get on the right track.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the text, which of the following sentences is FALSE? ☐ Pilgrims started to come to Santiago in the 12th century. ☐ Pilgrims who take on St James' Way come from many different countries. ☐ St James is a legendary character who helped win many battles. ☐ The *Codex Calixtinus* was written as a guide for the pilgrims.	☐	☐	☐
3. The author explains that… ☐ you can stay for free in all the hostels on the route. ☐ you just pay a small amount to spend a night in an *albergue*. ☐ you must make a donation in all the hostels. ☐ official hostels are cheap, but unofficial ones are not.	☐	☐	☐
4. In a Holy Year… ☐ the Pope always visits Santiago. ☐ pilgrims cannot get their *compostela*. ☐ the number of pilgrims always doubles that of a normal year. ☐ pilgrims who take on the *Camino* expect absolute forgiveness.	☐	☐	☐
5. The English way… ☐ starts in Cornwall and runs through coastal towns. ☐ must be taken along the seaside by boat. ☐ was preferred by the English people because it was easier. ☐ doesn't take as long to complete as the other routes.	☐	☐	☐
6. As he was walking, the author felt… ☐ as if he was in England because the landscape was similar to that of Cornwall. ☐ that the eucalyptus and the vineyards he found on the way are typically English. ☐ that it was just as easy to stay in an *albergue* or in a hotel. ☐ that staying in rural hotels was what an English pilgrim should do.	☐	☐	☐
7. The author did the *Camino* because… ☐ he had strong religious beliefs, just like many other pilgrims. ☐ as a pilgrim, he was looking for absolution. ☐ he wanted to experience a cheap walking holiday. ☐ he had never been to Santiago before.	☐	☐	☐
8. When he reached Santiago, he was very pleased because… ☐ he had won his *compostela.* ☐ he had to attend Mass in the cathedral. ☐ he could see the buskers and beggars in the square. ☐ he had completed the *Camino*.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes	☐	☐	☐

Nota de comprensió escrita ☐

DIGITAL AND TRADITIONAL TOOLS

Do the latest social networks encourage strong relationships or weak ones? Generally speaking, digital ties aren't as powerful as the friendships and **commitments** we make in person.

Twitter and Facebook, when used together with other tools of human **connectedness**, can be extremely useful. Digital networks haven't replaced physical togetherness and conversation, even if it sometimes feels that way. Yes, it is true that some people have effectively moved their entire lives online, and the media have for years covered every digital phenomenon, no matter how trivial.

Thankfully, however, the silly use of social networks is beginning to die down. What's emerging in its place is a more intelligent and constructive view of the digital future, one that **embraces** the enormous promise of these technologies while accepting their limitations.

Twitter and Facebook aren't going to save the world. But when used alongside other tools of human connectedness—including some very old ones, like the face-to-face conversations, meetings and protests that **drove** the civil rights movement in the USA—the new technologies can be extremely useful. We can learn a lot from our digital life and make real friends there. But if we never turn off the screen and don't use those **gains** in our life, what use would they be? Digital networking and more traditional forms of communication aren't mutually exclusive—they feed into each other.

American writer Clay Shirky tells in his book *Here Comes Everybody*, about how, through the wonders of digital networking, a New Yorker recovered a lost cell phone. His book is full of stories about really important social and organizational change that was significantly helped along—if not entirely created—by the newer gadgets.

Change begins with great ideas. Shirky says that among the 50 or so people he follows on Twitter are the Dalai Lama and a community of Benedictine monks who make writing journals and other paper products with the intention of slowing down our over-busy minds. "When I pick up a valuable new thought on Twitter, I try to take it with me into the non-digital world, where we should all be spending more time these days," he says. "That's where the real revolutions happen."

Professor Rheinghold, from Berkeley University, said about Twitter: "You have to learn how to make it add value rather than subtract hours from one's day. Certainly, it may cause distraction. But it also makes possible the formation of forums called *personal learning networks*". He explains that he values Twitter because of its openness, its immediacy, variety, reciprocity, its channel to multiple publics, its potential for allowing networks to become communities and the mass collaborations it enables.

The Web can be a labyrinth of abusive language and misinformation, but it can also be an accessible and inexpensive medium for community-building and political activism. The difference lies not in the technology but in the literacy—**know-how** is the critical difference. Those who gain the know-how to transform networks into movements might gain the keys to power—for better or worse—in coming decades.

Text adapted from *The New York Times* (September 30, 2010)

commitment: compromís / compromiso
connectedness: relació, comunicació / relación, comunicación
to embrace: incloure, abraçar / incluir, abarcar
to drive: moure, impulsar / mover, impulsar
gain: guany / ganancia
know-how: coneixements, experiència / conocimientos, experiencia

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is possible.

[0.5 points each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. The author… ☐ prefers personal relationships to digital ties. ☐ thinks digital ties have destroyed personal conversation and commitment. ☐ is against friendships made through the networks. ☐ thinks personal friendships are stronger than those made through the net.	☐	☐	☐
2. According to the article, the civil rights movement in the USA was an example of… ☐ excellent communication and togetherness. ☐ the power of bringing people together in forums of discussion and protest. ☐ very old forms of communicating. ☐ how the world could be saved by protesting.	☐	☐	☐
3. According to the author, Twitter and Facebook can be very useful in the future… ☐ if they are used alongside traditional forms of communication. ☐ whenever they are connected with one another. ☐ because they have been replaced by human togetherness. ☐ because the digital phenomenon is a true religion.	☐	☐	☐
4. The author thinks that we can learn a lot from our digital life if we… ☐ combine the best of both worlds by bringing our digital world onto our real one. ☐ use the new technologies to make more and more friends. ☐ never turn off the screen on our computer. ☐ expand networking and exclude traditional forms of communication.	☐	☐	☐
5. American writer Clay Shirky says that the real revolutions take place… ☐ in the digital world. ☐ among those who learn to live a more peaceful life. ☐ in the non-digital world. ☐ among the followers of wise men.	☐	☐	☐
6. What is Professor Rheinghold's opinion about Twitter? ☐ He thinks Twitter is more open than any other network. ☐ He considers it to be useless and that it takes a lot of your time. ☐ He likes it because it is the best way for communicating. ☐ He finds it valuable if you know how to extract its benefits.	☐	☐	☐
7. The author's views on the new social networks could be said to be generally… ☐ positive. ☐ negative. ☐ sceptical. ☐ indifferent.	☐	☐	☐
8. The article concludes that… ☐ it is impossible to tell what is good from what is bad on the net. ☐ there is too much information on the net. ☐ only those who control the net will be successful in the world. ☐ the Internet may become the most powerful political tool in the future.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita